

***The Seventh Tradition
– A Turning Point***

**THE THIRTY-SEVENTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

***1987
Final Report***

Roosevelt Hotel, New York City, April 26 – May 2

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468 PARK AVENUE SOUTH, NEW YORK, NY 10016

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Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).

THEME OF THE 37TH CONFERENCE

"The Seventh Tradition — A Turning Point"

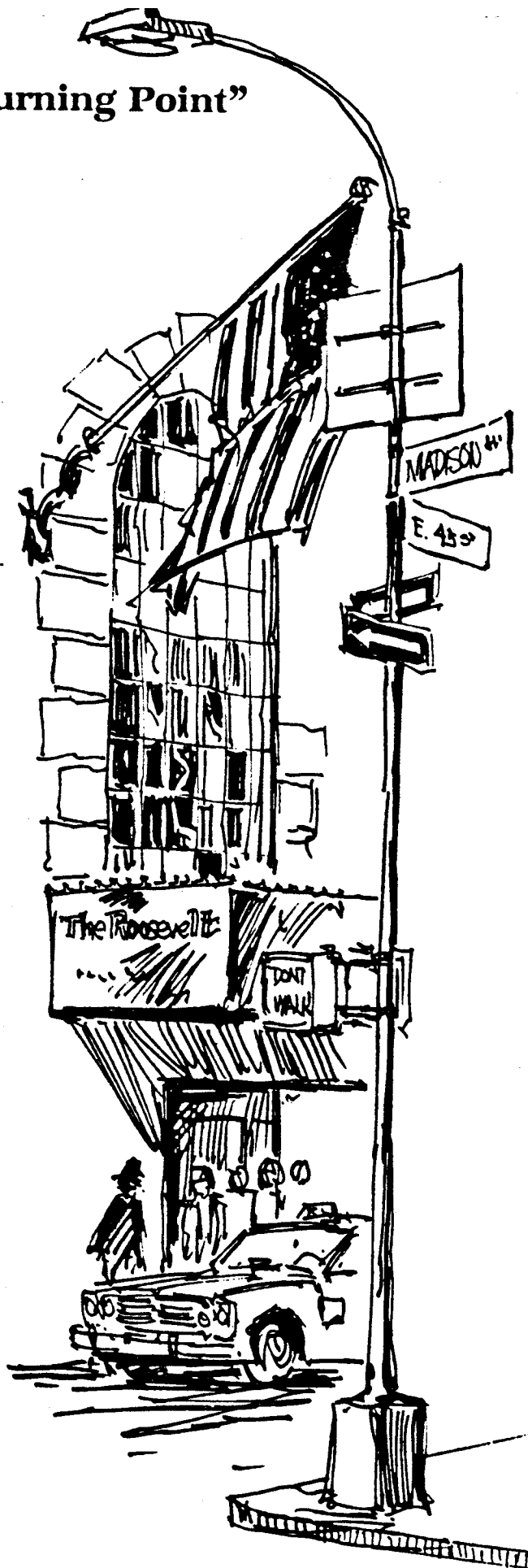
The 37th U.S./Canada General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous met at the Hotel Roosevelt, New York City, April 26–May 2. The work of the Conference is ongoing throughout the entire year—in the groups, in the districts and areas, at the General Service Office and in the constant work of committees, from local areas to the trustees' committees. It is during A.A.'s annual General Service Conference that the delegates from 91 areas of the U.S./Canada, trustees, directors and staff members of G.S.O. and Grapevine come together to express A.A.'s collective group conscience and ensure that the voice of A.A. as a whole will be heard.

"The Seventh Tradition — A Turning Point" was the theme of the 37th Conference. Choosing the Seventh Tradition as a theme is, in itself, a kind of turning point—it has never been selected before. Through the years Conference themes have varied—reflecting changing times and the climate of the Fellowship. For example, at the first Conference in 1951, after co-founders Bill W. and Dr. Bob turned A.A. over to the Fellowship, the theme was: Not to Govern — But to Serve. Determination to Work and Grow Together marked the theme of the 11th Conference in 1961. Sponsorship (1967), Group Conscience (1969), Our Primary Purpose (1972), The A.A. Group (1977) and A.A. Takes Its Inventory (1981) have all been the focus of attention at previous Conferences. And yet, while our tradition of self-support through contributions has not been "officially" addressed, it has, in one way or another, been discussed at nearly every Conference since 1951.

On Monday afternoon the Conference heard presentations on finance, which pointed out that G.S.O. has come to rely more and more on publishing income for group services and General Service Board activities, expenses that should be provided by group contributions. It was further noted in the presentations that publishing income is increasingly derived from non-A.A. sources, a situation that may potentially create Sixth Tradition problems.

In the past year, the General Service Board had maintained a self-support project, informing areas through the delegates of the details of the current shortfall in contributions. The 37th Conference noted with gratitude that the Fellowship has responded with increases of from 30% to 50% in contributions from last year's levels for the past five months. It was noted that a continuation of this trend for the next year and a half would essentially bring the Fellowship to a level of self-support from which the rates of increase enjoyed in the past, in proportion to the growth of the Fellowship, would suffice.

Sunday afternoon, after delegates had registered and received their badges and Conference Manuals, there was a small "ice-breaker" meeting in the Oval Room. Perhaps "icebreaker" is really a misnomer—as the instant friendship that is present whenever A.A.s get together, soon put everyone at ease. Susan Ulseth, Conference coordinator, welcomed Conference members and gave a brief run-down of the week to come and then introduced Conference delegate chairperson, Bill Miller, New York–Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire, who "was less nervous than last year." Bill turned the meeting over to the alternate chairperson Marc Pineau, Southwest Quebec, who chaired the meeting and introduced the speakers who did what A.A.s are most comfortable doing—shared their gratitude, told snatches of their stories, and expressed how they felt about attending the Conference. Speakers were: Real Bourgeois, Northwest Quebec delegate from Panel 36; Cheryl Ann Burke, G.S.O. staff member; Dr. Bill Flynn, Class A trustee; Gwen Fields, Panel 36, Idaho; Harold Greene, A.A.W.S. director; Don Pritts, Class B trustee and Arnes Sweet, Grapevine managing editor. Dr. John Norris, trustee emeritus, attending his 37th



Conference, received a standing ovation. "Dr. Jack" reminisced about the first General Service Conference (1951) when Bill Wilson shared with Dr. Jack Bill's feelings about rotation. Speaking to the first-term delegates Dr. Jack said, "do not be afraid to voice your concerns; A.A. is the only organization where a minority voice can change the tide." The last three speakers came out of the "hat"—David Smoot, Panel 37, District of Columbia; Greg Muth, Panel 37, Hawaii; and Louise Dumais-Adams, Panel 37 delegate from Connecticut.

Conference members often bring spouses, children or friends to New York and a Host Committee was available to see that these "significant others" were made comfortable and an agenda of activities was provided for those who wished to participate. Sunday afternoon the Host Committee held a get-acquainted tea at the Roosevelt. Throughout the week, Dorothy Conley and Margaret Dawson, New York A.A. members; Mary Bragg, wife of G.S.O.'s general manager; Eileen E., a representative from Al-Anon and other members of the Host Committee arranged and accompanied approximately 30 A.A. and Al-Anon spouses on a wide range of trips and activities. The group visited the United Nations, Al-Anon Family Group Headquarters, historic downtown New York (Trinity Church, the Stock Exchange, St. Paul's Chapel), the Statue of Liberty, and took a very special walk through Brooklyn Heights and passed by 182 Clinton Street, the former home of A.A. co-founder Bill Wilson and his wife Lois, the founder of Al-Anon.

On Sunday evening, Conference members, past trustees and former staff members, G.S.O. and Grapevine employees, and all who have worked for the General Service Office during the year (printers, volunteers, etc.) and their guests attended the pre-Conference banquet in the Roosevelt's Grand Ballroom. In the "old



Music before the opening dinner.

days" Bill frequently had a strolling guitarist and an open bar (for Class A trustees and nonalcoholic friends) at the pre-Conference dinner. This year a "coffee hour" preceded the dinner, with a pianist and a flutist playing cocktail music—no open bar! After dinner John Bragg, G.S.O. general manager, introduced Bill Wilson's beloved widow, Lois. After a standing ovation and warm applause Lois said: "It is lovely to be here with you lovely, lovely people. I'm sure Bill is enjoying the meeting too." An open A.A. meeting followed, chaired by Dave Roberts, Northern Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan. Tom Beebe, San Diego/Imperial, led the meeting. Speakers were Ed Cavin, Arizona; Frank Mauser, G.S.O. archivist; Leon Morehouse, Manitoba; Helen Turnquest, G.S.O. staff; and Jack Whitehouse, East Central regional trustee.

The first business session of the 37th Conference began on Monday morning in the Terrace Room. Gordon Patrick, chairperson of the General Service Board, officially opened the Conference and gave an overview of the activities of the General Service Board in the past year. At this opening session the agenda and procedures of the Conference were introduced to Conference members. John Bragg, G.S.O. general manager, called the roll, followed by a review of the agenda by Susan Ulseth, Conference coordinator, and opening remarks by delegate chairperson Bill Miller (see page 5). Wayne Parks, Class B trustee, gave the keynote address (see page 6).

Thus began an exceedingly busy week filled with committee meetings, presentation/discussion meetings (presentations begin on page 14), area highlights (see page 56) and a Delegates Only Dinner. Busy Conference members participated in two workshops (one during lunchtime): Unity — Let's Talk About It, and Living Sober — Growing Together or Apart.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference members voted to recommend the election of the following to the General Service Board: W.F. (Webb) Johnson as trustee-at-large, Canada; Jan Kelly Williamson, Southwest U.S. regional trustee and John Sharkey, Northeast U.S. regional trustee. They were elected at the May 2, 1987 meeting of the board after the close of Conference.

Beginning Thursday morning the fruits of the intensive work of the committee meetings were presented for discussion, rejection or approval by the entire Conference. With John Bragg at the podium, the delegate chairperson of each Conference committee presented the committee's recommendations. Then Conference members were free to come to the standing floor mikes and ask questions, disagree, add suggestions, share their area's concerns and experiences.

It is here, during the voting process, that the "ultimate authority" of Alcoholics Anonymous, as expressed through the informed group conscience of the entire Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada, emerges. One item on the Literature Committee's agenda: "Review service items for use at A.A. meetings regarding A.A.'s primary purpose," generated five hours of discussion on the Conference floor. Numerous votes were taken, the statements were reworded, rewritten, discussed and reviewed again.

Finally, the group conscience emerged and the two statements regarding our primary purpose, which will be used as a service piece, became a Conference Advisory Action.

All Advisory Actions of the 37th Conference may be found beginning on page 10, and the *Advisory Actions of the A.A. General Service Conference* (reflecting all actions from 1951 to 1986) is available from G.S.O.

One Conference member observed: "Gratitude smacks you in the face when you look out your hotel window late at night and see the street people asleep on the grates of the sidewalk and in the doorways. I wonder how many of them are still-suffering alcoholics?" One never knows — perhaps someday one of these street people will be a Conference member.

Friday afternoon, after the committee reports and Advisory Actions had been completed, the last presentation/discussion topic was: "Maintaining the Basics — A.A.'s Principles," reiterating once more what Alcoholics Anonymous is all about. The closing talk was given by Garrett Taylor, Class B trustee (see page 9). The 37th General Service Conference officially closed the way many A.A. meetings do—with the Serenity Prayer, but in English, Spanish and French.

Conference members met one last time, Saturday, at a closing brunch in the Terrace Room. This is always an emotion-packed morning. The pride of accomplishment and satisfaction for a job well-done is offset by the sadness of goodbyes to the trustees who are rotating off the General Service Board and to the outgoing Panel 36 delegates. Finally, there is the eagerness of the Panel 37 delegates as they return to their areas and prepare for the challenge of the 38th Conference in 1988.

After brunch, Conference members pushed back their chairs for the final program of the week, chaired by Gordon Patrick. Bill Miller of New York said that serving as delegate chairperson of the 37th General Service Conference had "been the highlight of my service life so far." Then Bill introduced Joyce Korner, Northeastern Ohio, who had been elected delegate chairperson for 1988. After commenting that, "So far, I have had 25 notes passed to me, but no dollars attached," Joyce said: "I am looking forward to new experiences and new changes. With your help and with God's, we will go forward."

In introducing the three rotating Class B trustees, Gordon Patrick spoke of the spirit of rotation and said that "every individual who walks in this door is special and has made a contribution."

Helen Harmon, trustee-at-large, Canada, said she was going home with no title—just as an ordinary A.A. member, and quoted a former trustee, the late Mac Cheeter, as saying the only retiring trustees who had trouble were those who had quit their home groups. Helen's husband will also be glad to have her unpack for good. When she first went into service work, he put a sign on either side of her suitcase and told her, "Just sit it the right way so I'll know if you're 'Coming' or 'Going.'"

Outgoing Southwest U.S. regional trustee, Wayne Parks, speaking of his term on the General Service Board, said, "As with everything else I've done in A.A.—I've been the winner," and finished by saying, "Our paths will cross as long as we stay in this Fellowship."

The last rotating trustee to speak was Garrett Taylor, Northeast U.S. regional, who commented that when he came here the Fellowship was "well structured, financially solvent and doing well spiritually" and "although most drunks can wreck things, I'm leaving it the same way. Let's be grateful for what we have and carry the message back."

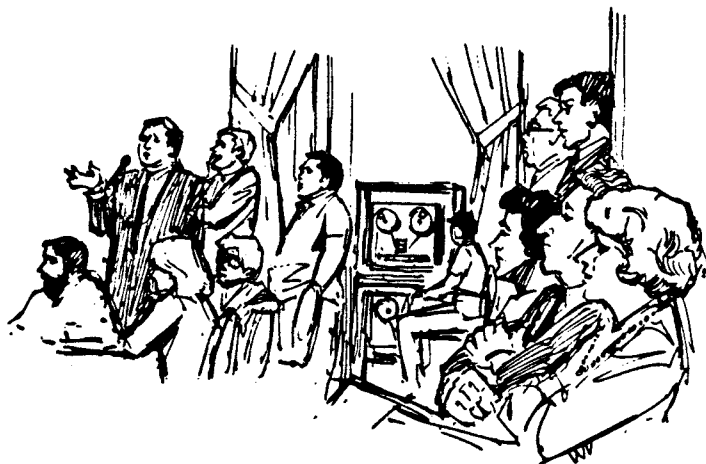
This final event of the 37th Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous closed with the Lord's Prayer. This Conference had dealt with many issues besides the Seventh Tradition and, true to the eleven other Traditions, it had reinforced the unity of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Welcome

I would like to share with you some of my experiences from my first Conference. I thought I had come prepared—I had re-read the Big Book, *A.A. Comes of Age, Twelve and Twelve, The A.A. Service Manual* and all previous Conference actions. I also talked to my service sponsor (who is a past delegate) and to other past delegates about their Conference experiences. After arriving here, it didn't take me long to find out that I was about to be part of a spiritual experience which I will never forget. It started Sunday with the dinner and lasted until after I had given my report at my area assembly. On Monday, as the Conference opened, I could feel the presence of a Higher Power working through each one of us. As the week progressed with reports, committee meetings, presentations, and sharing at meals, I could feel the unity growing stronger, and began to wonder how we could ever finish by noon on Saturday. I was told that by the end of the week, it would all come together and it did. The trip to Stepping Stones, home of Bill W. and Lois, was another experience I shall never forget. It seemed I could feel his presence all around, especially when sitting at his desk. On Thursday and Friday, committee reports were given and discussion followed. It was here that the Conference seemed to start to pull apart, but the presence of a Higher Power came through and agreement was achieved. Before we knew it, the Conference was over; we all grew a little bit. I left with the feeling Bill Wilson so aptly described as "a vision-stretching process."

Problems within the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous have been with us since the beginning. Our founders, Bill W. and Dr. Bob, have vested in us the safekeeping of our Fellowship. As we start this 37th General Service Conference, let us share to our fullest this week. If there is anything I can do to help any of you, please feel free to ask. We are all here for one purpose: to express our concern for our Fellowship. Let us have faith in a loving and guiding Higher Power, let us trust in our committee system, and in one another. The result will enable us to leave this Conference with a tremendous bond of unity—that unity and trust that continues to ensure the future of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Bill Miller, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire



Keynote Address

As we commence this 37th Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, I feel that it is important for us to note that we are now providing more services to the groups and members of the Fellowship than ever before in our 52-year history. Our Fellowship is growing at an accelerated rate and we are experiencing recognition and acceptance throughout the world as evidenced by the participation at the recent Ninth World Service Meeting in Guatemala. I think our co-founders would be very pleased if they were here today to know that our message of recovery is being carried as they envisioned it so many years ago.

Today is the beginning of my sixth General Service Conference and I would like to comment on some of the things that we are doing which indicate to me that we are responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. Those of us in service too often hear comments on what we are not doing or where we have been wrong or that some things are not being done properly, when in reality we are serving more needs of the Fellowship in carrying the message than at any other time in our history. For example, in the last year, we have made contact with the Native American population in several areas, but none that was more productive than the meeting with the Navajos in Chinle, Arizona. The delegates from New Mexico and Arizona, along with a G.S.O. staff person and two trustees shared a weekend with some Navajos who were trying to get A.A. established on the reservation. Hopefully the message that was conveyed was that we wanted them to be a part of, rather than separate from, A.A. as a whole. Having been one of the trustees who attended, I can say that it was one of the most enjoyable weekends of sharing the A.A. message that I have ever experienced. Sometimes the greatest need is under our very nose and we are so busy trying to carry the message 10,000 miles away that we miss a whole segment of our population. Hopefully, we will continue to make ourselves available to our native population because if there was ever a need for our message of recovery, it is with this group of people.

Another segment of our population that has been addressed for the last two years is our young people in A.A. Here again, two trustees as well as the chairperson of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous attended the International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous. To say that these young people are enthusiastic is the understatement of the century. In my opinion, the potential of this segment of the A.A. population is limited *only* by the lack of participation at all levels



Busy lobby of the Hotel Roosevelt.

of our Fellowship. We must encourage these young people to be a part of, rather than separate from, A.A. as a whole. We have the opportunity to have the best informed, most dedicated and most enthusiastic servants this Fellowship has ever known. It is up to us to make available every bit of knowledge we can to prepare them for the enjoyable way of life we have found in serving this Fellowship.

Some other items of importance that I think should be pointed out is some of the work that our General Service Office has been involved in over the last year, which we tend to forget once we leave this Conference. A partial list is as follows: (1) New quarters on the 11th floor have been acquired and refurbished where the Grapevine now resides. (2) Renovation and space requirements are being addressed on the other floors. (3) The first seminar of central offices and intergroups was held in Chicago this year and was initiated by G.S.O. (4) Two new films, one for the young people and another for correctional facilities, have been completed and are ready for your approval this week. (5) We have published one of the most difficult, but most appreciated, pamphlets, "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated." (6) The Self-Support Project.

All of this has been accomplished while continuing to do the routine jobs such as answering the 10,000 letters a month we receive, planning the 1990 Convention, planning and attending four or five Regional Forums, plans for the future needs of the office and the many other things that must be done to keep our Fellowship functioning.

Our other corporation, the Grapevine, has also been busy publishing their monthly magazine while finding time to go through an operational efficiency study by outside consultants. All this, in addition to making new tapes and books available to the Fellowship. What makes this all the more commendable is they have been operating without a managing editor since January of this year.

All of the things I have been talking about up to this point have been an attempt to make you aware of the many things our Fellowship is doing in order to carry the message of recovery, which requires money.

As you know, our theme for this Conference is "The Seventh Tradition — A Turning Point." Obviously, we are talking about money and I have yet to meet an alcoholic who does not have a deep and abiding love for it as well as a deep conviction that he or she is an expert in fiscal management. However, I do not think most of us got here because of our expertise in this area of our lives. The issue of self-support is the tradition that has saved our Fellowship, thanks to Mr. Rockefeller.

All of you have received information on our self-support project. From all indications, your response has been phenomenal, but I would like to point out that our primary need is for wider participation by the groups rather than an increase in money from those groups already participating in contributions to group services. It is only by increasing the *number* of groups contributing that we can achieve real self-support. Invariably, the first question that is asked after talking about self-support is, "What is going to happen if we get more money than we need?" I think the answer to that question has already been demonstrated by the recent notice in Box 4-5-9 which grants a 4% discount on all literature purchases of \$25 or more. This discount was effective April 1, 1987, to all purchasers. As the contributions increase, so do the discounts which very effectively keep us from accumulating too much money.

The question of accumulating too much money in the Reserve Fund keeps coming up from various areas. I think you will find that during this Conference, the trustees' Finance Committee will be making a report to you addressing several areas of concern. One other thing you might not think about in connection with the Reserve Fund is the cost of refurbishing our offices; work that is now in progress. This cost is paid directly from the Reserve Fund, so I do not foresee any great problems in the future of having too much money, as long as we continue to grow and provide the services which the Fellowship asks of us.

If I have been guilty of preaching at you, I must apologize, but over the years that I have been involved in the Conference process, I have gained even more respect for the wisdom of our co-founders and our Higher Power in shaping a Conference structure that has worked so beautifully in the past and without a doubt, will continue to do so in the future.

Again, I must reiterate the importance of participation at all levels of service. The Conference structure works, and what we must do is show up when we are asked to and allow our Higher Power to guide us in carrying our message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic. After all, that is what all of this is about—one drunk helping another.

Wayne Parks, Southwest U.S. regional trustee

What's On Your Mind?

A "What's On Your Mind?" sharing session was held Thursday evening, April 30. At that time, Conference members had an opportunity to bring up for discussion and input other matters of concern to them and the areas they represent. There was a good deal of sharing on a variety of subjects.

The manner in which Canadian contributions are reported was the first order of business. The request was made that such contributions be listed in A.A. directories and other places in real Canadian dollars and not, as presently done, converted into American dollars. It was felt that such reporting would be of great help to Canadian members of the Fellowship. The G.S.O. general manager indicated that he saw no reason why such a procedure could not be followed and that the matter will be looked into.

The subject of the A.A. membership survey was then brought to the floor. One delegate expressed concern that some groups selected in her area for the sampling survey were not as responsible and service-oriented as others which might have been picked and she wondered if there was some way in which those selected to receive questionnaires could be switched. G.S.O. general manager John Bragg noted that until 1983 delegates had been sent packages of survey questionnaires and it was the responsibility of the delegates to determine which groups would complete the questionnaires. However, many felt that such a process did not constitute random selection. Therefore, in 1983, a statistician from the State University of New York in Albany was consulted regarding a stratified random survey. The outcome was that the survey process is now one of oversampling so that even if half the groups involved did not return questionnaires or ceased to exist, the survey would still be valid. The 1986 survey was also done in this manner. It was also pointed out that the purpose of the survey is not to give a good result for a particular area, but rather is designed to give an overall result for the United States and Canada, which it does.

Discussion then turned to the multilith copies of the original manuscript of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*. One delegate expressed his feeling that many members in his area are using this original manuscript which is not Conference-approved in place of the Big Book. Since both are not the same, he would like to see the sale of this piece by the A.A. Archives stopped. The G.S.O. archivist reported that approximately 800 to 1,000 copies of these manuscripts are sold each year and it is offered in the context of an historically interesting document. The matter was directed to the trustees' Archives Committee for further study and the Conference will be informed of the outcome.

The question was then raised as to whether the General Service Office has looked into the possibility of obtaining an 800 number for literature orders. The matter has already been studied by G.S.O. and it was learned that in addition to standard charges, such items as employee salaries and benefits are locked into cost figures for such a number. These expenses would have to be reflected in literature prices. Additionally, 800 number orders also lead to charge orders which lead to the question of credit extension. Credit card orders can lead to bad debts for which the Fellowship would be responsible. Further, credit card companies charge a fee for the privilege of doing business. It is felt at the present time that A.A. has always been successful on a "pay as you go" basis and the General Service Office is reluctant to give credit to groups, who, in turn, should be reluctant to take it.

There was much discussion revolving around the central office/intergroup seminar concept, the first of which was held in September 1986 in Chicago. Some of the questions raised were: What was the purpose of the Seminar? Who was invited to attend? How much did it cost? What subjects were discussed? Is a full report available?

The G.S.O. group services coordinator indicated that the primary reason seminars were instituted was to provide a forum for A.A.W.S. to discuss with some of its largest literature customers its services to them and how they can be improved. And, in this context, the \$12,500 spent on the 1986 Seminar was indeed minute when compared with both revenue from the literature sales to central offices and intergroups and the opportunity for communication provided by the Seminar. It was pointed out that in Spring 1986, G.S.O. advised Panel 35 and 36 delegates that a seminar was being considered. A letter was sent to central offices/intergroups, inquiring whether or not managers, secretaries, and/or steering committee members saw the need for such a meeting and, if so, would a representative attend. Subjects covered included: A.A.W.S. literature pricing and shipping practices; volume discounts and bulk shipments; warehouse distribution; inventory problems and solutions; prudent reserves, group contributions and fund raisers. A report of the 1986 Seminar was sent to Panel 36 delegates and is available to any A.A. member who requests a copy.

Among the many lovely ladies at the pre-Conference dinner, Aleda, wife of Greg Muth, delegate from Hawaii, stood out. Aleda, also an A.A. member, wore a native muu muu, with a hauku lei of carnations, fern leaves and baby's breath around her neck and in her hair. Aleda and Greg came to New York with their children — Reannon, four years and Sterling, 13 months — a feat that requires remarkable serenity!

One delegate questioned whether we are planning to hold intergroup/central office conferences in addition to the General Service Conference. Or, should such meetings be held within the area committee structure? Another delegate indicated that in her area such seminars seem to be setting up a power base for intergroups and central offices and that such concerns should be addressed.

The matter of prudent reserves being maintained by central and intergroup offices was raised and some delegates felt that it should be looked at. It was indicated that in some areas, intergroups sell just about everything, including non-A.A. literature, and much of their profit is placed in prudent reserve funds.

As a result of a previous Conference action, central/intergroup offices should check with area delegates before distributing confidential A.A. directories to those outside the Fellowship. One delegate felt that this procedure is not always followed, and suggested that G.S.O. remind central offices and intergroups about the procedures.

Regarding the paper quality currently used by the A.A. Grapevine, one delegate expressed the opinion that the magazine was now less enjoyable to read. Another delegate felt that the covers and contents were not up to the old standards. Grapevine staff indicated that the weight of the paper on which the magazine is printed was reduced as a means of cutting mailing costs. The Grapevine staff has always been and now remains open to any suggestions that will make it a better magazine for the Fellowship.

A procedure was also suggested regarding new groups. One delegate felt that it would be most helpful if the General Service Office would notify the area delegate of new groups prior to issuing group service numbers. In this way, the delegate and D.C.M. could make contact with the group, visit and review guidelines, furnish a group handbook, assist the new G.S.R. and, in general, enable the new group to be more informed about the total A.A. structure. It was noted that a Conference action requires that groups requesting group service numbers be given them. However, it might prove feasible to set up a system whereby delegates are given more frequent feedback relative to new groups formed in their areas. This type of system might also correct the problem of A.A. meetings that are registering as A.A. groups at G.S.O.

Regarding the self-support challenge, one delegate felt that some of the D.C.M.s did not fully understand the paper "The Challenge of the Seventh Tradition," and got the impression that "we were going down the tubes." He further indicated a need exists which is far broader than the one presented in the Challenge paper and he would like to see a simplified form. A summary of the Challenge paper is available from G.S.O.

Dan Byrne, West Central regional trustee, noting the absence of a Conference International Convention Committee, requested a Conference Action on a 1986 recommendation of the trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums. The recommendation read:

"The committee further recommended that the 1987 General Service Conference recommend that the 1988 General Service Conference select three cities for the 1995 International Convention and that the Conference Site Selection Committee should select the Convention site for the 1995 International Convention in 1988."

The recommendation was read to the Conference, a motion was made to accept the recommendation, and the motion was approved and seconded.

Concern was expressed by a delegate about what he perceived as a lack of honest sharing and open communication among staff, trustees and other Conference members. His suggestion to generate more honest and open sharing among all Conference participants was to schedule a "What's On Your Mind?" session earlier during the Conference week. Other possible solutions to this problem included: (1) small group sharing meetings between Conference participants early on during Conference week; (2) more communication between trustees and Conference committee members during the year and during Conference week; (3) for all participants to have faith in the system and be mindful that the Conference is no place for smallness or gossip; (4) to remember that we must trust in order to be trustworthy; and (5) that perhaps more "hugging" sessions would help to make a difference. On the other side of the coin, some delegates shared that they had experienced none of these feelings and were quite happy with the Conference and what takes place during Conference week. All of these suggestions, including another suggestion that Conference agenda items should come from delegates only, will be taken back to the Conference Agenda Committee for consideration.

The session ended at 10:00 p.m. All those delegates who were interested in reviewing financial statements or had questions relative to financial matters were invited to remain behind after the session to discuss their concerns with John Bragg and Ed Gordon. (That session ended at 11:00 p.m.)



Closing Talk

I know you are very mentally, physically, and emotionally exhausted from this busy week and you are looking forward to the free time you certainly deserve. You know, the turning point in my life began on a wintry night in 1950. The ground was covered with ice and snow. My wife, Marguerite, was very upset because I was later than usual in making my drunken appearance. Eventually, she opened the front door, and I fell on the living room floor. My head was a bloody mess. I do not remember how I got home or how I got the head injury.

I was treated by the family doctor that night, so I am told. I didn't go to work the next day. I received a phone call from the family doctor. He told me of a group of ex-drunks who met at the Y.M.C.A. on Sunday nights at 8:30. They were successful in getting many drunks like me on the road to recovery. I told Marguerite about the call and promised to attend the next meeting. This was another broken promise. My drinking got worse. I became involved in many disastrous and embarrassing situations, like setting the house on fire. You name it, and I did it.

I bottomed out six years later. Somehow, I remembered the meeting the family doctor told me about. I attended my first A.A. meeting in May 1956 at the Cosmopolitan Group, founded by Dr. Jim S., whose story appears in the second and third editions of the Big Book under the title "Jim's Story." If you would read pages 316 and 317 of *Pass It On*, you would see that the situation for people like me was much different than it is today. The Fellowship has changed for the better. It is reaching out to all minorities, including Native Americans, the hearing- and visually-impaired, other language groups, and all who need and want the hand of A.A. I pray that our 100th anniversary will continue to meet the needs of all of us, as well as, if not better than, today.

You know, we recovering drunks most often experience some crisis before we act. It seems that we must bottom out before we can do anything positive. Just recently, it took the copyright misfortune to motivate the Fellowship to produce the popular soft-cover, pocket-size Big Book, and it will be a similar crisis that brings about a turning point for the Seventh Tradition.

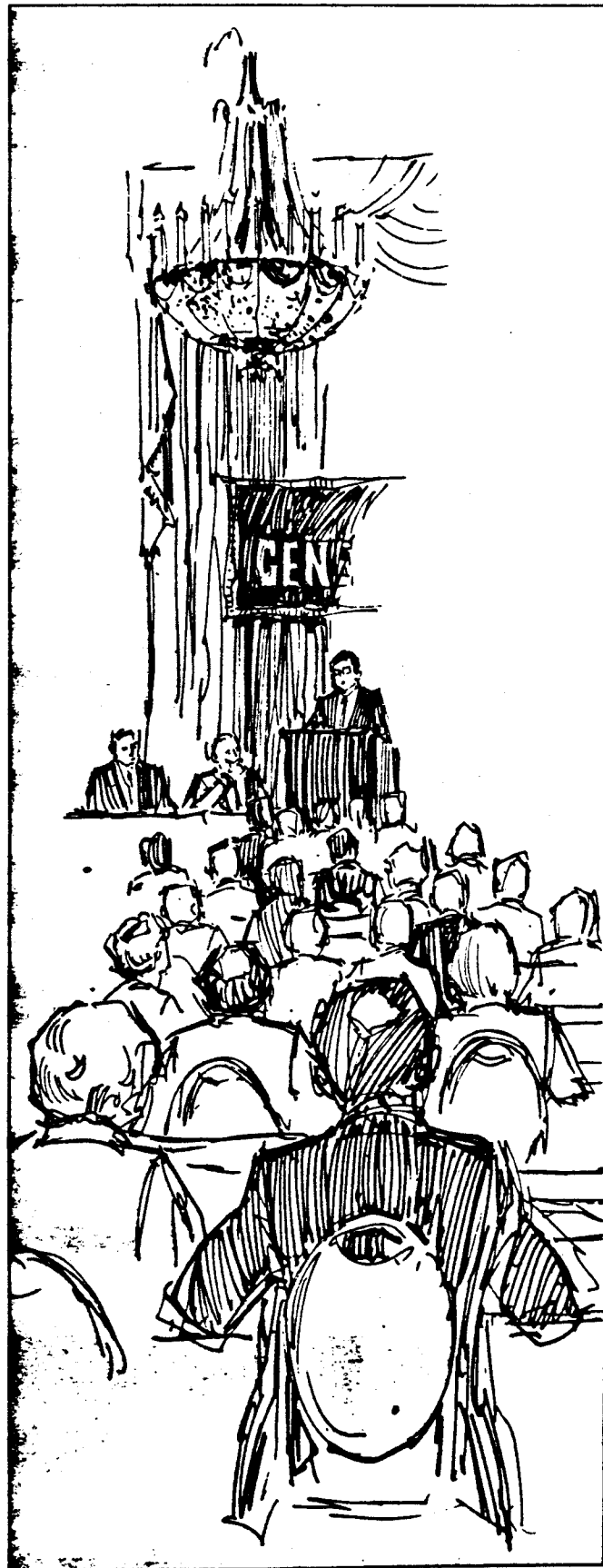
I am sure that all of us assembled here are enthusiastically committed to the challenge of self-support more than we were when I was a Panel 27 delegate. The Fellowship was not self-supporting then. Non-A.A. buyers were purchasing 15% of A.A. literature. Today, just nine years later, the percentage is three times higher. Our number one priority ought to be to reverse this trend.

Love, service, and action are the keys to our progress. Trying to live by the Three Legacies the best we can ought to be our goal. "Let us also remember to guard that erring member, the tongue, and if we must use it, let's use it with kindness and consideration and tolerance."

I leave you now with the faith and trust that the present trusted servants and the trusted servants to come will continue to abide by our 1970 Declaration of Unity: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; to keep our fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives, and the lives of those to come." (*The A.A. Service Manual*)

I am glad to leave the Fellowship in your hands. As for me, I am still a grateful alcoholic. A.A. might not add years to my life. I can surely say it has added life to my years. Thank you for your attention, and may God's grace always continue to shine on you.

Garrett Taylor, Northeast U.S. regional trustee



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference. Additional topics that each Conference committee discussed, but took no action on, will be reported in the History and Actions of Conference Committees; available from G.S.O. upon request.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 1 The 1988 General Service Conference select three cities for the 1995 International Convention; and that the Convention Site Selection Committee not determine its preference for first, second or third choice and that the top three cities be given equal consideration by the 1988 General Service Conference. The final selection of the site will be made by the General Service Board in July 1988, following an inspection trip by the Convention Site Selection Committee.
- 2 A report on the progress of The History of A.A.: 1955-1985 book be made to the 1988 General Service Conference.
- 3 The consideration of inviting intergroups and central offices into the general service structure be referred to the Agenda Committee for the 1988 Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 4 The format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the 38th General Service Conference consist of the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee as leader to introduce five speakers: One Class B trustee, two delegates, two A.A. members rotating from the following (G.S.O. staff, Grapevine staff, Archives or of the Corporate Boards); and that their talks be limited to ten minutes each.

There be a light system on the podium; the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be designated as chairperson of the A.A. meeting and that his or her duties be limited to introducing the leader and monitoring the time of the A.A. meeting.

- 5 "Self-Support" be a presentation/discussion topic for the next five years, in keeping with the spirit of the Seventh Tradition.
- 6 The theme of the 38th General Service Conference be "Our Singleness of Purpose—Key to Unity."

Wedding Bells at Conference

Saturday, before the Conference began, "Pete" Peterson, Panel 37 Northeast Texas, took time out to marry Linda Thomas, G.S.R. for the Compass Group, Irving, Texas, at New York's Fifth Avenue Presbyterian Church. It was a real "A.A. wedding" with Class A trustee John King officiating and Northwest Texas delegate Bonnie Taylor as matron-of-honor.

- 7 A workshop topic be on the theme "Our Singleness of Purpose—Key to Unity." A second workshop be scheduled, if time permits, with the subject to be determined at the trustees' Conference Committee's discretion.

- 8 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1988 Conference:

- A Self-Support
- B Singleness of Purpose—Key to Unity
 - 1 Groups vs. Meetings
 - 2 Are We Being Too Friendly With Our Friends?
 - 3 Our Primary Purpose/Is Our Message Clear?
- C Focus On the Positive
 - 1 Communications-Challenges
 - 2 What Are We Doing Right?
 - 3 Spirit Of Rotation

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 9 The C.P.C. staff person write to all area assembly chairpersons to gather information on their interest in having tabletop exhibits and the areas' desire to purchase them.
- 10 The title of the pamphlet "A Clergyman Asks" be changed to "The Clergy Asks" when it comes up for reprint.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 11 The 16-minute video based on the pamphlet, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," be produced for distribution to the Fellowship, with the following deletions: (a) "in this film" be eliminated from the opening statement, and (b) "A.A." in credit 4, page 7 of the script, be eliminated.

The video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" be produced with closed captions for the hearing-impaired, at a cost not exceeding \$1,500.

- 12 The finalized draft of the pamphlet, "Memo to an Inmate Who May be an Alcoholic," be accepted for distribution to the Fellowship as presented, with the following addition to page 29 under "What A.A. Does Not Do": "No. 14. Furnish initial motivation for alcoholics to recover."

- 13 The Institutions Correspondence Service not be dissolved at this time.

- 14 The General Service Office take such steps as are necessary to avoid delay in the Institutions Correspondence Service's response from G.S.O.

- 15 All areas be encouraged to begin working in the direction of establishing an area institutions correspondence service, coordinating this with G.S.O., as necessary.

- 16 The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities find a method of adapting the film "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" into the Spanish language.

- 17 The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider the feasibility of adapting the film "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" into the French language.

- 18 A recommendation to develop a simplified "Twelve Steps Illustrated" pamphlet to carry the message to the illiterate inmate was not accepted by the Conference.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

19 The "Supporting the A.A. Support System" pamphlet be revised as follows:

- a On the first page, change the type style for "group expenses" to bold face.
- b On the fourth page (the last illustration and description); change the current "40% to G.S.O." and "60% to Area Committee" to "30% to G.S.O., 30% to Area Committee, 40% to District."

20 The concept of the self-support communications plan be approved; the plan is to provide self-support information and tools to D.C.M.s and other service people in the Fellowship.

21 The objectives of the five-year plan be approved and reviewed monthly; the plan projects increased contributions and periodic literature price decreases, which would make A.A. self-supporting in five years or less.

22 No change in delegates' fees be made at this time, but that this matter be considered again by the 1988 Conference.

23 The Conference Committee on Finance reviewed the auditor's report on the General Service Reserve Fund which states, in his opinion, "that the balance of Reserve Fund at December 31, 1986 is adequate to meet any adverse events which can be foreseen at the present time."

The Committee recommends the acceptance of the auditor's opinion that the Reserve Fund is adequate at this time.

24 The 1977 Conference Advisory Action which reads:

"It was recommended that a prudent reserve be established equal to the preceding year's operating expense of the combined expenses of the General Service Board of A.A., A.A. World Services, Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (with the exception of extraordinary expenses); and that the auditing firm be requested to

review and comment annually on the availability, feasibility, and adequacy of this reserve."

Be amended to replace the phrase "equal to" by the phrase "not to exceed."

And that a lower limit to the fund not be provided inasmuch as the auditor is required to comment on the adequacy of the fund.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

25 Staff monitor ongoing distribution of Spanish and French Grapevine cassette tapes and report fuller results to the 1988 Conference.

26 No changes or additions be made to the Preamble.

27 Delegates focus their efforts on the district service structure as a means of reaching individual groups, in order to make every group aware of the value of the Grapevine as a recovery tool.

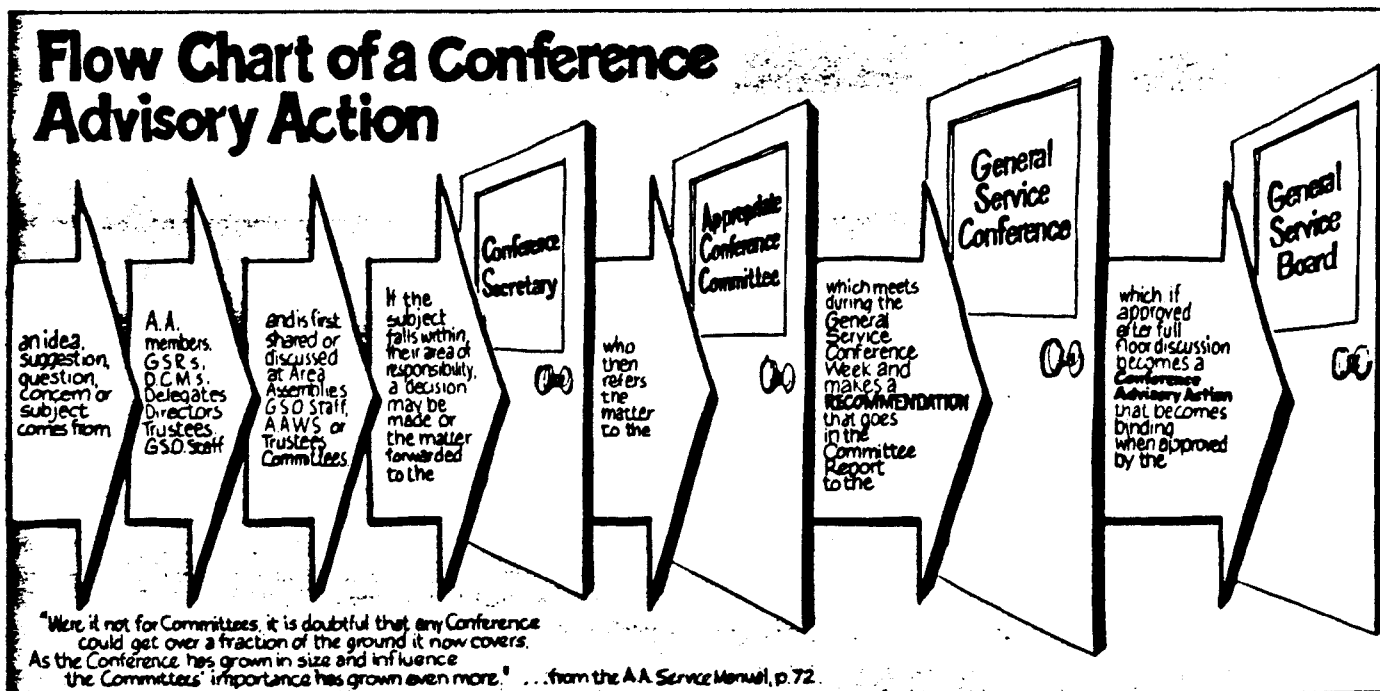
28 Delegates and area Grapevine chairpersons be encouraged to invite Grapevine staff personnel to attend local, area, and regional conventions, forums, and A.A. gatherings.

29 The Grapevine staff be responsible for communicating updated information to the delegates at appropriate intervals regarding editorial, circulation/fulfillment, and financial matters.

30 In view of the need for the entire Grapevine operation to be fully accountable to the Fellowship, the committee recognizes serious management problems and believes them to be the responsibility of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

The Grapevine Board establish a mechanism for timely communications to all Conference members of actions taken and progress toward resolution of these problems.

31 A disclaimer be prepared by Grapevine staff for the calendar of events and be printed before each month's listing of coming events.



LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

32 The following statement regarding A.A.'s primary purpose be available as an A.A. service piece.

This Is a Closed Meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous

This is a closed meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. In support of A.A.'s singleness of purpose, attendance at closed meetings is limited to persons who have a desire to stop drinking. If you think you have a problem with alcohol, you are welcome to attend this meeting. We ask that when discussing our problems, we confine ourselves to those problems, as they relate to alcoholism.

33 The following statement regarding A.A.'s primary purpose be available as an A.A. service piece.

This Is an Open Meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous

This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here—especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking," we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol.

34 The updated manuscript for "Too Young?" be approved.

35 Because of insufficient expressed need, no large-print literature for the visually impaired be prepared at this time.

36 Although there is some desire to publish the first 181 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in soft-cover, there is not sufficient need at this time.

37 The trustees' Literature Committee undertake development of a daily reflections book based on individual A.A.'s (including Bill W.'s) sharing based on the Traditions and Steps, and that a progress report be submitted to the 1988 Conference Literature Committee.

38 A pamphlet for the Native North American be prepared by the trustees' Literature Committee and brought back to the 1988 General Service Conference.

39 The Grapevine Corporate Board consider publishing a special issue written by Native North Americans and devoted to their recovery stories.

40 The following editorial changes be made in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet:

Since a number of groups send their inventories to G.S.O. that are mainly helpful only to themselves, the parenthetical sentence on page 34, "(If your group tries an inventory, please let G.S.O. know the results.)" be changed to read: "(Please share with G.S.O. those benefits of your group's inventory which might be of help to other groups.)"

To reaffirm A.A.'s purpose as stated by our co-founder, Bill W.'s writings on "Single Purpose" as they appear on page 304 in "As Bill Sees It" be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.

The phrase on page 25 that reads:

"... the stigma attached by ignorant people to our illness ..." be changed to read "the stigma attached by people ignorant of our illness ..."

The phrase on page 30 that reads: "Most of us do not want to cater to the cruel stigma unjustly attached by ignorant people ..." be changed to "Most of us do not want to cater to the cruel stigma unjustly attached by people ignorant of ..."

The phrase on page 33 that reads: "On the other hand, specialized groups — men's, women's, gays' ..." be changed to read "On the other hand, specialized gatherings — men's, women's, gays' ..." because, although the intent was to use the word group in a generic sense, its use confuses the issue about the difference between a meeting and a group.

41 In the pamphlet "44 Questions," page 19, the language be changed to read "Most members arrange to attend meetings as frequently as possible," rather than "Most members arrange to attend at least one meeting a week."

42 The trustees' Literature Committee further explore the need for simplified material for those with limited vocabularies and report its findings to the 1988 Conference.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

43 The area chairperson from Eastern Massachusetts be seated as a Conference member, since neither the delegate nor the alternate delegate from that area is able to attend.

44 The 39th General Service Conference be scheduled for April 23-29, 1989. These dates will not conflict with Easter or Passover.

45 While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area Archives and Archives committees, with the resulting benefit to General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local Archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office Archivist.

46 The 1982 Policy Committee Advisory Action:

"Each Conference Committee carefully consider their Agenda Items and strive to make their recommendations for Advisory Actions to the Conference at the Policy Level,"

be reaffirmed; and this Advisory Action of 1982 be read by each Conference Committee chairperson at the opening of the Conference Committee meetings.

47 To be more financially responsible, when a Conference Committee recommendation involves a substantial expenditure of money, an estimate of costs be part of that recommendation.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

48 The flyer, one-way display, and poster "The A.A. Member" be updated to reflect the findings from the 1986 Membership Survey.

49 The film targeting young people be approved for completion and distribution; and videocassette versions of the film be closed-captioned for the hearing-impaired.

50 The trustees' Committee on Public Information explore the feasibility of adapting the new film targeting young people into Spanish and French.

51 The graphics in the flyer "A Message to Teenagers" be updated with the new graphics from "Too Young?"

REPORT and CHARTER

It was recommended that:

52 An eleventh chapter about the Grapevine be included in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

53 Article 2 of The Conference Charter, page 24, paragraphs 2 and 3, of *The A.A. Service Manual* be changed to read:

"Foreign lands in many cases have created autonomous General Service Conferences of their own, which rely on the Steps and Traditions protected by the Conference (U.S. and Canada) and in other ways often turn to the actions of the Conference for guidance.

"Consultation between conferences is encouraged. And a formal meeting—the World Service Meeting—of delegates from the various conferences is held once every two years. The U.S./Canada delegates are chosen from the General Service Board.

"In countries where a General Service structure exists, the U.S./Canada Conference will delegate sole right to publish our Conference-approved literature to the General Service Board of the structure.

"Only matters seriously affecting A.A.'s worldwide needs shall be the subject of joint consideration."

(In addition, this article was referred to the 1988 Conference Report and Charter Committee for further consideration.)

54 The second paragraph on page 25 of the *A.A. Service Manual* (1987-'88 edition) be changed to read:

"It will be further understood, regardless of the legal prerogatives of the General Service Board, as a matter of tradition, that a three-quarters vote of all Conference members may bring about a reorganization of the General Service Board and the directors and staff members of its corporate services, if or when such a reorganization is deemed essential."

55 Paragraph 4, page 98 (after The Twelve Concepts) in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1986-'87 edition) be deleted.

56 No change be made at this time in the definition of an A.A. group in the A.A. Directories.

57 In an effort to improve area response to annual group printout mailing from G.S.O.

A summary sheet of the total group changes in the area be sent with the cover letter.

A cutoff date for the printouts be extended to a later date (March 15th).

The title page of the directory be changed to indicate a split-level year, i.e., 1987-'88.

Printouts returned from the areas to G.S.O. should have group changes clearly indicated.

58 The 1986 Conference Action regarding the directories not listing "Double-trouble" groups be reaffirmed, i.e. "Double-trouble groups not be listed in the A.A. Directories;" and the existing

Delegates Kathy Jarchow of Oregon and Gwen Fields of Idaho got "buzzed" and stopped by a security guard as they were leaving a store. Gwen says she was indignant for a moment (thinking to herself, "Don't they know who I am?"). She regained her composure after a few minutes and the cashier discovered she had left a tag on one of Gwen's purchases.

Double-trouble groups in the A.A. Directories be deleted. (Double-trouble groups are defined as groups with outside affiliation.)

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

59 The following phrase in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers," "Since A.A.'s co-founders first got sober by carrying the A.A. message into treatment centers . . ." be changed to read: "Since one of the ways A.A.'s co-founders helped maintain their sobriety was by carrying the A.A. message into hospitals . . ."

60 The report, developed in response to the 1986 General Service Conference recommendation that the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities study ways to develop contact sponsorship programs, be returned to the trustees' Committee to develop a service piece to be added to the *Treatment Facilities Workbook*. Also, that the trustees' Committee prepare this service piece using only shared experience that reflects strict adherence to the Traditions. (Some of the sharing in the initial report reflected violations of the Traditions.) Also that the service piece include sharing from both successful and unsuccessful contact sponsorship programs and that the format include sharing that reflects contact sponsorship programs in various stages of development.

61 The word "larger" be deleted from the *Scope* section of the *Composition, Scope and Procedure*. The revised *Scope* will read as follows: The purpose of a treatment facilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups who are interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in treatment facilities, and to set up means of "bridging the gap" from the facility to the A.A. community.

62 The 1986 Conference Action that "each area treatment facilities committee conduct workshops, as frequently as needed, to effectively utilize the *Treatment Facilities Workbook*" be reaffirmed. Also, that the workshops include groups and district committees.

63 The 1986 Conference Action that "treatment facilities committees send liaisons to other service entities' meetings in their area and, in turn invite them to send liaisons to the treatment facilities committee meetings" be reaffirmed.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

64 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in May 1987 [see page 49; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee].

65 The following directors for the A.A. World Services Board be elected [see page 74; slate of directors approved].

66 The following directors for the Grapevine Board be elected [see page 74; slate of directors approved].

67 The Conference reaffirm the 1985 Conference Action using the word *only* in "Résumés for trustee candidates be sent to G.S.O. by area delegate *only* . . ."

68 We continue with the current practice of selecting directors for both A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards, but that the positions should not necessarily be restricted to residents of New York City and vicinity.

69 A director serving on the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Board not be a candidate for regional trustee or trustee-at-large.

Presentations Cover a Wide Range of Concerns

FINANCE — THE SEVENTH TRADITION

The first presentation/discussion of the 1987 Conference took place on Monday afternoon. The topic was of vital concern to Conference members in considering A.A.'s future. Joe Phelan, Southeast U.S. regional trustee, moderated and gave some opening remarks.

Self-Support — An Idea Whose Time Has Come

At this point in our history, A.A. has a golden opportunity to involve all of our groups and all of our members in the goal of becoming, over the next five years, fully self-supporting by our individual and group contributions.

This is the theme of our 37th General Service Conference, the Seventh Tradition (the self-supporting Tradition). Among other important issues, we will have the opportunity this week to fully share, absorb, discuss and understand this effort which affects every level of service in Alcoholics Anonymous. We are all asked to give our best to A.A. and in return we know from our experience in recovery that A.A. will give back to us tenfold.

The problem, its history, and the present situation are all in the Challenge letter from A.A. World Services which each of our Conference members, D.C.M.s, intergroups, past trustees, and past delegates have. Already many have started to share the response in our districts, area assemblies, and regional forums. All of us, I hope, can agree that full participation as a result of full communication can help make this important effort work.

The problem of which we speak is not an isolated one. It is part of a broader failure of all A.A. members to fully understand what we belong to, to treasure each of our Traditions, and to support A.A. at all levels of service with our contributions. Its solution can be a rallying point for us all, and can increase the informed group conscience everywhere.

Happily, this problem has a solution. The solution lies in putting all of A.A.—not only our groups, districts, assemblies, central offices and intergroups, but our General Service Board and our

General Service Office as well—in a financial position of self-sufficiency within the next five years. To succeed, voluntary contributions must cover annual and projected expenses of the General Service Board, including G.S.O., without any dollars being transferred from A.A.'s publishing operation. Then our literature can be offered at a lower price to everyone.

This effort requires that each member of A.A. understand that self-support goes to the heart of Alcoholics Anonymous spiritually and practically, for we understand that our Traditions (including the Seventh) keep us unified and able to carry the total message to the suffering alcoholic.

We are most grateful for our Traditions and principles which have served us well since 1946 when A.A. had a membership under 25,000. Today, with a membership conservatively estimated at 60 times that figure, our basic unity remains strong. For that I thank God and the Traditions which guide us.

The mosaic which is A.A. is comprised of members who are all alcoholics with a single purpose: to stay sober and to carry the message to the suffering alcoholic. We have a clear program of recovery embodied in the Twelve Steps. Anonymity continues to be practiced with very few exceptions. We know our Traditions will continue to guide us.

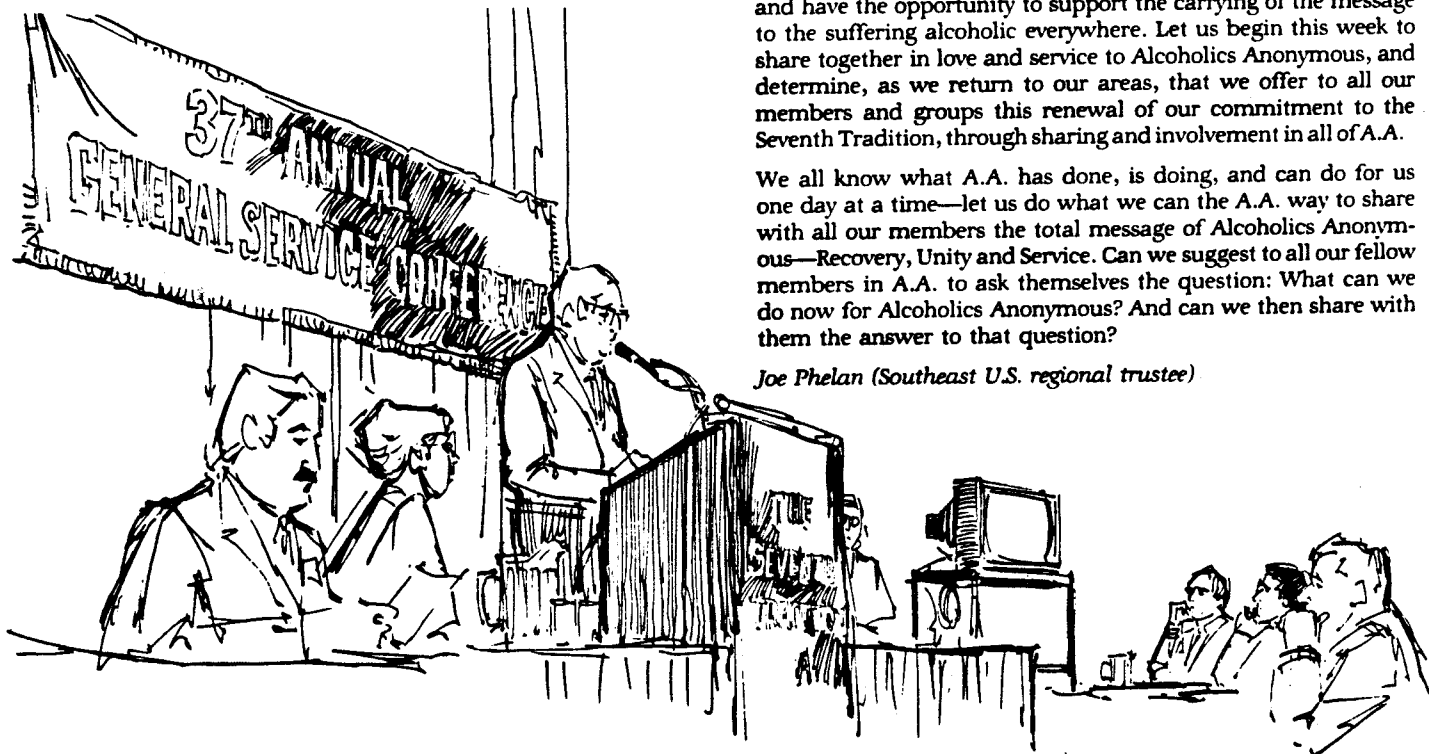
The short history of the Washingtonian Movement between 1840 and 1850 tells us how important our basic truths have been and still are today. As we know, the Washingtonians did not have the benefit of a set of traditions about matters we know to be so crucial, and the movement collapsed after so much early promise.

We, on the other hand, have a system of communication with unique strength. Let us use this system—the reaching out of one alcoholic to another—to reaffirm our adherence to the Traditions. We ought to be, everywhere in A.A., self-supporting through our own contributions.

Let us invite all of our members, through our system of communication, to participate and share together so that all are informed and have the opportunity to support the carrying of the message to the suffering alcoholic everywhere. Let us begin this week to share together in love and service to Alcoholics Anonymous, and determine, as we return to our areas, that we offer to all our members and groups this renewal of our commitment to the Seventh Tradition, through sharing and involvement in all of A.A.

We all know what A.A. has done, is doing, and can do for us one day at a time—let us do what we can the A.A. way to share with all our members the total message of Alcoholics Anonymous—Recovery, Unity and Service. Can we suggest to all our fellow members in A.A. to ask themselves the question: What can we do now for Alcoholics Anonymous? And can we then share with them the answer to that question?

Joe Phelan (Southeast U.S. regional trustee)



Report on Self-Support Project

In 1967 Bill W. wrote in a Grapevine article on the A.A. Tradition of self-support, "Both these principles we understand: That A.A. wants no charity; that we support our own services. We understand—but sometimes we forget."

Nearly every Conference to date has addressed, in one way or another, the need for self-support through contributions. Each of you was sent a copy of the paper entitled "The Challenge of the Seventh Tradition" which describes a five-year plan initiated by Gordon Patrick that has, as its goal, getting our Fellowship to the point where A.A. will be entirely in that position. Robert Morse, treasurer of the board, has called our attention to the fact that a substantial portion of our income is derived from sales outside the Fellowship.

As a result of a recommendation of the 1986 Conference Committee on Finance, a definition of self-support was adopted which required that the sum of costs of group services and other expenses of the board be totally liquidated by group contributions.

Since the last Conference, special monthly meetings of A.A.W.S. directors and office staff have been held, in addition to the regular monthly A.A.W.S. meetings, with self-support as the sole objective.

The solution is, of course, in contributions: an increased amount per group; an increased percentage of groups contributing; and an increase in the number of groups listed at G.S.O. as participants in the A.A. service structure.

It is important to note that *we are not talking about a lot more money per member*. Based on the 1986 contributions from groups in the U.S. and Canada, the reported membership, and the shortfall of \$916,000; an additional \$1.25 per member or \$25 per group would have eliminated the shortfall.

To accomplish the task, the entire service structure was alerted to the problem and asked to take part in the solution.

Starting with the August/September issue, self-support articles have appeared in Box 4-5-9 and the plan is to continue in almost every issue as needed. The first article informed A.A.s that literature income is supplementing contributions to pay for group services. The second article emphasized the "Power of the Purse" in keeping the ultimate responsibility and authority for A.A. in the hands of the groups. The following article was a letter from the members of the Plug in the Jug Traditions Group in northern California asking why the G.S.O. budget exceeds the amount of money received from contributions. The article included G.S.O.'s response. Future articles will inform the Fellowship of how A.A. dollars are spent.

The four-page document "The Challenge of the Seventh Tradition" was distributed to the General Service Board early in October. Two weeks later, it was sent to delegates and alternate delegates, and early in November it was mailed to central/inter-group offices with the hope that information about self-support would be included in their newsletters.

D.C.M.s and area officers have also been receiving material. In October, D.C.M.s were sent "A Call to Action for Self-Support," asking their help in communicating with the Fellowship about the "shortfall." In January, the D.C.M.s were sent the "Challenge" paper, a summary of that paper, and a finance flyer. They were encouraged to duplicate the material for distribution to G.S.R.s. By mid-March, we had received requests for more than 6,000 summaries and 7,500 finance flyers as well as requests for additional copies of the entire paper, the finance pamphlet, and contribution envelopes.

Past delegates and trustees have not been overlooked and many have responded with good suggestions and requests for additional information so that they might also participate in carrying the message of self-support.

An examination of more than 20 local meeting lists selected at random indicated an average of only 80% of groups listed locally are also listed at G.S.O. With the help of their D.C.M.s, we hope that delegates will make an effort to contact the groups in their areas which are not listed at G.S.O. to determine why not and to encourage those groups to register and participate in the worldwide Fellowship. We think that many of the unlisted groups are under the misconception that being listed locally means automatic registration at G.S.O.

In addition, an analysis of contributions over several years revealed that 30% of the groups that contribute in one year don't do so in the next, and vice versa.

The A.A. Grapevine offered assistance which was gratefully accepted. One of Bill W.'s articles on self-support was reprinted in the December issue. In January, there was a news write-up about the self-support project in the "Around A.A." section. Probably in response to the "Around A.A." article, the Grapevine has received several new articles on self-support which will appear in future issues.

Also obvious is the importance of making contribution envelopes more readily available to the groups. In the future, contribution envelopes will be listed on literature order forms to make them more easily available to the Fellowship. In November, the Self-Support Committee, which is composed of A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. employees, made the decision to engage the services of a communications design specialist. The Conference Finance Committee will be apprised of his recommendations in detail.

The Fellowship has enthusiastically responded by generously sharing ideas and suggestions as well as dollars. We have been told to do a better job of educating the Fellowship about: the need to be self-supporting; what Tradition Seven really means; the financial implications on A.A. as a whole when groups don't contribute; how A.A. dollars are spent.

We have received many suggestions with regard to how contributions can be increased and these have been referred to the Conference Finance Committee. Also, we've received suggestions for reducing or eliminating various expenses by cutting services or having events such as Regional Forums and World Service Meetings become self-supporting.

The response in terms of financial support has been overwhelming! Please share the following with your groups:

Contributions			
	1985	1986	% of Increase
December	\$354,000	\$449,000	27
	1986	1987	
January	\$164,000	\$216,000	32
February	156,000	199,000	53
March	194,000	268,000	48
April	83,949	125,817	50
*Through April 10, 1987, and includes \$15,000 contributed by the International Conference of Young People in A.A. (ICYPAA).			

It is exciting to note that the number of contributions has increased by 30% over last year and the dollar amount contributed is running 40% ahead of 1986.

The A.A.W.S. Board has already responded to the increase by implementing a 4% discount applicable to all purchases of literature in amounts of \$25.00 or more, effective April 1, 1987.

More important, the Fellowship's response is Twelfth-Step work in action—making it possible to carry the A.A. message to still more suffering alcoholics through literature, audiovisual materials and information, as well as with direct action with other countries worldwide, Loners, the public, the media and friends in the professional community.

Bill W. said, "There was a place in A.A. where spirituality and money would mix, and that was in the hat!" (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 163.)

Lois Fisher (G.S.O. staff)

Can G.S.O. Be Self-Supporting Through Group Contributions Only?

"Can G.S.O. be self-supporting through group contributions only?" Quite a topic! When I was asked to speak on this subject, I, being involved in finance, thought it would be easy to answer. Let me tell you, there isn't an easy answer. It is far easier to answer the question: *Why should G.S.O. be self-supporting through group contributions only?*

It has been observed by people far greater than I that the power of the purse has a major impact on trends, society and especially organizations of people. It is clear that outside affiliation, financially (and all that implies to the independence and proven effectiveness of the A.A. way), is easy to accomplish if the support is *not* there internally. Who would you rather have G.S.O. dependent on for funding—you, the groups, or some other treatment facility or program? Your destiny, your interrelationship as groups and members of A.A., depends on a G.S.O. that is responsive to your needs, not outsiders. A fundamental means of keeping and expanding the G.S.O. relationship (and the whole service structure for that matter) is to keep G.S.O. both dependent on and funded by group contributions.

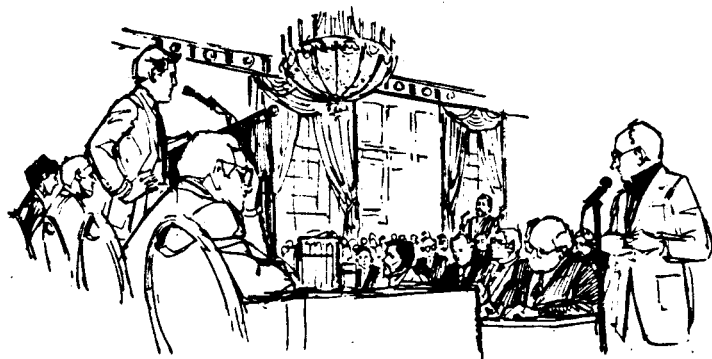
In an attempt to set a framework to answer the real question of my assigned topic, let me take some of your time to review history. In light of this forum being the 37th Conference, I thought we should take a journey through past Conference Advisory Actions concerning self-support based upon reports of the Conference Finance Committee starting over 30 years ago.¹

You are all aware of, and take seriously, Twelfth-Step work. Self-support money in the basket with the surplus making its way to district, area, intergroups and G.S.O. is Twelfth Step work.

The justifiable fears of affiliation and the reality of self-support go hand in hand: the Sixth and Seventh Traditions.

When the General Service Board set up the Self-Support Committee, Tom Jasper's assignment was to pull together historical background as well as other materials. I think his work was excellent and I'd like to share some of it with you.

It is likely that those same qualities of faith, vision and self-assurance which led Bill Wilson to co-found the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, enabled him to fashion A.A.'s evolving tradition of self-support, and to discuss money matters with the Fellowship



Fellowship in an easy, persuasive style. Equally important in the development of the Seventh Tradition was Bill's sensitivity to the need for a gradual change in our definition of self-support in order to remain in step with an enlarging A.A. world.

The Tradition was to move a long way from the financially desperate period, around 1938, when Bill and others around him wished silently and urgently that John D. Rockefeller would bestow the fledgling Fellowship with large donations.

A perceptible change in the Tradition was evident in January 1946. The Board of Directors of the Alcoholic Foundation adopted the following resolution in recognition of financial needs and the sufficiency of group contributions and book earnings to meet its then-present projects: "It . . . (is) the policy of the Alcoholic Foundation, Inc., not to solicit funds and to reject contributions with conditions stated or implied conflicting with established practices or policies of the Alcoholic Foundation, Inc., and not to accept revenues arising from any commercial undertakings which make use of the name Alcoholics Anonymous." (Amendment to resolution of January 16, 1946.) Those aspects of outside contributions which represented dangerous conflicts with A.A.'s purpose or which smacked of commercial profit were the first to receive formal attention.

In 1947, in discussing the Seventh Tradition, Bill points out that "where the proper use of money ends—and its misuse begins—is the point in 'spiritual space' we are all seeking." ("A.A. Tradition—How It Developed," p. 23) There were no money problems in the beginning when meetings were held in homes and the host provided the coffee. But, "money (had) entered our picture and we (were) *definitely committed* to its sparing use." ("A.A. Tradition—How It Developed," p. 23.)

Bill's view was that the vast majority of A.A.s believed that the services provided by the local and national offices were necessary. A.A. need not be "overwhelmed" by local offices or the General Office, for none of these could ever control A.A. If they were to become inefficient or overbearing, there would be a simple remedy: the average A.A. would discontinue his or her support.

Bill says in Part Two, page 20, of the 1947 pamphlet "A.A. Traditions," ". . . that voluntary contributions or pledges of A.A. members," ought to be A.A.'s principal and eventually its sole support. What must be avoided, though, he said, were large contributions—especially those which carry explicit or implicit obligations.

Bill concluded the 1947 pamphlet article with a prediction, "In the years that lie just ahead Alcoholics Anonymous faces a supreme test—the great ordeal of its own prosperity and success." (A.A. Traditions, Works Publishing, 1947, p. 22.)

¹ Space limitations preclude including the cited Advisory Actions. Please refer to *A Summary: Advisory Actions of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous 1951-1986*. Years cited: 1956, 1960-63, 1965-70, 1972-76, 1978-79, 1981-86.

In the February 1949 issue of the General Headquarters monthly newsletter Bill published, the purpose of voluntary contributions was defined: (1) to meet the expenses of the General Headquarters which operated a plan of service to alcoholics the world over, in keeping with A.A.'s primary purpose (it was described as international Twelfth-Step work); and (2) to meet those expenses of General Headquarters incurred in its operations as a coordinating central office for all A.A. groups.

The 1949 writings emphasized the voluntary nature of the contributions—"never be construed as dues or fees; also that these contributions may be used for 'A.A. Operating Expenses' only." (General Service Headquarters 1949—Bulletin #2, February 7th.)

In March 1949, the treasurer of the Alcoholic Foundation issued a letter to the Fellowship based on estimates by external auditors: 10% of the expenses of the General Headquarters Office was paid for by Works Publishing, Inc., which shared the office space.

The policy regarding outside contributions was further defined when, in February 1950, Bill W., writing to a law firm on behalf of the Foundation, as well as the local intergroup, declined a bequest of \$10,000.

In September 1950, the lack of voluntary contributions led Bill to issue to the Fellowship a five-page plea for support, including a request that the group secretaries call a special business meeting for the purpose of reading his (Bill's) report.

"Without A.A.'s Services we'd often fumble that new man just coming in the door; without our Services, we'd certainly spoil the main chance of those millions who don't yet know." (Semi-Annual Request for Voluntary Contributions to the Alcoholic Foundation, September 1950, pp. 1-2.) Voluntary contributions were used to pay G.S.O.'s bills—salaries, rent, accounting, printing, stationery, equipment, postage, and so on. "Group funds can be devoted to A.A. office expenses only." (ibid, p. 4.)

A 1955 bulletin carried a slightly different, softer plea: "There was a period in A.A. when there were two things to 'soft-pedal'—God and money. There are financial needs. When will we realize our responsibility for meeting them?" Support of the central offices, the General Service Conference, and General Service Headquarters, it pointed out in the same bulletin, was "... inseparably woven together into the place of money in A.A." Financial support is an integral part of Twelfth-Step work. The financial needs of A.A. might comfortably be met through a process of continuous explanation at the group level. Such communication might be accomplished by a brief financial report, and an explanation by the leader, *each time* the basket was passed. "Proper financial support is a specific, tangible way of expressing gratitude."

In November 1957, Bill wrote a Grapevine article entitled "Respecting Money," where he juxtaposed outside contributions and self-support. "Our spiritual way of life is safe for future generations if, as a society, we resist the temptation to receive money from the outside world. But this leaves us with a responsibility—one that every member ought to understand. We cannot skimp when the treasurer of our group passes the hat. Our groups, our areas, and A.A. as a whole will not function unless our services are sufficient and their bills paid." (A.A. Grapevine, November 1957.)

Ten years later, as if in conclusion, Bill wrote, "Both these principles we understand: that A.A. wants no charity; that we support our own services. We understand—but we sometimes forget." (A.A. Grapevine, November 1967.)

Let me restate the main topic once again: "Can G.S.O. Be Self-Supporting Through Contributions Only?"

Remembrances from home

Virginia delegate, Jim Ball, and Katharine Guy, Alabama/NW Florida, both found flower arrangements in their rooms at the Roosevelt. Thoughtful, loving remembrances from their home districts.

Let's see where the money goes that does come in from group contributions. The A.A. dollar going to G.S.O. makes it possible for the groups to handle work they could not handle on their own. G.S.O. provides services to A.A. groups which enable *them*—*you*—to fulfill their primary purpose.

There was a *Bar* 4-5-9 article, in the April-May 1987 issue, entitled "Where Does Your G.S.O. Dollar Go?" "... did you know that your A.A. dollar supports the activities of the archives? Here is preserved the record of A.A.'s fragile beginnings and its living history over the years ... Bill's actual letters to Dr. Bob. ... How and where groups began. ... Earliest copies of the Big Book." Frank M., our current archivist, quotes Carl Sandburg: "Whenever a society or civilization perishes, there is always one condition present. They forgot where they came from."

Your A.A. dollar helps not only to keep, but just as importantly, to carry the message through G.S.O.: seagoing A.A.s, Loners who have no groups where they are, and home-bound members all are saved by G.S.O.; tens of thousands of A.A.s inside prisons and jails have their own G.S.O. staff member; hundreds of letters and phone calls *every day* flood into G.S.O.—calls for help that G.S.O. staff responds to, putting the prospective member in touch with someone locally; the G.S.O. staff member on public information and one assistant receive over 10,000 requests yearly, from students, doctors, and nurses in training, for information about A.A. Each is handled with a letter and/or literature.

The A.A. dollar, through G.S.O., helps to meet the responsibility A.A. has when someone, someplace, reaches out for help, for the hand of A.A. always to be there. When new groups are started (about 15 times every working day), G.S.O. registers them and sends complimentary new Group Handbooks and a supply of A.A. literature.

G.S.O. helps finance the printing of the Big Book in foreign countries, when requested, to enable them to become self-supporting. Bill W. in an open letter spoke about G.S.O.: "G.S.O. has enabled our Fellowship to function all over the globe and as a unified whole ... G.S.O.'s all important services have accounted for much of our present size and overall effectiveness ... G.S.O. is by far the largest single carrier of the A.A. message."

"Can G.S.O. Be Self-Supporting Through Group Contributions Only?" That is a question only you, the Fellowship, you, the groups, can answer.

Robert P. Morse (Class A trustee)



What About the Birthday Plan? Or Group Pledges?

If things are dragging at your group or district business meetings, open up the floor for discussion on finance. It can also be guaranteed to liven up any area committee meeting or assembly.

Having had the opportunity to enjoy some time in sobriety and service (and, I might add, over 30 years of marriage, thanks to our Fellowship), I am well aware of the fact that problems about sex and money are ongoing concerns in all long-term relationships. Fortunately, I was only requested to talk about money.

Our long-term concern with total self-support has been going on for 52 years, that is, except for 1960 and possibly some time prior to that when we somehow managed to perform this miracle.

Group pledges do not sound like a logical solution for us. They conjure up thoughts of promises made in the past, well intentioned, but rarely kept. Of course, now that we are becoming (or have become) more responsible, this could be an option. Do group pledges work in your areas?

How about the Birthday Plan? Back in '56, this was initiated and called the Anniversary Plan, a suggested plan whereby members could help support G.S.O. In '61, we were reminded that this was "supplementary" support, beyond regular contributions, and \$1 per year for each year of sobriety, up to \$10, was a sound suggestion. (It should be noted here that we lifted the \$10 ceiling in 1975.) In 1970, we recommended that the Birthday Plan be extended to groups as well as individuals.

Now please remember that this should not be confused with the R.C.P. (Regular Contribution Plan) whereby each group would contribute monthly to G.S.O., or the Quota Plan where we would collect \$3 per member per year as suggested in 1963.

In 1973, we changed the \$3 figure to \$3.65 (a penny a day for sobriety). Then came the 60-30-10 Plan in 1975, which last year became the 50-30-10 Plan. All of these plans, of course, are not intended to replace the others, but to give ourselves additional means to be self-supporting, or should we call these options?

I do not mean to belittle the efforts of our Finance Committee. We all agree every effort we can make toward self-support is important. The fact that approximately only half of our groups are supporting G.S.O. should not come as a big surprise to us either. We are a very healthy and growing Fellowship. Many of our groups are very young and very small. Some are lucky to pay their own rent and buy their own coffee. Others are just getting to the place of becoming self-supporting themselves. Surely they can afford to send something. But don't we really hope that they become a little healthy first? Of course, we have those who have become too healthy, and that is where, as delegates, we can carry the message of our Seventh Tradition.

Maybe the paper "The Challenge of the Seventh Tradition" helped to bring about the healthy increase of group contributions in the last months of 1986 and the first months of 1987. It certainly didn't hurt. Pamphlets, papers, or notices may help, but nothing can really replace an informed delegate, area committee member, or G.S.R. carrying the message to uninformed groups or members. There are no dues or fees—we are self-supporting through our own voluntary contributions. No individual or group should ever be embarrassed or shamed into contributing.

At our Northern Illinois fall assembly, it was suggested that we try to implement the Birthday Plan during the month of November, since November is Traditions month and also Thanksgiving. A motion was passed that we take this back to



our districts and groups. At our winter assembly, our area treasurer collected almost \$5,000, not counting the groups and individuals who chose to send their contributions directly to G.S.O. Many decided not to participate for reasons of their own, and that is as it should be. Our area also voted a few years back to send everything above our prudent reserve, which was decided to be one-half of our area's annual budget, on to G.S.O., and that amounted to just over \$5,000.

So you see, we are trying. The basic fact is as old as our Conference. Informed service people doing what they can to carry the message of our Seventh Tradition so we can continue to carry our most important message, that of recovery. Remember the theme of our 40th Anniversary in Denver?—"Let It Begin With Me."

Hank Groat (Northern Illinois)

Group Support to District, Area, and Intergroup

For purposes of this presentation, I want to recognize that: (1) in our area, the district and area are part of the General Service structure and operate autonomously from intergroup; (2) in most groups in our area, the secretary and treasurer are one and the same person; (3) the "Supporting the A.A. Support System" pamphlet and its accompanying suggestions for group donations is a Conference-approved pamphlet that endorses the notion that intergroups/central offices are part of the General Service Conference—which they are not. We, acting as a Conference, probably have no right to tell any group what its contributions to an intergroup/central office should be.

Group financial support of the General Service structure begins with the individual member's contributions. When I came into A.A., they used to announce when the baskets were passed, "If you need some, take some." This statement is very passé today. I was stunned the night my sponsor came up to me after nine months in the program and told me I had to get a job. I asked, "Why?" He said, "so you can put some money in the basket, not just take it out. We need your contributions to help buy coffee, pay for rent, and send our G.S.R. to district and area meetings." I asked, "What's a G.S.R.?" He explained that a G.S.R. was our group's link to all the other meetings in the area and the world.

In our area, donations to the district and area pretty well reflect whether or not a group has a G.S.R., and more specifically, whether or not the group secretary knows where to send surplus group funds, how often to send them, and for what purpose.

Gwen Fields celebrated her 10th A.A. birthday the first day of Conference. What a great way to begin the 11th! Also celebrating an A.A. birthday during Conference week, staff member, Betty Liddle, with 26 beautiful sober years.

In our groups, the person with the money is the secretary who, in most cases, also acts as the treasurer. This group secretary/treasurer generally has six months to one year of sobriety, was elected during the last two minutes of a meeting, and knows nothing about service. It is this trusted servant that we attempt to reach.

Our area assembly has directed a specific flyer to the group secretary that illustrates various options for donating surplus group funds. This flyer is designed to be a permanent part of the group secretary's handbook. When rotation occurs the incoming secretary has some direction as to how the group normally attempts to make contributions and with what frequency.

I do not want to discount the value of a group's steering committee, or in some cases "elders," who represent the conscience of the group in determining who gets what and how much. Far too many groups do not donate to anyone and these are the groups we attempt to reach. We are not like the preacher dunning those already in church to give more; we are out soliciting new G.S.R.s so that we can broaden our base of representation and contributions. Our experience has been that where we have a G.S.R. we have a group making contributions, and where we are without a G.S.R. any monies received are pure luck.

A clear fact is—the groups *will contribute* to the district and area, especially if they know what they are contributing for—in other words, a *stated purpose*. I perceive that as long as we have a stated purpose for our districts and areas, and the groups know what it is, then, and only then, will they freely support these service entities.

But it first starts with the group financially supporting its G.S.R. who attends district meetings, area assemblies, workshops, Traditions breakfasts, Regional Forums, and regional service assemblies. When the group recognizes its responsibility to be a part of the sharing network of general service, it will support the system—if it believes the system is helping to carry the message. Which leads us to the obvious: what is the message we want the groups to financially support?

I believe our service message is very clear. It is, and should continue to be, that we carry the message of recovery to all who suffer from alcoholism. We learn through shared experience in general service how to best do this.

I recall the night at a district meeting when a G.S.R. was distraught over the fact that a local treatment center was bussing too many patients to their Step study meeting. This practice was very disruptive to the group. She wanted to know who else had this problem, and more importantly, how could it be stopped? Another G.S.R. who worked in the treatment field explained that all she needed to do was call the program director at the treatment facility, explain the problem, and ask them to send the patients to other meetings in the area. This is but one small example of how shared experience at a district meeting restored harmony to a group.

Five years ago, our area adopted a resolution of corporate poverty. The spirituality of this decision has been the backbone of our service structure. Our area decided that we would only accept contributions from individual members and groups and decline all contributions from outside sources, such as round-ups, conventions, etc. We resolved to be directly responsible to the groups we served for our finances. We have established an *operating account* and do not maintain a prudent reserve. Our financial policy is that whenever our checking account exceeds \$4,000 at the end of any calendar quarter, we will send the excess to the General Service Office. I am pleased to report that we have done this on two occasions.

As part of this commitment to self-support, we encouraged the districts to maintain their own treasuries. All of our districts now have their own funds for use in putting on workshops and paying rent for their monthly meetings. We also decided that we no longer needed to pass the hat at our area committee meetings, and the districts have also adopted this policy. We have transferred the financial responsibility directly to the groups for all our trusted servant responsibilities by supplying them with envelopes for mailing in their donations.

At the start of this presentation, I stated that I did not feel we as a Conference have any right to tell a group what its contribution to intergroups/central offices should be. I am in complete accord with our A.A. Guidelines which state that "Central offices and general service area committees are complementary, rather than competitive, A.A. operations. Both exist to help insure A.A. unity and to fulfill A.A.'s primary purpose of 'carrying the message' through separate structures." (A.A. Guidelines, Central or Intergroup Offices, p. 5.) We would not want to tell an Alano club what it should charge for monthly dues, or a convention or round-up what it should charge for registration; nor do I think we should tell a group what its contributions to intergroups/central offices should be.

The central offices in Southern California, and probably elsewhere in the U.S. and Canada, became very concerned when last year's Conference adopted the Conference Finance Committee's recommendation to place the 50-30-10-10 illustration for suggested group contributions as the lead or first illustration in the pamphlet "Supporting the A.A. Support System." The Conference voted to recognize the districts and that it was okay for them to have treasuries; the central offices thought we were robbing them of 10 percent. Inasmuch as the Conference is charged with matters affecting A.A. as a whole and not local affairs, I think we might have shown greater responsibility if we had eliminated any suggestion as to what a group should donate out of its surplus funds to a central office or intergroup. Maybe it's time for us to eliminate the present revised pamphlet altogether and develop a new one about group financial responsibilities to the service structure as a whole, without any suggestions to the groups on how to use their surplus funds.

In conclusion, I would like to remind us all that service is not a rich man's game. Financial means should never be a criteria for any member to be of service. It is the responsibility of the groups to fund their G.S.R.'s travel expenses to district meetings and area assemblies. It is the responsibility of the area to see that its officers are properly funded to perform the tasks which they have been elected to do. And without question, it is the responsibility of our Fellowship to have the General Service Office be directly responsible to the groups it serves for its financial support.

Tom Beebe (San Diego/Imperial)



RIGHT OF DECISION

On Monday evening, two presentations on the right of decision generated thoughtful discussion by Conference members. Helen Harmon, trustee-at-large/Canada, moderated the session.

The "Right of Decision" Makes Effective Leadership Possible (Concept III)

I am a member of the Conference Agenda Committee, where this topic comes from. At last year's Conference there seemed to be some doubt or feeling of unrest about the discussion and acceptance of the trustee's report on the General Service Conference Committee. The scope of the Conference Agenda Committee is to review and approve the agenda of the available subjects for discussion and make recommendations to the Conference for approval, disapproval, or amendment in a report given by the committee chairperson.

After some hours of reading Concept III, I find that if we have some knowledge of the Traditions, the Concepts are not that hard to understand. Concept III, the "Right of Decision," means to me that we must recognize the importance of the group conscience at all levels of A.A. My area may inform me of its feelings concerning matters presented at the Conference. I have the right, after listening to other views, to decide, with God's help, what is best for A.A. as a whole, even though it may not be in agreement with my area's thinking. I am not a messenger who is instructed how to vote, but a trusted servant with the right to decide on my own conscience. Each group of responsible leaders applies its own authority and responsibility to each problem. Our entire program rests on mutual trust. We trust God, A.A., and each other. The "Right of Decision" that we offer is not only the practical means by which our leaders act effectively, but is also the symbol of our implicit confidence in them.

The "Right of Decision" refers to the fact that everyone in service positions in A.A. is responsible to someone else and that there are checks and balances on what they do. Concept III provides that every person has the right to make decisions commensurate with whatever responsibility he or she has in A.A. without checking it out through those to whom they are responsible each time. Another Concept ensures that if you work for A.A. in any capacity, then you have a right to participate in whatever decision-making processes there are. Since the staff members have a definite responsibility in A.A. they have a right to participate in the General Service Conference where decisions are made that affect their jobs.

Authority may also be defined by Traditions, resolutions, or appropriate charters and bylaws. This Concept takes us to the Second Tradition, with the group conscience as the ultimate authority, but the trusted servant having the delegated authority.



With the responsibility we have, we must provide the proper management decisions in large matters of general policy to ensure A.A.'s survival and its capability of carrying the message. A group as large as we are cannot meet weekly to make the nuts and bolts decisions needed for a smoothly functioning operation or make immediate administrative decisions that are sometimes necessary. Therefore, the needed balance is furnished in giving the chief initiative and active responsibility to the trustees. Since they are involved in active management of our service organizations, they are in the best position to recommend future policy.

Where decisions are vital to A.A., let us not agree for the sake of being agreeable; where decisions are not vital to A.A., let us not disagree for the sake of being disagreeable; and, to borrow from a favorite prayer of ours, let us please find the wisdom to know the difference.

As Bill W. said of the Concepts: "... they detail the experience and reasoning on which our operation stands today. These Concepts aim to record the 'why' of our service structure in such a fashion that the highly valuable experience of the past, and the lessons we have drawn from that experience, can never be forgotten or lost." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 1986-87 ed., p.3.)

Cole Zobel (South Carolina)

The Principle of Mutual Trust (Tradition Two)

When I first received my loving invitation and noted by presentation subject, my first reaction was the thought that I would much rather speak on Concept III, the topic assigned to the delegate from South Carolina. I knew that I could offer an interesting, maybe even profound, view on the "Right of Decision." It will not surprise anyone when I share that my second thought was that had I been assigned Concept III, I probably would have wanted Tradition Two.

It is difficult for me to present any of the Traditions without first reflecting briefly upon Tradition One: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity." In other words, without unity, we as a society will surely die. Our unity is, of course, insured by Traditions Two through Twelve.

Some may ask, why are these Traditions so important? Why do we hold them so sacred? I believe it is because they came about as the result of the real-life experiences of the early members whose paths we follow today. The Traditions are part of the legacy for which we, this Conference, must serve as guardians in order that those alcoholics who follow us may find the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous always open.

When we are not attentive to our Traditions, we risk our unity, we become divided and then we as a Fellowship are at risk. When cooperation with the professional community drifts closer to affiliation, or when a court system starts dictating to an A.A. area what it wants us to do rather than accepting what we are able to provide, then we must rally behind the Traditions to insure our essential unity.

Tradition Two raises the principle of mutual trust. This is, of course, an issue that must be addressed, not only as it pertains to our unity, but also as it fits into our daily life.

Cole Zobel, Panel 36 delegate from South Carolina, introduced himself as Cold Sober — well, it sounded like that with his Southern drawl.



Bill W. said about blind trust, "Most surely, there can be no trust where there is no love, nor can there be real love where distrust holds its malign sway. But does trust require that we be blind to other people's motives or, indeed, to our own? Not at all; this would be folly. Most certainly, we should assess the capacity for harm as well as the capability for good in every person that we would trust." (As Bill Sees It, p. 144.) Bill goes on to warn that such assessments must be made in the spirit of love and understanding. I offer to you today that trust is a goal and not a state of being or a fixed thing. That trust must be gained through experience, understanding and communication. If there is any mistrust, whether between the groups and the district, the area and the delegate, or the Conference delegates and the General Service Office, why not improve understanding through increasingly open communications?

We should reflect upon why we continue to have presentations at Conference after Conference questioning the trust or lack of trust between the different levels of A.A. service. If nothing else, the recurrence of this issue suggest that trust is neither easily gained nor easily kept. It may also suggest that we are all too quick to become guarded or to doubt. Both the guardedness and the doubt contribute to mistrust. Perhaps it is time for us to intensify our efforts to be open with one another at all levels of service. These are some of the ways we can improve our ability to trust.

To paraphrase another great man's words, I suggest that to speak of trust does not provide trust. Let us not be talkers, but doers.

Cliff Carlson (Rhode Island)

THE USE OF SURVEYS IN MAKING CONFERENCE DECISIONS

Later Monday evening, Conference members heard three presentations on the advantages and disadvantages of surveys, along with new insights as to how they might be used. Joan Jackson, Ph.D., Class A trustee, moderated the session.

PRO — Don't Surveys Help Take the Pulse of the Fellowship?

When I received my loving invitation to share in this very controversial issue, I thought, whoeee! Don't surveys help take the pulse of the Fellowship? I think they can be very useful in taking the pulse of the Fellowship. They can get to the grassroots of the Fellowship. If our trusted servants accept their responsibility as trusted servants—G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area assemblies, yes, even us, the delegates. If we carry home from here (the Conference) the message as it really is, and tell it like it really is, and why we need their input, I think we can get the pulse and heartbeat of the Fellowship. But if we are very biased or opinionated, we can't. Surveys aren't meant to take anything away from the Conference.

Surveys are to help hear from the grassroots of the Fellowship. What would they like the trustees and the Conference to consider in our endeavor to better carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic? None of us likes changes. We of the old school cringe at the thought of it. If it works, don't fix it. If surveys bring out some thoughts that we might not have considered important, they might jolt us to get our attention; to at least look and listen! Go to your own home groups for a minute. Your G.S.R. makes an announcement that two weeks from tonight there will be a group conscience meeting on a survey being taken by G.S.O. The G.S.R. will read, explain, and give out a copy of the survey. You'll be asked to go home and talk about it, think about it, and pray about it, and you'll vote the group conscience two weeks from tonight. Now, how are you going to react as a member of your group? Are you going to think, talk, and pray about it? Are you really going to be open-minded? Or are you going to be a hard-nosed old so-and-so and close your mind like a trap? So the night comes. The floor is open for discussion and it gets long and loud. The G.S.R. calls for the vote. It's taken. The group votes yea on the survey question. You are the minority. You will voice it long (if they will let you), loud and clear. You will say how these new or young ones just don't know. After all, ta-da-ta-da-ta-da.

But if that G.S.R. has done the homework on the survey and presented it as it was, and your group did as it was asked to do, to think, talk, and pray about it, do you not think that was the heartbeat and pulse of your group conscience? It goes on up (or down) the ladder to the district and the area assembly, and all of these votes and notes are sent to G.S.O. for the trustees and the Conference to consider. Then we must do the same as the grassroots—talk, think and pray about it. The surveys are not taking anything away from our committee system or the group conscience of this Committee. The final and ultimate choice and vote will always be in the committee and in this Conference and in the ones that are to come.

If surveys can bring some positive thoughts and ways to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic (that is our primary purpose, you know! Sometimes I think we forget), then I feel we should look and listen. I'll have to admit I'm hard-nosed when it comes to the basic and simple truths of our Fellowship. If it works, don't fix it. Also, I don't always have to be right! (I'll have to admit that's a bitter pill to sometimes swallow, even now.) I find I can listen with an open mind. They have just as much right to be wrong as I do. Can you, or will you, listen with an open mind to them? I'm still pretty naive when it comes to my program and the Fellowship! I guess I want to believe that everyone in the whole Fellowship does everything just as it is in the book! I find this is not true. I guess we read the book differently or something—how honest is honest? I was flabbergasted and appalled to find that some of the surveys taken were padded. Both ways; for and against. The vote counts were altered. I don't know about you, but I know about me. If I had been a part of that, I'd be drunk, dead, or both. That's how it would be with me. An honest survey and an honest vote. Whether or not you believe I'm that naive is your choice, but I am. I believe if I should ever do anything to harm this beautiful life-giving, life-saving Fellowship, God would zap me!

"Pure alcoholics are getting to be as obsolete as dinosaurs" observed one Conference member. Later, John Bragg, G.S.O.'s general manager and Conference chairperson, opened a session with "My name is John, and I'm an alcoholic."



Those of us who have such a negative attitude toward surveys had better take a look at it. Maybe we should do an inventory on it. When you have a group conscience meeting at your home group, don't you take an inventory on the issues at hand? Pro and con, is it really for the good of the group? The Fellowship? Maybe it's not the way I feel. Maybe I really can't see any good. If you have nothing but negative thoughts, you'd better take an inventory and make sure negative is right! Now you know why I feel that if surveys are taken for the right reason and looked at as they really are, they can't possibly do anything to hurt our beautiful Fellowship. Surveys taken to hear and feel the heartbeat and pulse of our Fellowship must be painstaking so they will be true to the feeling of the Fellowship. Surveys taken in this manner can in no way undermine the committee and the Conference. They will always have the final voice and vote. In this day and time, I think surveys are here to stay (at least for a little while) and we must truly pray about them. If we pray for God's will and for God to express Himself in our Conference committee group conscience, He will! If we let Him!

Mary Baker (Kansas)

CON — Surveys Don't Help in Making Conference Decisions

In the last year, surveys have been sent out to a random sampling of A.A. members in an effort to "take the pulse" of the Fellowship. This represents a departure from the tradition of the Conference and may set an unhealthy precedent for the future. Their use should be discontinued because: (1) surveys are not a reliable measure of the Fellowship's pulse; (2) the use of surveys circumvents the Conference structure; and (3) the integrity of the Conference and its action may be damaged. Surveys may be a tool of potential value to other organizations that can depend on random samplings. In our Fellowship, however, we need to maintain channels of communication that insure that everyone's voice will be heard. Surveys sent to a small portion of the groups can indicate the feeling of *only* those groups. There is further danger that little time would be spent discussing the matter before a group decision is reached or that an individual may respond for the group.

Once the appropriate check is made as a response on the survey form, no more discussion of ideas or reasoning takes place. There is no room for the minority voice to be heard. There may be groups that have not considered the issue before, are not sure what to think, and simply want more discussion on the matter. Their affirmative response on a survey indicates they are a group for whom this is a burning issue and who see it as a necessity. This would be generating enthusiasm that may not exist. In the long run, there is no better way to discuss opinions and insure that everyone is heard than the give and take of face-to-face discussion. The General Warranties from the Conference Charter

state: "In all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of A.A. Tradition, taking great care . . . that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; . . ." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. 27.) Another problem that arises from the use of surveys is that our Conference structure is circumvented. There are numerous passages in *The A.A. Service Manual* in the sections on "The General Service Conference Structure" and "Annual Conference Meeting" that indicate how authority flows in the Fellowship and where the responsibility for decisions and discussion lies.

Authority begins with the groups, the group representatives to the Conference, from the Conference to the trustees, their committees and operating boards. In the Conference Charter, the Conference relation to A.A. states: ". . . [The Conference] will also be the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its view upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. 24.)

The "General Service Conference, Its General Procedures" include: "The Conference will advise with the trustees, directors, and staff members upon all matters presented as affecting A.A. as a whole, engage in debate, appoint necessary committees, and pass suitable resolutions for the advice or direction of the General Service Board and its related services." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, pp. 26-27.)

Later, in the discussion of what the Annual Conference is, the matter of what should be sent to the Conference is mentioned: "Many of the matters brought to the Conference are those that staff, boards, or trustees or their committees have not wished to act upon during the year. They felt that these matters were questions of movement-wide importance and so belonged at the Conference." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. 69.) The exception to these rules is also set out: "Except in a great emergency, neither the General Service Board nor any of its related services ought ever take action liable to greatly affect A.A. as a whole, without first consulting the Conference." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. 26.)

The use of surveys circumvents the Conference Charter. They do, in fact, reverse the flow of information and opinion gathering that result in an informed group conscience of A.A. as a whole as seen in the Conference. Actions may be different from the result of a random survey sample of the Fellowship. Because the use of a survey gives the impression of taking the Fellowship's pulse, such differences could damage the integrity of the Conference which binds us in our opinions, our discussions, and our service to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Louis Hall (Northern Minnesota)

How Can Surveys Be Utilized?

Surveys can sometimes be used to reach a goal. My first boss, many years ago, was a former lawyer who advised me that when I came to him for advice or a decision, I was not to tell him what I thought, but what I knew. With this in mind, I came to him one day with the results of a rather extensive survey I had made on the increase of prices the last year in just supermarkets and utilities alone. "Interesting," the boss responded, "what's your point?" "I need a raise," I replied. "You have it," the boss said and so I did, in the very next paycheck. A big one!

Surveys can sometimes be used to change your ways. Some years ago I was involved with the advertising for Fedders air conditioning. Almost from the beginning, that industry had what was known as a pre-season sales campaign, usually starting in late

March or April. For the last few years, sales had slacked off alarmingly and selling methods began to be questioned. Then someone made the rather strange-sounding suggestion that perhaps April weather wasn't as warm or promising of warmth as it used to be, thus urging people to buy prior to arrival of really warm weather.

Based on this thought, a plan was made to survey the weather bureaus in major U.S. cities until someone remembered that the U.S. Weather Bureau had records that go way back. Sure enough, a call to the central U.S. Weather Bureau produced evidence that warm weather in appreciable amounts didn't occur until four to six weeks later in the year than 20, 10 and even five years ago. Based upon this, the dates of pre-season selling of air conditioning was moved to later in the year and, of course, sales were good again.

Surveys can sometimes be used to support your own beliefs. A while back I had the privilege of working in the towering presence of one of the most remarkable communicators I've ever known, the late Rosser Reeves, now a member of the Advertising Hall of Fame. This man had the uncanny—almost spooky—ability to predetermine exactly how to present a product to the public, when to present it, what to say about it, where to say it, in what form to say it, and how often. Which is exactly what he would do down to the last detail. But to my knowledge, no work was ever done on a project nor was the client asked to spend a dime until the results of a survey of the intended market were in and analyzed. This is when we were all stunned, client included, by the amazing accuracy of Rosser's pre-determinations—every time. It was once suggested that he was so good with his intuition he should spare the agency the expense involved with costly and long surveys, but he wouldn't do this. His argument was in words such as: "I know I'm right and feel secure in that but I want the client, and you, to know I'm right and have that security also."

Surveys can sometimes be used to correct a costly misconception. Just recently, I worked with a client who, like a lot of us, came to conclusions one way or another that grew to become hard and fast fact with him, and he operated accordingly. He announced to me one day that he was excluding a certain publication from our media plan because women didn't read it and he wanted women readers. I countered that I wasn't immediately prepared to argue the point but would like a couple of days to investigate. As I suspected, but couldn't prove without research, this publication about to be eliminated has a huge and loyal female readership. And when I brought the results to the client, it's to his credit he did more than include that publication in our media mix, he skewed the schedule toward it. It wasn't the client's belief or mine that improved this campaign which, by the way, proved most successful; it was the results of a survey.

Surveys can sometimes widen your world (and the world of others). My first 23 years were lived in a house near the western slope of Sunset Mountain in North Carolina. When I was about eight years old, long before I ever heard the words "survey" or "research," I could no longer resist my curiosity about what it was like in the valley east of ours. I'd heard rumors it was wild and deep and empty. Nobody lived there, but I wanted to see for myself. And did.

It took me about two hours to climb my side of Sunset Mountain and find my way down the pathless slope into the valley beyond. But in those two hours, I went back maybe 100 years in time. People lived here all right, but in a far different way than any I had known. They lived in floorless cabins made of logs and clay without electricity or plumbing. They lived off the land, made their own clothes, were self-taught, were alone, and liked it that

way. I had no idea I was going into hostile territory where strangers were not welcome. But my age saved me as I was not the first young intruder. I was able to explain myself, and pretty soon I was chatting with a couple of boys. I was allowed to come back and after a while some of them were coming over to our side of the mountain and visiting in our valley. With this, even long before the spread of modernization melded our two different worlds, we came to know and appreciate and marvel at our separate wonders—the stark simplicity of one, the comparative luxuriousness of the other. After a time, we kids were going to the same schools, and it all began with what can be called an innocent little survey.

Surveys can sometimes be sadly ignored (but happily not too often). It is shocking, as I'm sure you've all witnessed, how some people or groups of people (and I'm referring to folks outside the program as well as in it) can talk about wanting to be informed and then refusing that information when it is offered. Just as shocking are the times when some people or groups of people (again I'm talking about folks everywhere) have all the knowledge they need right in front of them, placed firmly in their hands, yet refuse to look at it or act upon it. This comes under that sadly familiar heading: "My mind is made up; don't bother me with the truth."

Nothing, it seems to me, is more tragic than action taken in ignorance, unless it is action taken in direct defiance of what the facts would dictate. Yet we are indeed capable of that. Which is why surveys—a seeking of a wider range of opinion—are so vital in so many areas of our lives. And in this Fellowship, surveys can be used as more than a search for knowledge because, in our Fellowship, surveys can and do produce more than knowledge. They produce a mutual understanding, a genuine feeling for an insight into the aims and wishes and expectations and fears of those thousands of fellow members who are physically beyond our ability to see or touch except in thought and in the pursuit of what our searchings indicate is deep in the hearts and minds of most of us most of the time.

Surveys are not designed to make laws or to force decisions. Surveys are made to lead us to the surprise and promise of the other side of mountains.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr. (Class B trustee)



Shirley Sykes (nonalcoholic), assistant to the Conference coordinator.

NATIVE NORTH AMERICAN PROJECT

On Tuesday morning, the Conference heard two speakers report on the Native North American project. Betty Liddle gave an overview of the project and Tom Hills delivered a report on the subcommittee findings of the trustees' Literature Committee assigned to study the literature needs of Native North Americans.

Native American Project

In April 1985 the General Service Conference recommended that: "The general manager designate a staff person to coordinate and pull together (at the General Service Office) all available information about spreading the A.A. message to the Native North American population, including, but not limited to (1) translation of their languages and dialects, (2) experiences of various A.A. groups in their contact with these populations and to explore with a view toward consolidating and expanding A.A.'s experience in these areas; to report back to the 1986 General Service Conference through whatever committee the general manager feels is appropriate."

In September of that year, John Bragg assigned the task to me. At that time, we surveyed area delegates, alternates and also surveyed 600 alcoholism professionals working with Native North Americans. Of the respondents to the professional questionnaire, 88.7 percent indicated that A.A. literature in English would help them in their efforts to assist the alcoholic Native North American. Many expressed the view that this material needs to reflect the successful A.A. experience of Indian or Native North American members so that these suffering alcoholics will be better able to identify with recovery. Other respondents felt a need for "A.A. material integrating traditional beliefs with the Twelve Steps."

Both groups of respondents reported the following problems in carrying the message to Native North Americans: cultural differences; language problems; low motivation on the part of Native Americans; transportation problems; illiteracy; and lack of understanding about alcoholism and A.A. among Indian leaders. The A.A. respondents also reported: (1) difficulty in getting A.A. members who are willing to travel to reservations; and (2) weak service structures in areas with large Indian populations. The professional respondents also reported lack of literature or other descriptive material.

In addition to the survey work, I was invited to visit the following Indian reservations during the past year: Navajo Reservation, Chinle, Arizona; Alkali Lake Reserve, Alkali Lake, B.C., Canada; Mohawk Reservation, Hogsburg, N.Y.; and the Taos Pueblo, Taos, New Mexico. While most Native North Americans speak English, those on the reservation are separated from us in many ways—culturally, geographically, philosophically, etc. Without exception, the people I talked with on these reservations feel that an A.A. pamphlet that provides successful recovery stories of Native North Americans, with which their suffering alcoholic tribes-people can identify, would make a great difference in the acceptance. Historically, A.A. has flourished in countries where our literature has been translated into the native language. Italy, for example, had less than 100 members for many, many years. In 1980, the Big Book was published in Italian. Today, the Italian membership is 4,000.

Finally, I have had two visits with the people at the Bureau of Indian Affairs in Washington, D.C., to discuss ways in which we can get information about A.A. to their people. We have been assured that the B.I.A. stands ready to purchase in large quantities and distribute any A.A. pamphlet addressed to Native North

Americans. They have already purchased large quantities of existing A.A. material for Native American Schools and Tribal Councils in the United States. However, they, too, have reported the need for A.A. literature that would provide better identification opportunities for their people.

All this information was given to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, which recommended to the trustees' Literature Committee that consideration be given to publishing a pamphlet sharing A.A. stories of Native North American alcoholism and recovery.

Betty Liddle (G.S.O. staff)

Subcommittee Findings of the Trustees' Literature Committee

A subcommittee of three were assigned to consider the need for a pamphlet exclusively for the Native North American. This consideration is only part of an overall project to investigate the possibilities of spreading the A.A. message to the Native North American population. The project was the result of an Advisory Action of the 1985 Conference (Floor Action #1).

I was not present at the 1985 Conference, but am aware that the subject was introduced by the delegate from Northwest Ontario (Area 85). This is one of the largest geographical areas (if not the largest) in the Conference, and it has one of the smallest populations. It also has the smallest A.A. membership (about 1,000) and ranks 91st. Percentage-wise, the area has an extremely high native population. The people are spread through extremely rugged country and are widely separated generally.

Consequently the delegate had firsthand knowledge of the problem as it exists in the area. It is fair to state that it is representative of many parts of Canada and the United States, although there is likely more of a concentration here. My personal experience would certainly support the Canadian delegate in the seriousness of the problem.

Following the recommendation by the 1985 Conference, Betty Liddle was the G.S.O. staff person designated to the task of investigating the situation. She has certainly done that thoroughly, as may be seen from her report. Betty reported back to the 1986 Conference and has continued her reports to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community. Largely as a result of her research, the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, at its meeting on August 2, 1986, recommended that the trustees' Literature Committee consider publication of a pamphlet sharing recovery stories of the Native North American.

This recommendation resulted in a discussion at the trustees' Literature Committee meeting, held November 2, 1986, and the formation of the subcommittee.

Some of the thoughts expressed follow:

(1) It would be preferable to have an additional story added to the pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" Those sharing this view would seem to be concerned about having another pamphlet printed which is directly addressed to a specific group. The problem with this approach is that the impact of the message is lessened and is buried among the other stories.

(2) An audiovisual approach should be taken. This would be a good idea, but it is expensive to produce a film. Also, presenting the picture to an audience requires equipment and accommodations to show the movie.

(3) It was also suggested that the literature be translated into more of the many dialects which exist across this continent. There

is nothing wrong with this approach, but there is no question that the common language understood by most Native North Americans is English. Translating should be encouraged, but the most direct and simplest method would seem to be a pamphlet in English.

(4) Since the rate of illiteracy is relatively high, it was also suggested that some form of the new simplistic language methods be used. This would certainly seem to be a serious consideration, but perhaps to be developed later in addition to an ordinary pamphlet.

(5) A cartoon pamphlet should be done expressly for the Native North American. This also would be effective but probably more so if done later. A pamphlet with a number of stories would provide more reference points with which alcoholics would have opportunities to identify.

(6) Print a pamphlet with approximately 10 to 12 stories written by Native North Americans about themselves: young, old, men, women, etc. This would seem to be the best method. It is simple and could be done relatively quickly compared to all the rest. Pamphlets have been effective with other groups, such as "A.A. for the Woman," "Young People and A.A.," and "Time to Start Living."

From the information available both in the United States and Canada and verified by independent sources, the problem of alcoholism among the Native North American population is at least twice the rate of any other minority group, e.g., Hispanic and black people. There is no valid evidence that any kind of program has been successful other than A.A., and it is not certain even to what degree it has. Since A.A. is recognized as having had some success, merely in keeping with our program we should be attempting to carry the message in any way considered to be appropriate.

One of the reasons presented against the concept of an additional pamphlet is that we are all alcoholic and should have the same literature. There is no question that the recovery program is the same. Nor should there be any question that people follow different routes on their way to A.A. If this be true, pamphlets for the purpose of helping alcoholics to identify and relate should be encouraged rather than discouraged.

Eighty-nine percent of the professionals surveyed indicated that A.A. literature in English would assist the alcoholic Native North American.

Senior officials of the Office of the Assistant Secretary of the Interior in charge of Indian Affairs welcome the idea of a pamphlet and have verbally assured us they would purchase and use such a pamphlet in large quantities. We should be cautious about listening to outsiders, but it is important that we don't close our minds to their knowledge and make it part of our considerations.

It is recommended that a pamphlet in English exclusively for the Native North American with a number of individual stories about them and by them should be published. If it is felt that other forms of literature are required also, they should be published at some time in the future.

Thomas G. Hills (Eastern Canada regional trustee)

Ames Sweet, Grapevine's managing editor, invited Dean Rinehart of Oklahoma, next year's Conference Grapevine chairperson, to the Grapevine Corporate Board meeting on Thursday at 6:00. Just how busy a week it was was evidenced in Dean's straight-faced reply: "Is that 6:00 a.m. or 6:00 p.m.?"

PUBLISHING — TOO MUCH?

Later Tuesday morning, four presentations on opposing sides of the issue stimulated thoughtful discussion by Conference members. Bill Schmidt, Mid-Southern California, moderated the session.

A.A.W.S. — Yes, We Are

I now have the opportunity to pass on to you some of my own personal viewpoints and observations regarding the amount of literature we have in the Fellowship and if, in fact, it is as necessary as we have all claimed it to be. I will base my comments on over 20 years active membership in my group and on the many years I have spent in the Service Legacy of Alcoholics Anonymous.

I remember my early days in our area when it seemed my sponsor took me to nearly every A.A. meeting in Vancouver. There were very few pamphlets or hardcover books on display or for sale at the groups, in fact, maybe only four or five pamphlets and only two books—the Big Book and the *Twelve and Twelve*. As the Fellowship grew and we had more groups and a larger membership, there was an increased display of A.A. literature; eventually nearly all groups had a full rack of pamphlets as well as books. The other phenomena that happened, of course, was that as the Fellowship expanded and some special interests surfaced, new pamphlets were produced to reach special groups, i.e., "Too Young?," "A.A. for the Woman," "Do You Think You're Different?," and "Time to Start Living." As a matter of fact, we now have 45 pamphlets, three wallet cards, four workbooks, A.A. Guidelines, a group handbook, some parchments, three sets of cassette tapes, window shades, two booklets, eight hardcover books, and now a new softcover Big Book. No doubt, all of these have a very special meaning to everyone here, but if I surveyed you all individually, very few would pick the same piece of literature other than the Big Book, *Twelve and Twelve*, and perhaps *Living Sober*.

Let's look at the pamphlets. Most of them are outdated, too wordy, and have an institutional styled cover. They are really not that attractive, and mostly are hard to read without total concentration. Many are somewhat duplicated; for example, six or seven are related to the medical or professional people, three are directed at inmates, two for young people, and ten for the already sober group member. Those are some examples in just going down the list briefly. I see that we sold nearly 7 million pamphlets and 1½ million books in 1985, an enormous figure and certainly one that makes us a major publishing company—and that kind of disturbs me.

I recently asked a long-time member at home about the Seventh Tradition and where he thought publishing income fit into that picture. He told me his views, and I agree with some of them. To him, his group not only contributes to the three service entities in our area but also gives a little extra to G.S.O. by carrying a large literature inventory. He feels that what his group buys in literature is part of the self-support system. He pointed out to me that if the pamphlets were free, his group would have 50 of each on display rather than ten. To him all that matters is the net income of the Fellowship and are we paying our bills.

In the last few years we have introduced some new books. A.A. people have bought them like crazy, ensuring immediate financial success, which reflects in extra publishing income and eventually more money for the Reserve Fund. It also causes some concern. This year, if the groups respond as they are now, coupled with the publishing income, we will have a whopping surplus. I ask you, "Is this the way we should be going?" In my mind we need

a determination to review all our publishing, eliminate where necessary, combine some pieces, and modernize and make attractive what's left. Look at whether we need any more books. Reduce the prices! This will allow the central offices to maybe pick up a little extra money; in other words, give it back to the Fellowship.

If next week when I go to my meeting and there are no pamphlets, just two books and a meeting list, we would still have as many in attendance, we would still carry the message, we would still be sponsors, and we would still be grateful to A.A. I ask you to remember that pledge that was taken with Bill in Toronto in 1965: "I am responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible."

Jack Ford (Western Canada regional trustee)

A.A.W.S. — No, Just Right

My position is that we do not have too many pamphlets, etc. and that we will probably require more items to meet special needs in the future.

I think we must always be reviewing the titles on hand with an eye toward dropping or combining publications when a need no longer exists. For example, the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" replaced two separate items: "The Alcoholic Husband" and "The Alcoholic Wife." Similarly, it could be argued that "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" could be combined with the pamphlet "A.A. for the Woman."

But on the subject of new pamphlets, only nine new titles have come out since 1970. Pamphlets fall into three categories and since 1970, we have published six in the recovery area, two under the unity category, and one in the service area. These nine new titles in the past 17 years include, for example, "A.A. and the Armed Services." A need to reach these men and women was recognized and addressed. Similarly, the pamphlet "Too Young?" was provided for teenagers. We already had the pamphlet "A.A. for Young People" but it was directed at the population who are in their early twenties.

Only in recent years was it recognized that there was a widespread alcohol problem among older people, particularly retirees, and thus we responded with the pamphlet "Time to Start Living."

And who would argue against the very effective item "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" which serves the prison population, a segment of society which, in my opinion, we have yet to do all we can for? "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," by the way, was our second pamphlet for inmates and came in response to the awareness that this simpler format was necessary since so many inmates have reading difficulties. Isn't that a wonderful example of doing our job correctly, of following up and recognizing a problem, and then doing something about it?

We have a special pamphlet for the clergy, and another for the medical profession. We also have a generic one for professionals. Maybe someday we will want one for judges and court personnel in view of the increasing referrals by the courts to A.A.

Currently there are plans afoot to create a pamphlet for the Native American. In time, this Conference will have to determine whether such a special pamphlet is needed.

Presently we have six audiovisual items and six cassettes. Given the increasing use of cassettes, I can imagine a growing demand for more. Twenty or thirty years ago the idea of people driving

around in their cars listening to the Big Book would have been laughable. Today it is a widespread reality and in time, I would guess all of A.A.'s literature will be on tape.

There is another new world of communication which is quite alien to me—the world of the computer. I wouldn't know a floppy disk if I sat on one, but the A.A.W.S. Board has already received a request to put the Big Book on this format. Further, there is a request to use our material on computer "bulletin boards," and I'm not sure what that means.

As outgoing chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board, I am hopeful that we will get some expert advice to help prepare ourselves for future requests for republication and adaptation to the world of the computer.

In conclusion, I don't think we have too much literature. Nor do I think we have exactly the right amount. I think that we must always be ready to add publications when there is a need. We must always review existing publications to be sure that they are still required—something Vinnie McCarthy does so well. And we must always be ready to respond to technological advances—the world of film, cassettes and the blessed computer.

Shepherd Raimi (Class B trustee)

A.A. Grapevine — Yes, We Are

Did you ever have the experience in your home group of "attacking a newcomer" when several members give about six months of advice in four minutes? "Don't drink." "Go to meetings." "Get phone numbers." "H.A.L.T." "Ninety in ninety." The poor newcomer is so overwhelmed with information, he doesn't know where to start.

We at the Grapevine get carried away sometimes, too, while trying to carry the message with our "meeting in print." We have so many good items to pass on to the Fellowship that we want to present everything all at once. Stop by the Grapevine office anytime and see how many issues and projects are in progress. With proofs and galleys and drawings on the walls and manuscripts piled high on the editors' desks, it's a wonder this organized chaos leads to the great finished products of the magazine and books we enjoy.

We think the magazine circulation should increase every year. It doesn't. Renewals were down in 1986 from the great 50th anniversary year of 1985, and running even less in 1987. The *Best of the Grapevine*, Volume I, was so successful, that we thought, like all alcoholics, if one was good, then two would be better. The *Best of the Grapevine*, Volume II, came out too soon and sales were less than expected last year.

While all this was going on, we decided to publish a book of Bill W.'s articles from the Grapevine. In the meantime, A.A.W.S. came out with the portable edition of the Big Book. We had to delay presenting the Bill W. book until the 1988 General Service Conference.

Are we publishing too much? Are we going too fast? Have we become like the oldtimer who knows what's good for the newcomers without asking them anything about themselves?

It looked like it was time to take our inventory.

A long-range planning committee consisting of all the board members plus Gordon Patrick as ex-officio was formed to implement and expand upon suggestions made in the staff report given at the January 31, 1987, Grapevine Corporate Board meeting. The

overall objectives of the Grapevine Long-Range Planning Committee are: (a) to increase the use and circulation of the magazine within the Fellowship, and (b) to find ways to reach more still-suffering alcoholics.

An outline of the staff report was prepared along with a flow chart for tracking the implementation of the goals and objectives. At the first meeting of the Long-Range Planning Committee, four key questions were posed at a round robin. One response per person was asked with no discussion at that time. We present these questions to you without our comments so you may come up with your own answers. (1) What is the primary purpose of the Grapevine? (2) What can the Grapevine do for A.A.? (3) In terms of content, what would you most like to see in the magazine? (4) What one thing would you most like to see happen for the Grapevine?

Available resources to help increase the use and circulation of the magazine are divided into four categories. First, the A.A. Grapevine organization itself—the in-house staff and volunteer contributions, the board of directors, and the many thousands of Grapevine representatives. Second, the General Service Board of Trustees, the trustees' committees, and the staff of A.A.W.S. Third, the members of the General Service structure including Conference committees and the delegates in their areas and district committees. Fourth, the Fellowship through A.A.'s formative years when Bill Wilson used the Grapevine to carry a message to the greatest number of A.A.s. Today, each individual member has the opportunity to share his or her stories, thoughts, and opinions in the magazine.

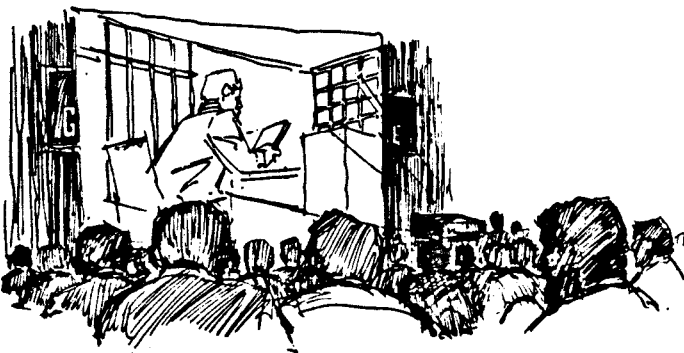
We of the Grapevine board and staff stand ready to serve the membership of Alcoholics Anonymous. We want to carry your message in the "meeting in print."

Norman Adams (Grapevine director)

A.A. Grapevine — No, Just Right

I have wrestled with this topic since I received my loving invitation in February. It was impossible for me to separate the topic "Publishing — Too Much?, A.A. GV — No, Just Right" from the problems of the Grapevine magazine itself and management problems.

During the last few months, I have been asking the members of the Fellowship in my area questions regarding the Grapevine, and to my surprise (and I say that tongue in cheek), have found that there is an apparent lack of interest in the Grapevine's content and form. This seems to have translated itself from still receiving the magazine but not reading it, to discontinuing the subscription.



What is said is that it has lost its appeal through apparently heavy editing to being "pap for the masses," boring, not current, and generally "Let's not make waves."

In further discussion, it seems that a change has been noticed during the past year or so and, strange as it may seem, the Grapevine has become involved in a situation(s) that are not to the credit of either the Grapevine or the General Service Board during this time. The Grapevine, as any periodical, is a mirror image of those who run it—its directors and editors—to the point that the mirror has cracked.

This already shaky magazine is having its underpinning sawed away from it by the flagrant abuse of our Traditions, Concepts, and principles—the same ones that have saved me from myself and have given me my life. I hope the Grapevine survives this assault on its integrity.

Is this responsible leadership of those who are the guardians of A.A.'s Traditions and Concepts? I think not! Is the Grapevine printing just right? Who knows? Do you?

Richard Haas (Vermont)

ARE WE CARRYING THE MESSAGE TO ALL?

Tuesday afternoon, the Conference heard six presentations illuminating three vital areas relating to how the Fellowship carries the message. Bill Croke, Class B trustee, was the moderator.

How Are We Reaching Hearing- or Visually-Impaired Alcoholics?

About seven years ago, I attended a workshop in which singer/activist Holly Near was discussing why she had used an American sign-language interpreter at her concerts for many years. She said, "Most of my message is in my music, so my message wasn't accessible to the deaf community." When she said this, I thought first of just having heard that the only signed meeting in New York City had folded, and then I thought of our Responsibility Declaration: "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible." Clearly, although there were about a thousand meetings a week in the Greater New York Metropolitan Area, the hand of A.A. was literally not there to carry our message to the deaf.

In the time since then, there seems to have been a growing consciousness throughout North America about the need to ensure that the A.A. message is accessible to all people, regardless of physical differences. As people with special needs have sought help, so have groups, individual members, and service structures acted to remove barriers.

For people in wheelchairs, intergroups often place a "wheelchair symbol" on meeting lists to indicate barrier-free meeting spaces. Many groups have made special efforts to erect portable ramps and to hold large gatherings only in spaces that are wheelchair-accessible.

For visually-impaired people, much of our literature—including the Big Book, the *Twelve and Twelve*, and many pamphlets—are available in Braille and on audio cassette. The Grapevine is publishing an outstanding collection of audio cassettes of material from past issues. And a number of the service materials are available in large type.

I recently read through correspondence in the "handicapped" files at the General Service Office. If that correspondence is any indication, we are reaching both people in wheelchairs and visually-impaired members quite well—but we are much less successful in carrying the message to hearing-impaired alcoholics.

Deafness is an isolating, invisible impairment. Often, when a deaf person shows up at a large meeting, she or he is not noticed. Unless there happens to be someone who can sign in the room, the deaf person may not be able to participate in that cherished two-way communicating we call sharing. Although we may write messages to deaf newcomers and give them literature, we may not be communicating. For many who are deaf since birth, English is a second language—sometimes a distant second language. If they use American sign language within the deaf community, they communicate through a language that is wholly different from English in structure, and English may be very difficult for them to read.

In recognition of this problem, G.S.O. has made available in simplified, or "A.S.L." English, the Twelve Steps and several brochures. G.S.O. has also issued Guidelines for Carrying the A.A. Message to the Hearing-Impaired Alcoholic—a wonderfully practical and sensitive sharing of the Fellowship's experience on this challenge. Available also are contacts for hearing-impaired alcoholics as well as the International Deaf Group by Mail, listed in the front of all directories. Many deaf members subscribe to the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*. And G.S.O. and many intergroups have installed TDD machines—a teletype machine used by many deaf people to "phone" one another.

What more can we do? Well, like our responsibility declaration says, "When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. to be there. And for that: I am responsible." As individuals, some of us might make the decision to study A.S.L. Groups may decide to hire interpreters if no one in the group signs. We can announce on the flyers for large gatherings that they are wheelchair-accessible and interpreted for the hearing-impaired. We might consider including on the forms on which groups update information for A.A. directories, a space to indicate if the meeting place is wheelchair-accessible and if it has an interpreter; and we could use the appropriate symbols in the directories. We could consider videotaping a professional signer interpreting key literature since VCRs are basic equipment in schools and other facilities for the deaf. Above all, we can ensure that the only requirement for membership is the desire to stop drinking, not the ability to walk, or see, or hear.

Jean Smith (A.A.W.S. director)



How Are We Reaching Other Language Groups?

When Bill W. left us with the Declaration of Responsibility—"I am responsible . . . When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible," I am convinced that he also had in mind other language groups. My presence here today is living proof that A.A. reaches out to other language groups, for my mother tongue is French. When I called A.A. for the first time, had they not spoken to me in French, I might not have made the effort of speaking in another language.

A.A. had its start in Area 87 in 1944 with Dave B., and it was not before 1947 that the first French group was founded. There were only five French-speaking members. It was soon recognized that the only way to reach the Francophones was to translate the literature into their language. In 1959, the Conseil des Publications Françaises was founded which was mandated to translate the literature into French. From that point on, the Fellowship has developed from about 500 members in 1959 to approximately 12,000 French-speaking members in 1987.

This growth was achieved because of our ability to give all group services in French from our local service office. We now have almost all of the A.A. literature translated into French. We can give public information to everybody in French. We can have a French presence in hospitals, penal institutions, and schools. We hold bilingual area assemblies. We need to translate workshops and presentations into French. We now have our own version of the young people's group. We have discovered that the best way to reach the Francophones is to be able to speak their language and render all services in it.

The same holds true with the Spanish population of Montreal. They have organized one Spanish-speaking district composed of eight groups. At the beginning, they were associating more with the Spanish groups in the United States. We made an attempt to integrate our Spanish-speaking groups fully into our area. Fortunately their D.C.M. was bilingual (French and Spanish) so we invited him to share in our newsletter *Box 4-6-0*, in the Spanish language. We invited Spanish-speaking members to attend our area assemblies, and they held workshops in Spanish. We can now say that the Spanish-speaking population is part of our area's group conscience. We still have a problem at the level of receiving Twelfth-Step calls in Spanish because Spanish-speaking members are not numerous enough to handle the phones daily; but with time, it will be resolved. At times we wonder if it would not be good to improve this situation—to have a telephone answering service to handle the phones and refer the incoming calls to Spanish-speaking members. I sure hope that some of your experience can be shared with me on this subject.

We do not seem to have the same degree of success with our other ethnic groups. We have a very important Italian-speaking population in Montreal, but we do not have one single Italian-speaking group. The Italian population is certainly five times the Spanish population, which has eight groups already. We can only conclude that the fact that we have literature in French and Spanish helps us and is probably the only avenue to reaching the first members of any ethnic group, and from there it builds up and works.

East Central regional trustee Jack Whitehouse observed that he had experienced a new definition of "acute anxiety"—"what you feel when your first-year delegate wife goes to the microphone."

We also have some difficulties in reaching the Native Americans on a reservation near Montreal. We will be very happy to have your thoughts on the subject. Maybe, in the case of Native Americans, it is a problem of difficulty in identifying with our French or English membership. Do you have this problem—maybe in California where you may have Native Americans and two spoken languages? If so, how do you reach them?

In conclusion, I would like to say thanks to the early members who recognized that to reach a foreign population we should publish in their language. I have had access to A.A.; and it seems to be our experience that when it can be done, it works. Do you think so?

Marc Pineau (*Southwest Quebec*)

How Are We Reaching Other Language Groups?

In 1960, in a paper entitled "The Language of the Heart," Bill W. wrote: "By 1950 this one big question remained unanswered: Could we communicate overseas? Could A.A. transcend the barriers of race, language, religion, culture and wars?" (*A.A. Today*, p. 11.) The answer turned out to be yes. Now, in the late 1980s, we definitely have transcended all of those barriers and it is by the grace of God that we indeed speak the "language of the heart."

How are we reaching other language groups? The trustees' International Committee has a long-range goal of having three of A.A.'s basic pamphlets, "Is A.A. For You?," "44 Questions and Answers" and "A Newcomer Asks," translated and printed in many different languages. The first two languages selected for translation were Russian and Chinese. They are now available.

In order to help the trustees' International Committee decide which translations to consider next, information was obtained from delegates, and central and intergroup offices to let the committee know which languages they had a call for. The greatest number of requests have been for the southeast Asian languages, i.e., Laotian, Thai and Cambodian.

On the list of actions taken by A.A.W.S., Inc., we can see that in 1959 they approved the publication of the Twelve Steps in Spanish to replace the "Fortune" reprint pamphlet. It was further felt that Spanish translations of "The Alcoholic Woman," "This Is A.A.," and "The Alcoholic Husband" should be made available. By 1964, our G.S.O. was already printing in offset the Spanish version of the Big Book's first eleven chapters. All of this was possible because in 1960 the Conference recommended that in view of the importance of communicating the A.A. message to non-English-speaking alcoholics in many lands, A.A. World Services, Inc. undertake a thorough study of the immediate and long-range needs for A.A. literature in languages other than English. Those were the years when the Conference suggested that area committees try to interest groups in Conference-approved literature by using the motto: "Let literature carry the message, too." With the help of this simple but significant slogan, Spanish literature started to spread out and with it came the initiation of more and more Spanish-speaking groups. And this is how we are reaching other language groups!

Quite naturally, the leaders in this respect are in the Southern and Mid-Southern California Areas where there is a heavy concentration of Hispanics. It is on record at G.S.O. that the very first Spanish-speaking A.A. group was formed back in 1945 with the name "Grupo Latino Americano de Los Angeles." Why? Let's listen to a short story originally written in Spanish. This is the English version:

"I am W.B., a grateful alcoholic. (For those who don't know what W.B. means, it simply means 'wetback'.) I came to this country trying to escape my unmanageable life. The excuses were many, but my intentions were honest. Naturally, I had to cross the border illegally. The difficulties and the price I had to pay were great, but finally I made it. Once here in this magnificent country, I could envision a beautiful horizon ahead of me. I started to work immediately as a simple laborer, but my alcoholism had also crossed the border 'illegally' with me. So with my first paycheck I started to drink again. During my hangovers, I used to remember how, back in my country, I had resisted the good advice not only of doctors and priests, but of employers, friends and relatives. I had come determined to control my drinking without the help of others. But it was not until I woke up in an alley after a week-long binge that I realized I was beaten and had to call that phone number—the L.A. Central Office. They would send me help."

From then on the story is all too familiar—one drunk blessed with the gift of sobriety, trying to obtain from God the same blessing for his still-suffering brother or sister. One drunk who didn't speak a single word of English talking to another drunk who couldn't understand Spanish. Why? Because for A.A., there are no language barriers. A.A. speaks the language of the heart. God doesn't "love in word, neither in tongue, but in deed and in truth." (1 Jn. 3:18) W.B. the alcoholic finishes his story with the following: "The miracle happened. I kept coming back. And from that moment, 'one day at a time' by the grace of God, I haven't taken a single drink of alcohol. And for this reason, today I'm still a wetback, but above all, a grateful alcoholic." To me, this is how we are reaching other language groups!

Although the pioneers of the Hispanic A.A. movement at first believed that no place remained for their participation within the General Service structure, by the late 1970s, it was apparent to everyone that such a place did in fact exist, and in truth, always had existed. The Puerto Rican A.A. groups constitute a Conference Area and more and more Spanish districts are being formed in most of our continental areas. Nobody is left out. Everybody now is a part of the whole. As Bill W. said, "This was something much greater than people cordially meeting people. This was no merely interesting comparison of mutual experiences and aspirations. This was far more; this was the communication of heart to heart in wonder, in joy, in everlasting gratitude." (*A.A. Today*, p. 11) And this is how we are reaching other language groups!

Vicente Mejía (*G.S.O. staff, Spanish Services*)

How Are We Reaching Other Groups?

Alcoholics Anonymous has never assumed that "carrying the message" was limited to persons who came to us declaring that they were alcoholic and were in need of our assistance. The very first A.A. meeting was arranged because Bill W. needed to talk to another alcoholic to maintain his own sobriety. Our Fellowship continues this tradition today. The efforts of our public information and cooperation with the professional community committees are being rewarded and more people than ever before are being helped. However, in some instances, grave problems have developed because of the number of people involved and the complexity of many of their problems. We just could not have foreseen or anticipated the degree of complications involved.

A number of groups are dealing with the issue of helping persons suffering from "significant symptoms of mental illness" as well

as a drinking problem. The groups that were originally called "double trouble" are still trying to help in that area of our communities. The New Jersey list includes meetings which are supervised and conducted by the staffs of institutions and gives their origin. Sometimes the staff person is there as a volunteer and may or may not be a recovering alcoholic him or herself. At other double trouble meetings, the emphasis is on having members prepare to attend regular A.A. meetings. They follow a path similar to that of our beginners meetings. They are cautioned that some A.A. members may go beyond sharing of experience, strength and hope by giving advice about necessary medications.

There are double trouble groups for MICA clients, patients classified as mentally ill chemical abusers. These meetings follow an A.A. format but have their own preamble and are not listed by A.A. in the Southern New Jersey Area.

A second and more troublesome problem is the nonalcoholic attending both open and closed A.A. meetings. Major difficulties arise when some persons present themselves at A.A. meetings, say they are drug addicts, and state that their counselor told them they have a right to attend because of A.A.'s Third Tradition. This right, they insist, also includes full participation to speak and to lead meetings while still maintaining that their problem is drug addiction and not alcoholism.

Our concern has taken us to treatment facilities, both public and private. We have talked to administrators, physicians, nurses, and counselors. We find many adamant in their position that an addiction is an addiction. Our statement, that we consider alcoholism an illness and that the program of our Fellowship has the single purpose of recovering and helping others to recover from this disease, falls upon deaf ears. We want to emphasize that not all professionals think and act this way, but those who do are causing much concern at meetings in our area.

Many affected groups, based on group conscience, are making firm statements as part of their opening format, on who should speak and what to speak about at the meetings. When these declarations are ignored, other problems relating to enforcing the decision of the group develop.

Some members have decided to "stop fighting anything and anybody" and are starting meetings in private homes to eliminate what they consider intrusions of persons with problems other than alcohol. Other groups are not listing the meetings locally or at G.S.O. When approached about being listed in order to be informed, they respond that when they want our help, they will ask for it.

At a recent district meeting, a G.S.R. reported that some members were concerned that a new group was forming that would limit its membership to those who were sober for 15 or more years. This is another reaction to the same situation. Nonaffiliated meetings of ACOA, Al-Anon, and ACOAP groups, confuse some members into substituting them for A.A. meetings. All of these instances point out pockets of real concern for the unity of the Fellowship. We need the oldtimers and they need the newcomers. Newer members are making statements like "pure alcoholics are like dinosaurs." We would be in great peril of losing the very essence of what has saved us and could help to save our lives and those of many thousands more to come if the dinosaurs were left out of our Fellowship.

There is enough space for all of us, but we must have the patience, the love and the wisdom to ask for and listen to the voice within each of us for the spiritual guidance necessary to continue our personal adventure of recovery.

Harry J. Fischler (Southern New Jersey)

How Are We Reaching Other Groups?

Alcoholics Anonymous is more than a set of principles; it is a society of people in action. Our basic service is carrying the A.A. message through service; anything that will help to reach the still-suffering alcoholic from preparing coffee to performing Twelfth-Step work. The primary purpose of the Conference and our responsibility as delegates is to render service to Alcoholics Anonymous to ensure that it continues to function as a whole. We must carry the Alcoholics Anonymous message to all still-suffering alcoholics, else we ourselves can wither and those who haven't been given the truth may die.

We are responsible when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, for hand of Alcoholics Anonymous always to be there. For this reason, the following steps are considered important to reach other groups in Alcoholics Anonymous in order to reach the still-suffering alcoholic: (a) encourage Spanish-speaking and other minority groups to participate in the general service structure; areas should be encouraged to provide room within their structures for Hispanic districts, (b) assemblies should be encouraged to provide G.S.R. schools, seminars, or workshops in Spanish, (c) produce new public information spots for radio and TV; Spanish language and sign language for the deaf should be used in TV announcements, (d) coordinate and pull together all available information about minority groups in our areas to be able to understand cultural differences and improve communications.

Our Alcoholics Anonymous experience has taught us about the great influx of members from treatment facilities. A bulletin directed primarily to treatment facilities handling minorities with alcoholism problems should be instituted and sent to such facilities. Delegates will help compile mailing lists. Clarification should be made to all Alcoholics Anonymous members outside the general service structure about the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous. All alcoholics should know that, in effect, the General Service Board has but one purpose, that of serving the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. It is, in effect, an agency created and designed by the Fellowship to maintain services for those who should be seeking, through Alcoholics Anonymous, the means for arresting the disease of alcoholism through the application to their own lives, in whole or in part, of the Twelve Steps which constitute the recovery program upon which the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous is founded. The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous claims no proprietary right in the recovery program for these Twelve Steps as all spiritual truths may now be regarded as available to all mankind.

Eugenio Cotto Jr. (Puerto Rico)

How Are We Reaching Other Groups?

How are we reaching other groups? In our efforts to carry the message of recovery to young people and the elderly, we do a relatively good job, with some exceptions. Our twelfth stepping has been turned around. Most central offices and intergroups no longer receive the number of Twelfth Step calls they did five or six years ago. People are being sent or sentenced to attend A.A. meetings, and it has created many problems.

The Twelfth Step says we try to carry this message to the alcoholic who still suffers. We have done this in the past and will continue to pass it on. A lot of people have been using the saying "If it works, don't fix it." This may be true of the writing in the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; but when it comes to practicing these principles in all our affairs, we need to change.

We need to carry the message of Unity and Service to young people in A.A., asking them to participate in service workshops and on panels to allow these future delegates, area committee members, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s the opportunity to experience this Legacy we have learned to love.

Do we actually carry the message of sobriety to courts, or is it being sent to us? Have we lost interest in that person who may come to us hungry, angry, lonely, or tired? My hope is that we haven't. Our institutions are full of people who need help. Why are A.A.s afraid to visit institutions or correctional facilities? Our local jails are full of inmates who need to know more about A.A. The literature is there, but we are the people who know best how to explain it to the sometimes illiterate inmate. Films are used to show the overall picture, and literature is there for identification, but where is that person who can talk one-on-one with the inmate whose only hope is to receive correspondence from the outside?

Here stands before you a person sent to A.A. in 1971. There isn't any difference between those sent today or when I was sent at that time. The largest problem we have is not getting off our chairs to shake their hands and welcome these so-called resentful people who, with a lot of caring, may someday be standing here before you.

What has happened to those people who have been in A.A. for five to ten years or longer? Have you seen them sitting in the back of the room with a problem they should be able to solve, but for some reason (whatever it may be) they just can't get out of that depression or loneliness they feel?

Shouldn't we let them know they're still a part of this program? When a long-time A.A. member is hospitalized for a long period of time and can't get out to meetings, do we still carry the message to him or her? Our area has a shut-in committee that will make regular visits to those who are confined to a nursing home or their own home for the simple reason of carrying the message.

This from *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*: "A.A.'s Twelfth Step, carrying the message, is the basic service that our fellowship gives; it is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence. A.A. is more than a set of principles; it is a society of recovered alcoholics in action. We must carry A.A.'s message; otherwise we ourselves may fall into decay and those who have not yet been given the truth may die. This is why we so often say that *action* is the magic word. Action to carry A.A.'s message is therefore the heart of our Third Legacy of Service." (pp. 139-140)

How are we reaching other groups? Pretty well, I think, but we could do better.

Jack Reighard (Northwest Ohio/Southeast Michigan)



GRAPEVINE

Wednesday morning's opening was followed by three presentations highlighting the "how," "what," and "where," of the A.A. Grapevine. John Sears, Wyoming, moderated.

The Grapevine: What Is It?

There are many different ways to address the question posed in this presentation topic: "The Grapevine: What Is It?" The simplest would just be to tell you that the Grapevine is the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and then sit down. Or I could tell you how the magazine is a "forum for debate" or a "mirror" of the Fellowship or a "meeting in print." Certainly the Grapevine is all of these, but to me it is much more. As a monthly magazine, it is the only piece of A.A. literature that can consistently respond to growth and change in the Fellowship and be a spawning ground for new ideas and creativity in dealing with the ever-growing issues that continually face our Fellowship.

Another way of addressing the question would be to look at the Grapevine's structure and where it stands within the larger world of A.A. as a whole. As a separate corporation from A.A.W.S., the Grapevine is wholly concerned with the publication of a monthly magazine, producing cassette tapes of Grapevine articles, and producing special items such as *Best of the Grapevine*, Volumes I and II, and the forthcoming book of Bill Wilson's Grapevine articles, to be entitled *In All Our Affairs*. Unlike A.A.W.S., whose principal publishing concerns revolve around material which has, for the most part, already been written, the Grapevine has to produce a new, quality product every month, relying for content on what individual A.A. members worldwide decide to write. In many respects, then, the primary activity of the Grapevine is "the creative." Again, it would be tempting, having said that, to sit down. Yet there remain the practical questions of business and finance.

In Concept XI, Bill W. describes many of the reasons for the separation of the two A.A. service corporations. He also poses many questions that such separation inspires: questions about merging the two entities to achieve unified management and possibly financial efficiencies, and questions about the importance of matching operational responsibility with a corresponding operational authority. After discussing the pros and cons of several such matters, Bill's conclusion is clear: "We might save some money, but we probably couldn't save the magazine."

A.A. is not, and never has been, in the business of selling sobriety. But it is in the business of giving it away. Perhaps the Grapevine should be made available to all those who want it rather than to all those who can pay for it. Perhaps the time has come to move away from the strict business concepts on which performance is generally evaluated and get back to the creative work that transcends those concerns. Paid circulation and the financial "bottom line" may not be the best barometer for determining the health of the Grapevine because there is still another way to address the question of what the Grapevine is—it is a tool, a sobriety tool, an integral part of the A.A. program. It is a living and breathing expression of the way A.A. members worldwide feel about their sobriety and all that comes with it.

While business standards are by no means unimportant, the absolute reliance on prepaid circulation may, in fact, restrict a much wider distribution of the magazine itself, thus denying many members the use of this tool. Perhaps distributing the Grapevine through monthly group contributions, thereby enabling the groups to order, on a monthly basis, single bulk copies of the Grapevine, as well as prepaid subscriptions, could be a

solution to the problem. Many groups, for example, seem to have a problem putting together—in advance—the full year's subscription price. This, of course, is entirely understandable. Rent has to be paid, and contributions have to be made to the A.A. entities that lend supporting services to the group. So the group cuts back its Grapevine subscription, and people wonder why Grapevine circulation is not keeping pace with the overall growth of the Fellowship.

From a strictly business standpoint, this could be perceived as a problem. And yet, if the Grapevine really is a valuable sobriety tool, really is an integral part of the A.A. program (which I truly believe), then that "business" problem is not the problem that concerns me the most. The problem that concerns me the most is that the Grapevine is not getting into the hands of those suffering alcoholics, both in recovery and not in recovery, who need it. And so long as we continue to define what the Grapevine is by monthly prepaid circulation alone, we may miss what to me is the strength of the Grapevine—that is, to carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, in a way that only a free creative press can, to the Fellowship and the alcoholic who is still out there.

Stanley Silverman (Grapevine director)

How Does It Work?

To the question "How does the Grapevine work?" I am tempted to respond as Bill W. once did when asked the same question about Alcoholics Anonymous: "It works good." Certainly, in spite of the ups and downs that come with any A.A. job, that has been my experience as Grapevine editor.

It works good because, apparently, A.A. members write as much as they talk. Every day, my in-box is piled high with manuscripts from A.A.s all over the world. And not the same people time after time: though there are a few regular contributors, the bulk of any issue is by first-time writers. *That works good, too, because A.A.s write in the language of the heart: we don't have to depend on professional talent.*

It works good because the editorial "policy," to use a word that doesn't really apply, consists of the universal spiritual principles articulated in the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts. As editors, we are not tied to any one point of view or school of thought. Just as each A.A. member takes these timeless principles and brings them alive through daily practice of the program, each Grapevine article, reflecting one A.A.'s individual experience, brings the principles to life in unique, ever-changing ways.

It works good because, while the Grapevine is many things to many people, it never tries to be *all* things to *all* people. Over the years, the magazine has been called a "meeting in print," a "forum for debate," a "mirror of the Fellowship"—and more recently, some have used the descriptive phrase "on the cutting edge of A.A." All these things are true, yet no one of them captures the reality of the Grapevine—just as the story of one member cannot capture the reality of A.A.

It works good because the Conference Charter guarantees that "nothing herein shall compromise the Grapevine editor's right to accept or reject material for publication." That guarantee is vital. For example, a few weeks ago I was going through some Grapevine Board minutes from the 1950s, in which the then-editor reported that he had just rejected an article by Bill W. because it was an appeal for funds for headquarters. As long as I and future editors act just that responsibly, the Grapevine can never become a vehicle for any one faction or special interest within A.A.

On the other hand, it works good because in practice no Grapevine editor has ever demanded or used that right unilaterally. Last year on Annual Open House Day, one of the Grapevine directors was bringing tours around, and having a wonderful time introducing me as "the person who decides what goes in the Grapevine." He would laugh gleefully and walk off, while I turned pale. As he well knew, no one person makes decisions about magazine content. Manuscripts are accepted or rejected on the basis of a staff consensus; and when the staff has questions or reservations, members of the editorial board are called in. No decision is ever final until all are comfortable with the outcome.

And finally, it works good because, when it doesn't work good, you let us know about it! I suspect that most of you, like me, have grown in service because of—not in spite of—the freely expressed criticism of many other A.A.s. (One of Bill's best-known Grapevine articles was entitled "Our Critics Can Be Our Best Friends," and by that definition I stand now in a roomful of best friends—and I say that with deep gratitude.)

One of the great strengths of the Grapevine is that over its 43 years of existence, it has remained free to take chances, express new and different ideas; and risk criticism. The mail we receive is almost overwhelmingly positive, but there is always a healthy trickle of angry or indignant letters. If that trickle ever stops coming in, I'll know it's time for me to get out because the Grapevine will no longer be growing, progressing, and responding to the heartbeat of this great Fellowship.

Ann Warner (editor of Grapevine)

The Grapevine: Where Is It Going?

The Grapevine has come through a time of restructuring and trauma. It is better positioned today than it ever was to be all those things that Stanley Silverman and Ann Warner have described. There is a dedicated staff and an even more professional board that are focusing clearly on the mandates that have been given to the organization to market this magazine—and the Conference gave us that mandate.

We have requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee search for a new managing director of the publication. We are requesting that the Conference ratify the nomination of a new chairperson of the Grapevine Board and one new Grapevine director, whose journalistic credentials are extremely strong. The long-range planning committee of the board meets monthly and is concerned with new ways of presenting "the creativity of the publication." We are discussing and exploring on the marketing level new ways to approach the GvRs, new ways to approach the groups, and ways of having the groups use the Grapevine as a tool for recovery and open communication throughout the Fellowship. We have in place ever tighter controls and more stringent management information systems.

All of these things notwithstanding, the "Vine" cannot flourish without the sun and rain, the clear air and solid soil, which is you, the living spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Each of the preceding presentations has alluded to this point. The Grapevine is far beyond marketing and circulation and dollars and cents. The Grapevine, as a tool for sobriety and as a publication, has a 43-year proven track record. If that track record is to continue, it is in the hands of a Power greater than ourselves: "Paul plants; Apollo waters; and God gives the increase." Ignatius Loyola, who founded the Jesuits, used to say it this way: "Work as if everything depended on you and pray as if everything depended upon God." That God of our understanding is working

beyond our understanding in our collective consciousness at every moment of this Conference. We have the power to transform the Grapevine into an ever more effective international journal of A.A. What is the future of the Grapevine? We know what we've been, and there's no telling what we might become.

In the face of the future, we need to accept our powerlessness again. The directors and staff of the Grapevine, as well as all the delegates, need to accept that powerlessness. We have learned that principle through our own experience with alcohol. In it is the freedom that allows us to contribute to the untapped potential of the Grapevine as a tool of recovery and communication.

There was a time the Grapevine did not exist. It is conceivable that it may not exist again. If it has no meaning today to alcoholics who are still suffering and to alcoholics who are recovering, there is no reason for it to exist. The Grapevine could be shut down. Look at all the money, heartache, trauma and work we'd save.

One of the most marvelous things about alcoholics, in my experience, is that nobody can tell them anything, except, perhaps, "Don't pick up the first drink." So no one is telling you that you have to have a Grapevine in the future. It could be a world without the Grapevine, and if you didn't pick up the first drink, I suppose it would be just fine. But if, on the other hand, it helps one, or ten, or 1,000 suffering alcoholics out there, if it helps you and me and Stan and Ann just once in the course of a year, what price do you put on that? If it keeps one of us away from a drink, what price do you put on that? How many millions of dollars is the cost of one drink to this group of people sitting right here today? Stop and add it up in terms of anguish, opportunity, relationships, jobs, joy and lives.

Once given the freedom to walk consciously connected with the spirit of joy, wisdom and understanding that is part of the essence of a Higher Power, we, the members of the 37th General Service Conference, then have the responsibility to contribute to the future of the Grapevine.

Let me end by asking you a number of questions: When was the last time you read the Grapevine? When was the last time you wrote an article for the Grapevine? When was the last time you gave a sponsee or newcomer the gift of the Grapevine? How many of the groups you attend display the Grapevine? How many of the hospitals, prisons and institutions in your area use the Grapevine? Do you speak about the current issue of the Grapevine at the break in your meetings? Do you take the Grapevine with you on Twelfth-Step calls? Has your group conducted a Grapevine meeting? Does your group have a GvR?

J. Desmond Towe (Grapevine director)



Ivy Rivera (nonalcoholic) putting the Conference Manual on the word processor.

REPORT ON THE NINTH WORLD SERVICE MEETING

The Wednesday afternoon session began with an interesting Report on the Ninth World Service Meeting, held in Guatemala City, October 19-23, 1986.

There were many concerns expressed to me from members of my family and friends prior to our departure for Guatemala, and I have to admit to having a few moments of apprehension when we were boarding our plane in Miami for the last leg of our journey to Guatemala. Any uneasiness I felt was quickly dispersed when we were pushing our way through the security door at the airport and I saw someone waving a sign "Helen Harmon—Welcome to Guatemala." That was the beginning of a "love-in" between the Ninth World Service Meeting delegates and the A.A. members in Guatemala who were our hosts for the entire duration of our stay.

On Friday my husband and I toured Guatemala City, and on Friday night I attended two Spanish "Ah-Ah" meetings where I spoke and Alex (our host) interpreted for me and for them. They were so grateful for our attendance at their meetings and so pleased to have the World Service Meeting in Guatemala.

There were a lot of emotional A.A. greetings in the lobby of the Camino Real Hotel as second-term delegates renewed acquaintances and new delegates were introduced to people they had received letters from or corresponded with.

The opening reception was held on Sunday afternoon, and what better way ("First Things First") than with an A.A. meeting which was opened by reading the prayer of St. Francis and closed with the Serenity Prayer, as is the custom in Latin America? Each member of the Ninth World Service Meeting—delegates, staff members, and the trustees of the General Service Board of A.A. in Guatemala—spoke for a few minutes, and the W.S.M. delegate from Guatemala, Walter Siebold, acted as interpreter. As you can well imagine, this was a very emotional meeting.

The theme of the Ninth World Service Meeting was "Service Through Love and Humility," and it was attended by 35 delegates from 27 countries. All meetings and workshops had simultaneous Spanish/English translations. Japan attended for the first time, and we received a letter from Poland expressing their regrets at not being able to attend; Poland was pleased to report that their country is making progress—they now have 90 A.A. groups and 26 Al-Anon groups.

The opening address was given by the chairperson of the General Service Board of A.A. of Guatemala, Jorge Roca y Roca. He expressed the desire that "... the greatest gift we could ever receive [is] to assure that this army of victors, whom you represent, and who are today victorious because one day they had the courage to admit their defeat, may properly fulfill their service tasks and may more easily, and with better preparation reach the still-suffering alcoholic ..." (*Final Report, Ninth World Service Meeting*, p. 8).

The keynote address was given by Raymond McCrudden from Great Britain. He noted that "... just by the actuality of our very presence here, this minute constitutes Service ..."; that "humility and intellect could be compatible, provided we placed humility first ..."; and that "the basic ingredient of all humility is a desire to seek and to do God's will, and in the context of the Fellowship this could mean passing on the true message as it was given to us, embodied in the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts ..." (*Final Report, Ninth World Service Meeting*, p. 5). Raymond summed up

his talk with the wish that, during the course of our meeting, we would show our humility by learning, our love by sharing, and then perform our service by communicating what we have learned to our respective countries.

We heard reports on the European and Ibero-American Service Meetings held since the Eighth World Service Meeting. These meetings are held in alternating years with the World Service Meetings. Countries (especially South American countries) sponsor one another, and now Australia and New Zealand are sponsoring Japan, which has about 2,000 members at this time.

Most of the work of this Ninth World Service Meeting was done in committees, i.e., Agenda, Literature/Publishing, Policy/Admission/Finance, and Working With Others, as it is in our own Conference. One of the concerns of the Literature Committee was that non-A.A. literature is still being sold by some groups. It was the sense of the meeting that it is preferable for A.A. groups to sell or distribute literature published by A.A. only.

The Working With Others Committee reaffirmed a previous recommendation of the importance of making clear to A.A. members going into institutions that we take nothing inside but our message nor do we take anything out, and also that we are guests subject to all rules and regulations.

The Policy/Admissions/Finance Committee removed the restriction of a working knowledge of English in the qualifications for becoming a W.S.M. delegate; this item now reads that delegates should have a working knowledge of English or Spanish. The delegate's fee for the Tenth World Service Meeting was set at \$1,400.

We held workshops on "Understanding the Twelve Concepts," "Communication Between Countries," "Carrying the Message to Prisons and Hospitals," and "A.A. in a Changing World." There was also one unstructured workshop.

We heard presentations on "Telephone Service in A.A.," "Carrying the Message to Prisons and Hospitals," "What Makes a Good Leader in A.A.," "How Can We Make Service in A.A. More Attractive," and "Regional Forums."

Ireland noted that one of the most difficult problems they experienced was finding sponsors to meet people when they are released. In her presentation on carrying the message to hospitals, Lorraine Yudaeff (Australia) noted that "... once we have been accepted into hospitals ... be dependable. Don't take on more than you can manage, and manage what you take on." I believe the same applies to prisons. Peter Du Toit (South Africa) noted that "... a good leader learns from positive and negative criticism. One sobering thought about criticism is that when one is constantly being kicked from behind, it means one is still slightly ahead." Service in A.A. can be made more attractive through sponsorship, and gratitude demonstrated through love and action and also a better understanding of our A.A. symbol.

The agenda for the Ninth World Service meeting is very similar to our Conference agenda, and we work from 9:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m. (with time for coffee breaks and meals, of course). Because we were meeting in a Latin American country, we observed their tradition of time for a siesta by having a two-hour lunch break. You could find many of us in our bathing suits having a swim or just sunbathing, and much sharing took place among delegates and staff during these hours beside the pool and under the palm trees.

For the first time, a Delegates Only Meeting was held on Tuesday night. We discussed topics such as registering A.A. logos, self-sup-

port for countries financially unable to participate, and what was being done in carrying the message to Russia.

Most countries are registering the A.A. logo, and any country that has not done so is encouraged to take the necessary steps to do this. It was suggested that we sponsor other countries that do not participate in the World Service Meeting by sharing the reports of the Meeting and sponsoring them with our enthusiasm so that they, too, will become interested enough to find ways of raising the necessary funds to participate. It was noted that some of our attention should be given to carrying the message to countries (other than Russia) who may be more receptive at this time, and that maybe we should stick to the basic method of carrying the message of A.A., i.e., one drunk carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. The W.S.M. delegates desired to continue this dinner meeting but decided that it would be more productive to open it to all members of the Ninth World Service Meeting, i.e., staff and observers.

The Tenth World Service Meeting will be held in New York City on October 23-27, 1988, and the theme will be "A.A. and Its Responsibilities." This Meeting will coincide with the quarterly meeting of the General Service Board.

The Ninth World Service Meeting closed with a dinner hosted by the boards of the Northern Zone of Central America (Costa Rica, El Salvador, and Guatemala). We were treated to a marimba concerts, gifts from the General Service Board of Guatemala, and even a little package of Guatemalan soil so that we would always remember our visit. One member who is a composer presented a special composition to the Ninth World Service Meeting, entitled "Service Through Love and Humility"; each W.S.M. member was presented with a cassette tape of this composition. I will not hesitate to say that this has to be a "first" for A.A. Also, one member baked and decorated a beautiful cake inscribed with the banners and names of all the countries participating.

We had many moments of merriment when the Spanish delegates invariably broke into song at the dinner table (helped out at times by our own G.S.O. general manager). I am sure we all left Guatemala with a feeling of love and gratitude for a country that had done everything in its power to make us feel welcome, safe, and loved. We know that for those who did not speak Spanish and English, A.A. is truly the language of the heart.

Helen Harmon, trustee-at-large/Canada



COURT PROGRAMS— CURRENT PROBLEMS AND SOLUTIONS

Four presentations on a topic of vital interest to the Fellowship generated thoughtful discussion by Conference members during Wednesday afternoon's session. Amos Reed, Class A trustee, was the moderator.

Canada

After meeting with G.S.R.s, social workers, judges, and other personnel in the judicial system, the question of mandatory referrals to A.A. does not appear to be creating any great difficulties in Area 81. There are no laid-down policies for referrals, but referrals do happen on an individual basis, as decided by judges or other agencies. There have been a few referrals who have required that attendance slips be signed and returned to their probation officers. The group secretary merely initials the slip and away they go.

However, one problem that did come to light was a "misunderstanding" as to what the A.A. program is all about and exactly what we are trying to do. There is a widespread misconception in Area 81 that we are a *treatment organization* instead of a *recovery program*. I suppose we are a treatment facility in one way if you think of a room full of A.A. members sharing their experience, strength, and hope as "group therapy."

The general consensus is that "reluctant" or "judicial agency referred" attendants at A.A. meetings are not really concerned about anonymity, as the practice of the press has been to publish individuals' full names, along with the fact that they have been sentenced to a period of A.A. attendance. We reach some of these mandatory referrals because they are ready for the program. Others pay lip service while at meetings and then disregard A.A. Traditions by talking out-of-turn. This may not harm them personally, but it gives a poor impression of A.A. to people who do not understand the imperative requirement for anonymity.

What about the newcomer or those who have a few 24 hours but who are really concerned about their identities? Who do we owe more responsibility to? My area feels that each group is responsible to meet and greet new members, be they voluntary or otherwise, and explain to them the meaning of the Twelfth Tradition as it relates to themselves and others. There is also an essential requirement for the chairperson of the committee on cooperation with the professional community in each district to educate the professionals—including the press—as to the basic principles which guide us.

It is well understood that A.A. is there for those who have a desire to stop drinking, but many mandatory referrals are not ready for this program and have to be "led by the hand" for their time with us in the hopes of planting the seed for a future time when they will be ready. We must keep in mind that not all mandatory referrals are alcoholics; a percentage of them are people who fail to use common sense after a few drinks.

I realize that mandatory referrals are not as prevalent in Area 81 as in other areas, and that problems encountered in other areas may become ours sometime in the future. But it is felt that, with careful attention to each newcomer, education of the media and the professional community, and a willingness on our part to spread the word and attract those with a desire to stop drinking, we will be able to help a large percentage of those who really want help—whether they know it or not!

Lawrence Adams (New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island)

Massachusetts

When I received my "loving invitation" to share with you the experience of our area in the matter of court programs—problems and solutions, I felt an immediate sense of gratitude for the efforts of those people who preceded me in service in the area I'm privileged to serve. It is largely the result of their foresight that this issue is not really a problem in Western Massachusetts.

It seems ironic that when our Fellowship was in its infancy, those few pioneer members, along with our co-founders, searched for people they thought the program of recovery could help. Today, when these same people come to us, no matter what the motivation may be, we not only fail to regard individuals with cards to be signed as an opportunity for Twelfth Step work, but seem to resent the fact that they are there at all.

In my time in A.A., I have yet to encounter anyone who has stayed with us who did not begin their journey to sobriety without some influence from someone other than themselves. I really don't know why we gladly embrace people sent to us by their employers, spouses, or friends and shun them if they are referred to us by a judge or probation officer. These court officials send their clients to us because, first of all, we asked them to through the offices of our P.I. and institutions committees and, secondly (and probably most importantly), they have come to know that our suggested program of recovery works!

If we are to consider this influx of persons attending our meetings from the court system as a problem, then it should be worthy of the same serious effort to resolve it that we give to any other problem. Are we to be so selective and so rigid in who or under what conditions we help someone? Are we going to consider everyone who comes to us through the court system as unable to join us because a judge sent them to us? Or are we going to treat them as persons who deserve as much as we deserved, the right to share what was so freely and lovingly given to us?

I would like to share with you what our area has done in this regard. Some judges and probation officers recognize that some of the persons who enter the court system could best be served by attending A.A. meetings. Since we have so many beginners and open meetings, their attendance has not been a problem, to my knowledge, albeit some members are rather reluctant to sign an attendance slip. Someone from the group will invariably accommodate them, however.

Another thing that has reduced this "problem" has been the establishment of "honor courts" where persons, as a result of their probation, must attend a prescribed number of A.A. meetings. These meetings are held in the courtrooms; attendance is monitored by the probation department, and A.A. members are able to "carry the message" while being able to explain that they are not part of the judicial system but are simply sharing their experience, strength and hope. I number among some of my best friends people who have attained years of continued sobriety due, in no small part, to attending these honor courts.

Massachusetts law requires that persons convicted of driving while under the influence of alcohol more than twice must be incarcerated for 60 days or more. Because it has been determined that they and the public at large will be best served by these individuals' recognizing the severity of their underlying problem with alcohol, they must receive treatment for alcohol abuse.

Although this program is administered by an agency outside of A.A., our institutions and P.I. committees contribute to and cooperate with this agency when asked to do so. In some instances, persons confined to these institutions may be permitted

to attend open A.A. meetings in the area; as far as I can determine, they are welcome to do so by the majority of groups and members.

When I first entered the doors of this precious Fellowship, I was treated like a part of humanity who had some worth for the first time in a long time. I fondly remember that feeling today. It was that tolerance and that love that has allowed me to help carry the message of recovery to others. I pray that I will always remember that I was not that different from any other newcomer today, and that I will always be willing to share this message with others without regard for where they came from or who sent them to us.

Paul O. Davidson (Western Massachusetts)

Texas

"Some day we hope that every alcoholic who journeys will find a Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous at his destination . . . [where] those of us who travel drop in as often as we can. Thus we grow." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 162.)

"Our very first problem is to accept our present circumstances as they are, ourselves as we are, and the people about us they are. This is to adopt a realistic humility without which no genuine advance can even begin. Again and again, we shall need to return to that unflattering point of departure. This is an exercise in acceptance that we can profitably practice every day of our lives.

"Provided we strenuously avoid turning these realistic surveys of the facts of life into unrealistic alibis for apathy or defeatism, they can be the sure foundation upon which increased emotional health, and therefore spiritual progress can be built." (Bill Wilson, A.A. Grapevine, March 1962.)

"Too often, I think, we have deprecated and even derided projects of our friends in the field of alcoholism just because we do not always see eye to eye with them. We should very seriously ask ourselves how many alcoholics have gone on drinking simply because we have failed to cooperate in good spirit with these many agencies—whether they be good, bad, or indifferent. No alcoholic should go mad or die merely because he did not come straight to A.A. at the beginning." (Bill Wilson, A.A. Grapevine, July 1965.)

"We can be grateful for every agency or method that tries to solve the problem of alcoholism in their own field. We can be open-minded toward all such efforts and we can be sympathetic when the ill-advised ones fail. We can remember that A.A. itself ran for years on trial and error. As individuals, we can and should work with those that promise success—even a little success. Every one of the pioneers in the total field of alcoholism will generously say that had it not been for the living proof of recovery in A.A., they could not have gone on. A.A. was the lodestar of hope and help that kept them at it." (Bill Wilson, A.A. Grapevine, March 1958.)

"To reach more alcoholics, understanding of A.A. and public good will toward A.A. must go on growing everywhere." (Bill Wilson, "Third Legacy Manual," p. 136.)

"Nothing matters more to A.A.'s future welfare than the manner in which we use the colossus of modern communication. Used unselfishly and well, it can produce results surpassing our present imagination. Should we handle this great instrument badly, we shall be shattered by the ego manifestations of our own people. Against this peril, A.A. members' anonymity before the general public is our shield and our buckler." (Bill Wilson, A.A. Grapevine, November 1960.)

"Few of us are anonymous so far as our daily contacts go. We have dropped anonymity at this level because we think our friends and associates ought to know about A.A. and what it has done for us. We also wish to lose the fear of admitting that we are alcoholics. Though we earnestly request reporters not to disclose our identities, we frequently speak before semipublic gatherings. We wish to convince audiences that our alcoholism is a sickness we no longer fear to discuss before anyone.

"If, however, we venture beyond this limit, we shall surely lose the principle of anonymity forever." (Bill Wilson, A.A. Grapevine, January 1946.)

The solution to the problem of alcoholism seems still to be in employers, families, courts, and the public at large. Obviously it is both a community job and a job for specialists. Individually, we A.A.s can help, but A.A. as such cannot and should not get directly involved. Therefore, we must rely on other agencies, on outside friends and their willingness to supply great amounts of money and effort.

In the past 50-plus years, our labor has not been in vain, but there is still much to be done. It is still hoped that A.A. will continue to help the public to a better realization of the gravity of the alcohol problem, but we shall be of little use if our own attitude is one of bitterness or hostility. Drinkers will not stand for it.

Some areas of Northwest Texas have court programs paid for and supported by city and county courts, with their own probation departments; they refer people directly to different types of agencies, counselors in private practice, and to A.A. and N.A. And therein lies the local A.A. groups' responsibility to properly educate those folk on "what A.A. is and what A.A. is not"—a privilege, not punishment—for better cooperation and stressing anonymity. Smaller towns and communities know of A.A.s living sober, and they often are called upon by the local authorities for help.

In our area, through our cooperation with the hospitals and treatment programs, there are "bridging-the-gap" groups, sponsorship to A.A. and N.A., introductory education in service work, as well as proper use of our own guidelines.

Over all, our Northwest Texas Area does not seem to have the large problems that are encountered in the larger cities.

The great reward for the A.A. member is a better understanding of Unity, Service, and Recovery, and the joy of continuous sobriety.

Bonnie Taylor (Northwest Texas)

Maryland

You already have been sent a detailed report of Maryland's experience with D.W.I.s and court slips in our meetings. That was prepared by myself and our area chairperson and distributed a couple of months ago to you all. So I won't go on at length with what you so easily can read at your leisure. But let me hit some high spots in that report and finish with a brief discussion of potential future problems and a modest suggestion.

I note, particularly in a copy of Box 4-5-9 of some months ago, that some areas are in the early stages of handling court-referred D.W.I.s. Because we in Maryland were one of the first areas to deal with signing court slips on a large-scale basis, our experience may be of use to others. It is in that spirit that we pass our experience on to you.

A.A. has a history of being helpful to people with an alcohol problem who are referred from courts. It is nothing new to A.A. What is new are the approach and methods of recent years. While in former days the individual A.A. member initiated the contact with the individual in trouble who wanted help, in these times we have had a totally different situation—at least in my area. Our experience has been that the state has arrested and convicted people and then “sentenced” them to A.A. for rehabilitation. I suggest that this is not our purpose or function.

What happened in Maryland is that we became engulfed in a situation that threatened our unity. The numbers of court-referred people grew gigantically, to the point where they outnumbered by far our regular membership. Many of these people did not want to be at A.A. meetings and resented the whole situation. The result? Groups and meetings became severely overcrowded, with lack of attention and extraneous noise. Anonymity of regular members was broken. Alcoholics Anonymous was regarded as part of the state’s punitive system, an arm of the court. Regular members felt intimidated, and many left meetings and groups they were accustomed to attending. Those who provided us with meeting places—churches, for the most part—suffered damages. And they voiced their complaints in the public press.

While we in A.A. had begun from the standpoint of cooperation, state authorities became less and less cooperative, evidently feeling that they had open and unlimited access to our resources. With the problem approaching the point where it was nearly out of hand, our unity was severely threatened.

As the report you have received points out, we moved deliberately and carefully to May 1986 when, in an area assembly, we overwhelmingly voted to limit our cooperation to providing A.A. speakers for meetings that the state would organize and monitor. Where there had been much discussion during our assemblies—which were often disrupted with this issue—over violation of the Traditions, particularly Traditions Six and Ten, our action was not taken on the basis of those Traditions but on the essential issue of preserving our unity, as expressed in Tradition One.

Where do we stand now? Few groups in Maryland sign any court slips whatsoever. But our decision evidently is not acceptable to the state. Our state has created a structure in its approach to handling its D.W.I. problem, it appears, promised on the use of Alcoholics Anonymous. In other words, we are, in their view, necessary to how they will handle those who violate driving and drinking laws in Maryland.

One official has said that the state “intends to use A.A.” for that purpose. The state’s intention, as stated by some state officials, will be to encourage A.A. members who came via the court system to start “A.A.” meetings for the purpose of signing slips and thus continue to carry out the state’s aims.

That is the potential problem. We in Maryland think it is a problem A.A. as a whole, as well as our own area, is going to have to address. The question may become one of misuse of the very name “Alcoholics Anonymous.”

I come before you empty-handed as far as answers to the problem are concerned. But, as a beginning point, we might look to the Guidelines on Cooperation With the Courts, and we might think of modifying those Guidelines and bringing them up to date, with a view to contending with what the future may bring.

Gene Ray (Maryland)

MAINTAINING THE BASICS — A.A.’S PRINCIPLES

Following the conclusion of the Advisory Actions and related business, the 37th Conference had time to relax Friday afternoon during the final presentation/discussion session and focus on the fundamental issue of our primary purpose. Jim Shannon, Class B trustee, was the moderator.

Our Primary Purpose — Is It Changing In a Changing World?

Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity having but one primary purpose—that of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Many times I need to be brought back to this, our Fifth Tradition, lest I lose the forest for the trees.

As a hopeless street drunk and wino whose life has been spared by this beautiful Fellowship, I started to give service as I was able, little by little. Coffee maker, telephone answering service, G.S.R., D.C.M., chairperson of the area assembly, finally—no, I hope not finally—delegate. You see, I must stay in service. It seems to be my lifeblood.

As is probably true with many of you, as I got further and further away from my last drink I rotated through service jobs in Alcoholics Anonymous, attempting to create a balance in my life at work, at home and in A.A. I found the demands on my time a challenge to say the least. They say the brain is like a computer, able to sort out the details before we even give it a thought. Maybe that is why I have to be constantly alert as other priorities begin to take precedence over this life-saving, life-giving Fellowship. What about my commitment at the state prison? My group’s finances are such that we can’t give all that much to the area and G.S.O. Who’s the Grapevine rep? Workshop? Who’s got the time? Treatment facilities committee? Public information? We don’t have any volunteers! I am torn. C.P.C.? Archives? Report and Charter? General Service Board? Literature—books, pamphlets, guidelines, workbooks, films. All of these services seem to fit under the umbrella of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. They all seem to have equal priority.

As we know, the good is sometimes the enemy of the best. Have we reached that point? Would we ever know if we had reached that point? Are there indicators to give an alarm when we are approaching a dangerous crossroad?

Let me tell you about my home group for a minute. When I first joined my group, it was a smokey place, often had active drunks, newcomers were shaking (me included) and sweating, and you know what? Nobody paid any attention. God love these people; they accepted me the way I was. “Just keep coming back,” they told me.

As the years passed, our group moved a couple of times and now it is in the local hospital—rugs on the floors, no smoking, clean, white, sanitary. The other night they were talking about spilling coffee on the rug; I guess that’s good. I guess the fact that it’s a no-smoking group now is good. But I think I would have had trouble coming into my group now.

Which of these is “the best”? For me, without a doubt the first place. I needed to feel a part of them. I wonder if I could have done so in the sanitized version of today. But I will stick with my group through this; maybe I’m wrong. But I’ll tell them how I feel all the same.

Today I see many individuals working along that fine line between attraction and promotion. As more and more treatment facilities spring up around the area, more and more recovering alcoholics

find their way into that field. It becomes increasingly important to have people on the treatment facilities committees that are familiar with A.A. guidelines, workbooks and the Traditions. Most of the time we don't have individuals who meet that criteria. They're just alcoholics. They'll put on a meeting for you if you want. Oh, you want more than that? Sorry.

Do you suppose there are any doctors, lawyers, treatment facility directors who cannot find Alcoholics Anonymous if they want to? I doubt it. Is that enough? Do we not only have to let them know we are alive and well, but provide them detailed descriptions of our program, the literature available, our guidelines, our definition of an A.A. group? How many individuals in a given treatment facility are alcoholics? How many addicts? Can anybody tell? Do we have to make sure the treatment facility is correctly describing Alcoholics Anonymous? Must we police this? Who will police it? Police? What are we looking for? Large scale impact? Are we afraid that there might be one alcoholic in the facility who might not get the word? It seems to me I read about how Bill and Dr. Bob used to interview potential candidates for A.A. If they thought the individual hadn't suffered enough, they'd tell him to go back out for a while.

Yes, I believe our primary purpose is changing in a changing world. I believe when we spend more time finding new and innovative ways to ferret out every last known category of potential alcoholic instead of looking in the street, we have reached the crossroad. We are like the weatherman who is so wrapped up in his computerized weather map, he forgot to look out the window.

I believe what's said around here—that if they're ready, you can't say anything wrong; if they're not ready, you can't say anything right. This has been proven true to me many times. I believe it's time to take our inventory to assure our primary purpose.

Peter G. Robinson (New Hampshire)

The Twelve Steps—The Joy of Living

I came to A.A. burdened with despair, fear, guilt, loneliness, and no faith in God. These defects allowed me to justify my behavior. You assured me I wasn't unique but that I was suffering from a threefold illness called "alcoholism," an illness that could be arrested by applying the 200 words called the "Twelve Steps" in my life on a daily basis. I became aware by sponsorship and example that the Twelve Steps were the tools that could release me from bondage of self. It was weeks before I was able to grasp the meaning of the statements you made about the Steps, but my sponsor was patient and understanding and insisted I study the Steps each day.

Three months after my last drink, my sponsor gave me a book entitled *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, with orders to read it daily. I followed his instruction and learned I was dry, not sober. This is when sobriety became an obsession, and I started practicing the principles to the best of my ability in all my affairs. While reading the Foreword one night, these words seemed to be in bold print: "A.A.'s Twelve Steps are a group of principles, spiritual in their nature, which, if practiced as a way of life, can expel the obsession to drink and enable the sufferer to become happily and usefully whole." (*Twelve and Twelve*, p. 15.)

Immediately I turned to the Contents and wrote a list of many good things I could look forward to by living the Steps—liberation, a return to sanity, a dependence on God as a means of independence, an ability to recognize assets and liabilities, an ability to

give and receive forgiveness, the knowledge of God's will, a change of attitude, the end of isolation, peace of mind, emotional balance, the rewards of meditation and prayer, and the joy of living, which is the theme of the Twelfth Step.

Our beloved Bernard B. Smith said, "Through our Steps and Traditions, we have been changed from spiritless, leaden creatures into golden examples of energy, usefulness, and happiness." To be a useful person in A.A., community, and home, I needed to discover myself through the application of the Steps. In doing so, I have been blessed with many gifts: freedom to be and to like me; freedom from the loneliness that drove me into the bottle time after time; and, best of all, freedom to share my experience, strength, and hope with the suffering alcoholic.

Dr. Bob said, "To acquire a spirit of dedicated service is what this Fellowship is all about, and those among us who fail to acquire this spirit . . . may have missed the single most important principle that A.A. has to give." I was to pray daily for guidance and understanding of my responsibilities to our Fellowship and always examine my motives before action. Love and tolerance—a product of the Twelve Steps—would endow a quality of peace of mind, contentment, and happiness. When these attributes were mine, I too, could speak the message of the heart that Dr. Bob had as he worked with thousands. A.A. is a society in action.

Bill W. said, "Our Twelfth Step, carrying the message, is the basic service that the A.A. Fellowship gives. This is our principal aim and the main reason for our existence." "Action" is the key word. A giving that expects no reward, a love that has no price tag, and a new state of consciousness and being are but a few of the rewards of carrying the message.

During his last public appearance, Bill W. said, "I know Alcoholics Anonymous will live another thousand years—if it's God's will." We thank God for His inspiration and Bill's dedication to a vision that has enabled us and will continue to enable millions to trudge "the Road of Happy Destiny," providing we, as trusted servants, assembled here for the 37th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, accept the challenges as they appear on the horizon and live the Twelve Steps.

Buddy Holder (Mississippi)

The Twelve Traditions — "Tools" of the Fellowship

Yes, I believe the Twelve Traditions are "tools" of the Fellowship. As stated in *A.A. Comes of Age* (p. 79), "Ours is not the usual success story; rather it is the story of how, under God's grace, an unsuspected strength has arisen out of great weakness; of how, under threats of disunity and collapse, worldwide unity and brotherhood have been forged. In the course of this experience we have evolved a set of traditional principles by which we live and work together and relate ourselves as a fellowship to the world around us. These principles are called the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous. They represent the distilled experience of our past, and we rely on them to carry us in unity through the challenges and dangers which the future may bring."

"But the Twelve Traditions also point straight at many of our individual defects. By implication they ask each of us to lay aside pride and resentment. They ask for personal as well as group sacrifice. They ask us never to use the A.A. name in any quest for personal power or distinction or money. The Traditions guarantee the equality of all members and the independence of all groups. They show how we may best relate ourselves to each other and to the world outside. They indicate how we can best

function in harmony as a great whole. For the sake of the welfare of our entire society, the Traditions ask that every individual and every group and every area in A.A. shall lay aside all desires, ambitions, and untoward actions that could bring serious division among us or lose for us the confidence of the world at large.

"The Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous symbolize the sacrificial character of our life together and they are the greatest force for unity we know." (ibid, p. 96-97.) "Therefore each of our Twelve Traditions is really an expression of the deflation that each of us has to take, of the sacrifice that we shall all have to make in order to live and work together." (ibid, p. 136.)

I was the noisy drunk who had to go to many meetings before I obtained sobriety; the group loved me, kept me in line, and told me to "keep coming back." It was finally three years later in a meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous, drunk on wine, that I had a moment of clarity and put the plug in the jug. Thank God the group kept functioning and was still there when I was ready.

When the man who was the victim of another addiction even more stigmatized than alcoholism wanted to join the group, the early members were concerned. "If we turn this man away, he'll soon die. If we allow him in, only God knows what trouble he'll brew." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 142.) Deciding to take him in, "the newcomer plunged into Twelfth Step work. Tirelessly he laid A.A.'s message before scores of people. . . . Never did he trouble anyone with his other difficulty." (ibid, p. 142.) Because of this Tradition, our dually addicted cannot be turned away, ". . . that any alcoholic is a member of our Society when he says so." (ibid, p. 145.)

Some of us in my little group decided that we were tired of our husbands, some of whom were still drinking. We decided to try "girl meets boy on the A.A. campus." Our sponsors kept saying, "Your actions are affecting A.A." We replied "How can they be?" But we soon saw that our actions kept prospective members from joining. Their comments were, "You mean you come to A.A. and divorce your husband or wife? If that is the case, we want nothing to do with this A.A. bit."

"Unless each A.A. member follows to the best of his ability our suggested Twelve Steps of recovery, he almost certainly signs his own death warrant . . . Unless there is approximate conformity to A.A.'s Twelve Traditions, the group too, can deteriorate and die. So we of A.A. do obey spiritual principles, first because we must, and ultimately because we love the kind of life such obedience brings. Great suffering and great love are A.A.'s disciplinarians; we need no others." (ibid, p. 174.)

As far as living and working together goes, Bill Wilson said, "If we can succeed in this adventure and keep succeeding, then and only then will our future be secure. We know that Alcoholics Anonymous must continue to live, else save few exceptions, we and alcoholics throughout the world will surely resume the hopeless journey to oblivion."

Almost any A.A. can tell you what our group problems are. Fundamentally they have to do with our relations among ourselves and with the world outside. They involve how the A.A. member relates to his group, the relation of his group to Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, and the place of Alcoholics Anonymous in the troubled sea called modern society, where humankind must presently shipwreck or find haven.

Terribly relevant is the problem of our basic structure and our attitude toward those ever-pressing questions of leadership, money and authority. The future may well depend on how we feel and act about things that are controversial, and how we

handle our public relations. Our destiny hangs upon what we presently decide to do with these danger-fraught issues.

Gradually we saw that the unity, the effectiveness, yes, even the survival of A.A. would always depend upon our continued willingness to sacrifice our personal ambitions and desires for our common safety and welfare. Just as sacrifice meant survival for the individual, so did sacrifice mean unity and survival for the group and for A.A.'s entire Fellowship.

As our Twelve and Twelve states: "The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. We stay whole, or A.A. dies. Without unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God; His gift to us would be spent aimlessly. Back again in their caves, alcoholics would reproach us and say, 'What a great thing A.A. might have been!'" (ibid, p. 129.)

It became plain that the group must survive or the individual will not. We "live today in the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, which—God willing—shall sustain us in unity for as long as He may need us." (ibid, p. 131.)

Kathy Jarchow (Oregon)

The Twelve Concepts — How Can We Live the Concepts in Service?

How can we live? A very important word for the alcoholic. In the words of our co-founder, Bill W., "A.A. is more than a set of principles. It is a society for alcoholics in action." We must carry the message, or else we ourselves can wither. Those who haven't been given the truth may die. The late Bernard Smith, a past nonalcoholic chairperson of our General Service Board of Trustees, stated the following about our General Service Conference:

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1987

	Groups	Members
United States	36,002	727,145
Canada	4,540	76,377
Overseas	30,868 ¹	698,271 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,782 ²	53,460 ²
Internationalists		543
Lone members		520
	73,192	1,556,316

1. At the end of 1986, we had reported members from 68 of the 115 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 25,608 groups and 578,180 members. To establish an estimate for the 47 countries not yet responding, we excluded the eight largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 47 and the overall estimate emerged.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

"We need it to insure the recovery of the alcoholic who still stumbles in the darkness, seeking the light. We need it to insure the recovery of some newborn child inexplicably destined to alcoholism. We need it to provide, in keeping with the Twelfth Step, a permanent haven for all alcoholics who in the ages ahead can find in A.A. that rebirth which brought its first members back to life." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 281.)

Thanks to Alcoholics Anonymous, our fellow members, A.A. groups, the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts, we have been granted that privilege to live—"One Day At A Time."

When our co-founder Dr. Bob was asked about the spiritual part of the program, he answered, "The whole program is spiritual." A verse I feel relates to spirituality is as follows: "I sought my soul, my soul I could not see. I sought my God, but He eluded me. I sought my brother, and found all three."

To live the Concepts, we must practice these principles in all of our affairs. We can (and unknowingly do) work the Twelve Concepts in many ways: in our everyday living, our domestic homes, our work, our leisure and recreational time, as well as at our A.A. home groups, district meetings, area assemblies, and the General Service Conference.

The first two Concepts have key words: "confidence," "trust," and "responsibility." At the 1955 A.A. International Convention in St. Louis, the Fellowship assumed responsibility from our founders. Our "confidence" comes from Tradition Two: "For our group purpose, there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern." May they find the wisdom to know the difference. In my personal life, I need to know the collective conscience of my family's thinking, my fellow man, at work and at play, in order to survive somewhat normally in everyday life.

Concept III tells me I have the "Right of Decision." I can decide which A.A. groups I wish to attend. As we worked up through the service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous as G.S.R., D.C.M., area secretary, treasurer, chairperson, and delegate, we are called on many times to make decisions. This is a trust given to us by our fellow A.A. members. Several years ago, my wife and I were called on to make a decision regarding the children. While in the doctor's office having our five-year-old daughter's toe sewed as a result of a bicycle accident, our eleven-year-old son brought in his ten-year-old brother from the parked car. The ten-year-old had drunk lighter fluid. We quickly made the decision to have his stomach pumped instead of finishing the toe surgery at the time. Remember—"First Things First."

Concept IV tells me I belong—I have the "Right of Participation." The spiritual aspect tells me no member is regarded as "second class." I can participate in family get-togethers, union meetings, and office functions and worship at the church of my choice.

Concept V, the "Right of Appeal," gives me the right to be recognized and heard from. We can express ourselves, which keeps us from becoming a rubber-stamped society. We cherish our individual freedom to express ourselves—rightfully or wrongfully—to be heard. I would like to make a comparison to the conventional washing machine. You can put in water and detergent, but nothing will happen until that "agitator" starts and shakes all the "dirt" out.

Concept VI brings out the wide latitude of judgment and responsibility given the trustees and their freedom to discharge their duties as "custodians" of the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts worldwide. From top to bottom, our whole service structure resembles a large corporation. The A.A. groups are stockholders; the delegates are their representatives or proxies at the "Annual Meeting." Our General Service Board of Trustees are actually the directors of a holding company; this holding company owns and controls the subsidiaries, which carry on our active world services. (My wife and I must assume that latitude of judgment in raising our family. We are the bankers for the family, discharging and deciding where the monies are best used to ensure the future security of the family.)

Concepts VII, VIII, IX, and X really test the spirituality of the structure and the Traditions. In a sense, they seem contradictory, especially Concept VII. The legal power of the trustees is exercised in these Concepts. Currently, the General Service Board reserves the veto power over any Conference action. Hopefully, in years ahead, the Conference will continue to recognize the rights, duties, responsibilities, and legal status of the General Service Board. Perhaps issues can always be resolved in a harmonious manner because one is protected by tradition and the other by law.

Concept XI tells me we need the utmost cooperation and understanding between all standing committees of the General Service Board, its subsidiary operating boards, the General Service Office, and the Grapevine. For a successful family life, all members need to cooperate. We also need the direction and advice of our doctors, lawyers, and clergy to function in a normal society.

The safety valve for our service structure comes to us in the form of the general Warranties of the Conference in Concept XII. They protect us against overzealous wealth or power and ensure financial security and that we remain democratic in thought and action.

In closing, the Concepts exemplify spirituality, humility, responsibility, and compassion for the suffering alcoholic. As I live the Concepts, "My cup runneth over" and I "... shall be with you in the Fellowship of the Spirit," and we will surely meet again as we "trudge the Road of Happy Destiny."

Dan Byrne (*West Central U.S. regional trustee*)



Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Nineteen eighty-six was a particularly eventful year. Situations which seemed to be serious at the start of the year were resolved or improved. However, I am sure that the year ahead will bring new challenges.

First let me discuss some events involving the Grapevine. In 1985 the board formed an oversight committee and engaged outside consultants to examine the Grapevine operation. Two outside consulting firms were engaged, and in due course they reported findings on the structure of the Grapevine and recommendations as to changes. Before the ad hoc committee formulated its own final recommendations, the managing editor became dissatisfied with the direction in which the study was proceeding. Her resignation was unanimously accepted by the Grapevine Board, with the unanimous approval of the trustees. The Grapevine Board authorized interim management by Ann Warner, editor, and Don Meurer, controller.

The Grapevine Board looks forward to the completion of its examination of the long-standing problems of the Grapevine, both by a new ad hoc committee and by the Grapevine Board itself. It confidently expects that the ultimate result will be a continuing, viable role for the Grapevine in A.A.

In my report to the 1986 Conference I also emphasized the board's concern regarding our deviation from a condition of self-support which had been allowed to grow over the past ten years. The fact that a substantial part of the deviation from our tradition of self-support by our own contributions has been made up by publishing income derived from outside sources has not been emphasized in the past. It is the source of particular concern to the General Service Board and the A.A.W.S. Board.

The A.A.W.S. Board has mounted a vigorous campaign of communication to the Fellowship and already there is indication of a heartening response. This topic will receive a great deal of attention at this Conference. The solution cannot be a one-shot funding campaign. We have to create a heightened awareness by the A.A. members of what they belong to and what their responsibility is, resulting in a continued higher level of support for all levels of A.A. service.

A seminar was organized among representatives of intergroups and central offices. An important general purpose was served: the beginnings of better communication with G.S.O. and with the general service structure, not to mention better communications between those offices. The seminar was a success; 82 offices were represented. The attendees requested another seminar this year, which G.S.O. is in the process of organizing.

Since the 1986 Conference, Bob Pearson has retired completely from G.S.O. As you undoubtedly know, Bob has served for the past two years as a part-time senior advisor to John Bragg and the other members of the G.S.O. staff. Prior to that, for ten years he served as G.S.O.'s general manager. The General Service Board is indebted to Bob for his long period of distinguished service on behalf of the board and the Fellowship as a whole.

The 1986 Conference chose three possible sites for the 1990 International Convention, with the specific selection to be accomplished by the General Service Board, based on a detailed study of facilities and costs at the three locations. Seattle, Washington, was selected. Administration of the International Convention is contracted to an outside firm, Slack Associates. Under the supervision of the trustees' Committee on the International Convention and G.S.O. staff, Slack Associates is going ahead with detailed planning and contractual negotiations with the various private and public organizations in Seattle that will be concerned with the operation of the Convention.

In the above connection and in many other recent activities of the General Service Board, it has been necessary to engage specialized outside firms to provide needed expertise and knowledge. On occasion, members have expressed concern about this practice. I think it is part of the reaching toward maturity that is so necessary in our growing operations to recognize when we need help, and to seek it out. It certainly is part of efficient management. I think we are aware, in such areas as the loss of the Big Book copyright, that perhaps in the past we have been too much a "do-it-yourself" organization, and that costly mistakes can be made by organizations attempting to use shortcuts to save money or to demonstrate independence.

Our service structure appears to be standing up well against increasing pressures and challenges from the changing world around us. It appears to have the flexibility to adjust to the new demands. Further changes appear to be inevitable, but I am confident that the A.A. program of recovery and hope will endure as long as everyone at every level continues to exercise the tolerance and trust which are our Higher Power's wish for us.

Gordon Patrick, chairperson

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: The board met 12 times during 1986. The following significant items are noted:

- Reviewed and recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee: the 1986 budget; the revised budget for construction and refurbishing, which totaled \$865,200, an increase over the preliminary budget of \$744,800 projected in the 1986 budget; and proposed budget additions as of June 30, 1986, in the amount of \$58,600.
- With board authorization, A.A.W.S., Inc., transferred \$516,600 to the General Service Board to cover operating deficits for the year ended December 31, 1985.
- Held interim meetings to address the subject of self-support. The paper "Challenge of the Seventh Tradition" was distributed to past and present delegates, intergroups and central offices,



and all D.C.M.s. The mailing to D.C.M.s was accompanied by a summary for their use with G.S.R.s and groups. Our aim is that within five years, contributions will cover the cost of our services to the Fellowship.

- Notified Canadian central offices and intergroups that an unauthorized miniature version of the first 11 chapters of the Big Book was published in Hong Kong and offered for sale in Calgary, Alberta. Jack Ford contacted the person behind this project, informing him of our concerns and that the Canadian copyright is still in effect. We have no notice of further activity.

- Distributed copies of the portable soft-cover edition of the Big Book in November 1986 to trustees, directors and delegates.

- Approved the following prices: Big Book, portable soft-cover edition, \$4.80 (non-A.A. price) and \$4.15 (A.A. members' price, the same discount as applied to the hard-cover Big Book); A.A. Comes of Age, cassette album, \$25; Traditions flyer in large type, 10¢; Discount package #1 and #2, \$20 and \$70; Steps and Traditions standup display, \$14; A.A. Member display, \$14; Markings on the Journey (filmstrip), \$35; Your G.S.O. Today (filmstrip), \$35; Circles of Love and Service (filmstrip), \$35; "If You are a Professional" (revised), 15¢; "Twelve Concepts Illustrated," 30¢; Correctional Facilities Workbook (Spanish), \$7; C.P.C. Workbook (Spanish), \$7; "A.A. in Treatment Centers" (Spanish), 20¢; C.P.C. package #1 and #2 (both Spanish), \$25 and \$75; Living Sober, (Polish) \$2.75—for sale from G.S.O., U.S./Canada; New P.S.A.s (five English, five French), \$12 each; Bill's Own Story (film), weekly rental, \$35; long-term leasing, \$275; Bill's Last Message—poster (Spanish), \$1.50; Dr. Bob's Farewell Talk—poster (Spanish), \$1.50; "This is A.A." (Korean and Vietnamese), 20¢; "44 Questions" (Korean and Vietnamese), 45¢.

- Recommended to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee that the limitation of \$2,500 on financial commitments, which the A.A.W.S. Board can make for new projects, be increased to \$10,000, and that the members of the corporation amend the Bylaws accordingly.

- The first Intergroup/Central Office Seminar, held in Chicago on September 5-7, 1986, proved to be a long-needed step toward better communication among all service entities. Attendees voted to meet again in 1987.

- Approved 77 requests to reprint from A.A. literature and two requests to tape-record. Thirteen requests were not approved.

- Authorized the signing of a lease for the eleventh floor of 468 Park Avenue South, New York City, effective July 1, 1986.

- Approved the establishment of a new joint Employees' Retirement Committee for A.A.W.S., Inc., and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

- Approved modifications of long-term disability provisions contained in the Employees' Retirement Plan in order to eliminate duplication of provisions contained in the Employees' Retirement Plan and the long-term disability insurance policy.

- Engaged an employee-assistance-program firm (Waldman-Shay), whose confidential services will be available to employees and families and will include assistance for family, alcohol, drugs and other problems.

- A labor union that attempted to organize two departments at the General Service Office has now withdrawn its petition.

- Proposed our 1987 budget and projected sufficient income to introduce a 4% discount on literature orders of \$25.00 or more.

- After 11 years of service, Bob Pearson retired on February 11, 1987.

Shepherd Raimi, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: We met three times since the 1986 Conference. Future meetings will be held at the Hotel Roosevelt in New York City to facilitate integration with other trustee activities. The summer meeting, however, will continue to be held at the General Service Office to allow committee members an opportunity to see new acquisitions to the collection and explore improved organization of the material.

A subcommittee was formed to study how we might help the Conference Policy and Admissions Committee as a resource in deliberations on the feasibility of a Conference Archives Committee. Relevant material was gathered and presented to the secretary of the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions.

Our Archival Handbook was revised to reflect additional information reported from centers for area archives. There are more than 60 such centers in the United States and Canada.

A system has been designed to ensure the physical retention of historically important items from group files after these have been microfiched. Future historians will have an opportunity to see these originals.

Both the History of the Trustees' Archives Committee and the Composition, Scope and Procedures were reviewed and revised.



Archival display panels depicting highlights of A.A.'s history

The audience of *Markings*, our archival newsletter, was expanded to include delegates, past delegates, alternates, trustees, and past trustees. This action was taken in keeping with our overall objective to reach out as widely as possible to collect the artifacts and oral histories of our earlytimers.

A smaller version of our Archival Exhibit was commissioned. It can be set up easily by one person on a countertop or table and thus is available for Regional Forums and more area conventions.

Joe Phelan, chairperson

Archivist's report: From many reports, our reaching the earlytimers project ("Don't Throw Me Away, I Belong to A.A.") has had quite a beneficial effect on donation of archivally valuable artifacts to the local area archives. Much material has been collected locally, and, just as important, a large number of oral histories were taken from these early members.

1986 was something of a banner year for acquisitions. Particularly welcomed were a number of area histories: *Golden Moments of Reflections*, a history of A.A. in Eastern Missouri from 1940 to 1985; *Saskatchewan, A.A. Legacy; Historical Events, People and Dates in the Milwaukee-Wisconsin Area*; *The History of A.A. in Ontario*; and *How A.A. Got Started in Arkansas*. Additionally, we received several large donations of historical books.

A thoughtful member from Brooklyn, New York sent us page 669 of the 1936 Brooklyn Telephone Directory. One listing reads: "Wilson Wm. G. 182 Clinton . . . Main 4-3220."

With the production of a smaller version of our traveling Archival Exhibit, a number of "archival" items are now available to present our history to members. These include: "Voices of Our Co-founders," an audio-cassette of five talks by Bill W. and Dr. Bob; "Markings on the Journey," a 38-minute filmstrip presentation on A.A. history; *Scrapbook, 1939-42*, a collection of compelling newspaper articles on early A.A.; a photocopy of the prepublication version of *Alcoholics Anonymous*; and a set of photographs of individuals and places involved in establishing A.A. in the formative years.

Frank Mauser, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: Suggestions for the 1987 Conference theme were reviewed, and we recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee (which makes the final selection) that the theme be "The Seventh Tradition—A Turning Point."

We reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and the post-Conference sharing session and suggested the following:

- More information be given on the responsibilities of a trustee and a director at the Conference orientation session on Sunday afternoon. The chairperson appointed Shep Raimi to write an information sheet describing the roles of trustees, directors, and G.S.O. staff in the Conference structure. This project was completed, and the information sheet was distributed at the 1987 Conference and included in the delegates' pre-Conference kits.
- The Conference secretary prepare a list of topics to be covered for regional trustee orientation, i.e., quorum, voting procedures, committee participation, etc. This project was completed, and the list was distributed at the 1987 Conference orientation session.

- Monday-morning digests of trustees' reports be changed to trustees' committee highlights. This communication could be made through the G.S.O. staff. The chairperson will give brief highlights only, in his or her own words, covering major activities or topics of concern to the Conference body.

- At joint committee meetings, some trustees are asked to attend too many joint meetings at once. Therefore, a sign-up sheet should be circulated so that trustees can indicate which they will attend. This sheet was circulated at the General Service Board meeting prior to the 1987 Conference.

- The trustees' committee ask Conference members and other A.A.s to develop workshop questions prior to the November board meeting, keeping these questions simple and concise.

- The workshop topics continue to be distributed in delegate's pre-Conference kits in early January. A subcommittee was appointed to complete this project by mid-December.

With the recommendation of the Conference Agenda Committee, we accepted the following workshops: *Unity—Let's Talk About It*; *Living Sober—Growing Together or Growing Apart?* Workshop questions were approved for distribution to Conference members in January.

Topics submitted for 1987 Conference consideration were reviewed, discussed, and referred to the appropriate Conference committee, presentation/discussion, workshop, or sharing session. A list of Conference members scheduled to participate in the various sessions was reviewed and accepted.

The committee reviewed and approved the final Conference agenda, after deleting some presentation/discussion topics. We felt it best not to overload in order to deal with major Fellowship concerns.

Jack Ford, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is a point of contact for all Conference members and all those serving on the 91 area committees in the U.S. and Canada.

All A.A.s are encouraged to submit suggestions for the Conference agenda, usually through the delegates. The suggestions are presented to the trustees' Conference Committee and the Conference Agenda Committee for approval. Then they are shared with the Fellowship via the *Quarterly Report*, Box 4-5-9, and the preliminary Conference agenda (mailed to delegates in January).

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- 1 Collecting ideas for the Conference theme and agenda
- 2 Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Conference Committee
- 3 Handling monthly letters and advance correspondence with all delegates in preparation for the Conference
- 4 Working with the general manager, office manager, and staff in planning and coordinating the Conference
- 5 Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, and the *Final Conference Report*
- 6 Coordinating G.S.O.'s Annual Open House

Growth of the Fellowship has led to an increase in districts; about 2,500 D.C.M.s are now listed at G.S.O. Districts are dividing into smaller units when necessary; many now have slates of officers similar to area committees.

Most areas and districts send us their minutes and newsletters, which are circulated among the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs. In addition to current trusted servants, contact is maintained with over 1,000 past delegates.

On November 15, 1986, 834 A.A.s from many states and Canada toured the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. The enthusiasm of these "first-timers" was contagious. Tours were conducted in three languages: French, Spanish and English. One tour guide was able to sign for the hearing impaired. The next Open House is tentatively scheduled for November 14, 1987.

Susan Ulseth

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: After reviewing all available information about carrying the A.A. message to Native North American peoples, the committee recommended that the trustees' Literature Committee consider publishing a pamphlet in which Native North Americans share their recovery stories. We also recommended that A.A.'s Professional Exhibit appear at a Native North American Conference. In January 1987 we recommended that the project be continued through the trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees.

In August 1986, we reviewed the Professional Exhibit schedule for 1987 and recommended that the C.P.C. staff person request invitations to exhibit at conferences in the following fields: law; corrections; medical associations; mental health; marriage and family counseling; gerontology; schools; public health; the clergy; and the armed services.

Current problems in connection with A.A.'s cooperation with court programs were discussed at all of our meetings since the 1986 Conference. In November, it was recommended that:

- 1 A subcommittee be formed to maintain an ongoing overview of the developments with court programs.
- 2 The Regional Forum coordinator be asked to include the topic of court programs in Regional Forum workshops.
- 3 The San Diego court case, as well as other reported problems in connection with A.A.'s cooperation with court programs, be monitored.
- 4 Issues concerning court programs be included in the General Service Conference agenda wherever appropriate.

The C.P.C. Committee suggested that the trustees' Committee continue to monitor these problems on a regular basis.

At its January 1987 meeting, the committee considered the development of a tabletop exhibit for use by local C.P.C. committees at regional professional conferences. The committee learned that the Archives Committee was considering a similar idea and recommended that the C.P.C. Committee secretary work with the Archives Committee secretary on developing a tabletop exhibit that could serve multiple purposes.

The committee approved the staff recommendations to: (1) refurbish three of our Professional Exhibits called "B" units; (2) retire the large exhibit called an "A" unit; and (3) build a new "B" unit.

Jack Whitehouse, chairperson

Quote taken from the Conference questionnaire: "I came here feeling afraid that I may be quizzed. I was at first lonely, but I found out that I, too, had to put my hand out and introduce myself."

Staff report: We have six Professional Exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1986 our exhibits were shown at 24 meetings, resulting in more than 1,600 requests for additional information. These exhibits also help increase the *About A.A.* mailing list, which is now over 21,500.

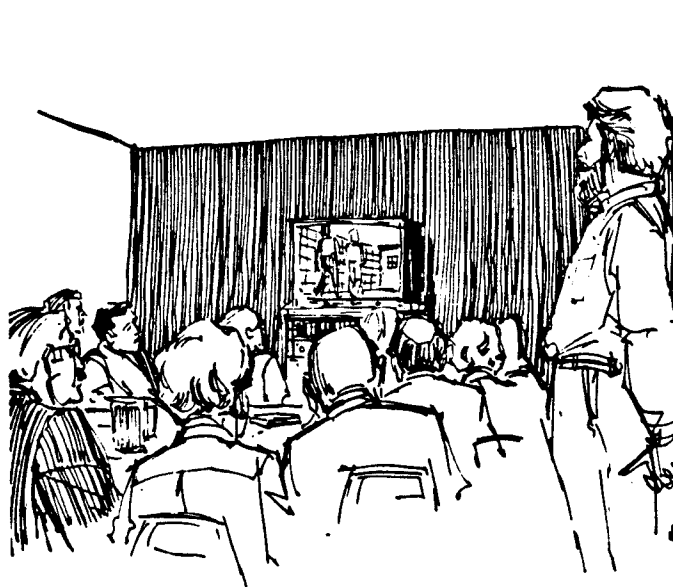
The C.P.C. staff member attends annual meetings of national organizations dealing with alcoholism and represents A.A. in a liaison capacity on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism.

Other meetings that staff or board members have attended or participated in are: American Association of the Deaf Conference, Salt Lake City, Utah; National Conference of the Alcohol and Drug Problems Association, Boston, Mass.; National Council on Alcoholism Forum, San Francisco, Cal.; North Carolina University Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Wilmington, N.C.; Tenth Southeastern Conference on Alcohol and Drug Abuse, Atlanta, Ga.; University of Utah School on Alcoholism and Other Drug Dependencies, Salt Lake City.

The staff member also maintains communication with A.A.s involved in C.P.C. service. C.P.C. committees have increased significantly over the past year, with 535 now listed at G.S.O. New committee chairpersons receive the C.P.C. Workbook free; additional copies cost \$7 each. A selection of complimentary C.P.C. literature and service material is sent to new C.P.C. committee members, and discount packages are also available. They also receive *About A.A.* and *Bor 4-5-9* (which now has sections on P.I. and C.P.C. activities).

The C.P.C. staff member is also assigned to coordinate all available information on spreading the A.A. message to the Native North American population, with a view toward consolidating and expanding A.A.'s experience in these areas. The C.P.C. staff person visited the following Indian reservations: Alkali Lake Reserve, Alkali Lake, B.C., Can.; Mohawk Reservation, Hogsburg, N.Y.; Navajo Reservation, Chinle, Ariz.; Taos Pueblo, Taos, N.M.

Betty Liddle



CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: At our August 1986 meeting, we reviewed an audio presentation and report from the producers of the 16-minute video, "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee recommended that a female voice be integrated into the audio portion and that a fine-cut print of the entire video be ready for presentation at the January 1987 board weekend. To date the committee's overall feeling is one of total approval.

After reviewing the rewrite of the new "Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic," the committee recommended a few changes in the draft. In January we reviewed the final draft of the pamphlet, and approved and recommended that it be submitted to the 1987 Conference for review and approval.

At our November 1986 meeting, we recommended that complimentary copies of the soft-cover Big Book be sent to all correctional committee chairpersons. We also recommended that special efforts be made in targeting the illiterate inmate, and that a figure of \$10,000 be included in the 1987 budget for special literacy projects. At our January 1987 meeting a presentation was made on "Literacy Problems in Correctional Facilities"; the committee recommended that this report be sent to the Conference.

The committee discussed the possibility of dissolving the Institutions Correspondence Service, and suggested that this service be coordinated by each delegate area. It was recommended that this topic be added to the agenda of the Conference.

When reviewing the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the trustees' Correctional Committee, the committee noted that the staff member (according to the Composition portion) was "non-voting." After a lengthy discussion with regard to the status of the nonvoting staff member, the committee pointed out that this did not appear to be in accordance with Concept XI, Item 4, which reads as follows: "*Full Participation of paid workers is highly important: We have already discussed the necessity of giving key paid personnel a voting representation on our committees and corporate boards . . .*" The committee recommended that the composition of the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee be changed from "nonvoting staff member" to "voting staff member." This recommendation has not been approved by the General Service Board at this time.

Don Pritts, chairperson

Staff report: The total number of active correctional facilities groups listed at G.S.O. is 1,777. These groups are served locally by approximately 514 institutions/correctional facilities committees in the U.S. and Canada.

The correctional facilities desk continues to be a hub of activity with a constant correspondence flow to and from A.A. members on the "inside," correctional facilities officials, correctional facilities/institutions committees and outside A.A. sponsors. Approximately 500 letters are written each month—6,000 a year. Letters from inmates include requests for complimentary literature and for help in starting a new group, resolving group problems, and contacting "outside" A.A. members.

When a request comes from an inmate for release planning, G.S.O. helps coordinate efforts with local committees for pre-release sponsorship. Additionally, the staff member coordinates the Institutions Correspondence Service, through which approximately 500 A.A. members on the "outside" share by mail their experience, strength, and hope with A.A.s on the "inside." Discount packages of A.A. literature (English and Spanish) are

available to A.A. groups in correctional facilities, as well as institutions committees, and back issues of the Grapevine are donated monthly for distribution to inmates (75 per month). Damaged special literature is donated by the A.A. Grapevine.

Correctional facilities chairpersons receive the Correctional Facilities Workbook and Guidelines, and appropriate literature is available for committee members as well as group correctional facilities representatives. The films "A.A.—An Inside View," "Bill's Own Story," "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and the filmstrip "Markings on the Journey" are available on loan at no charge to A.A. groups in correctional facilities.

Lyla Bonney

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: During 1986, we reviewed and approved budgets; supervised the administration of the Reserve Fund; and monitored the efforts of the General Service Office in its self-support project.

In 1986 G.S.O. had to stretch out projects, reduce expenses, and eliminate the 6% literature sales discount to balance the budget. Although sales wound up 5.6% over what was anticipated, sales of the new portable Big Book accounted for \$307,000 out of \$401,000 of the difference. Exclusive of this item, sales were within 1.3% of budget. Contributions were 0.4% under budget for the first 11 months of 1986 and, due to a strong December, finished 2.1% over budget. Expenses for 1986, exclusive of construction, were \$554,700, compared to a net income of \$825,100 in 1985 (the 1985 net income included \$315,900 of the net 50th Anniversary International Convention income).

In anticipation of a positive response from the Fellowship to the challenge of the Seventh Tradition, G.S.O. has reintroduced a sales discount (at 4% on purchases over \$25, effective 4/1/87). During 1987, A.A.W.S., Inc. will review, on a regular basis, the possibility of increasing this discount if contributions warrant it. It is much more in the spirit of A.A. to rely on direct self-support through contributions than on income from literature sales inside or outside the Fellowship, as in the past.

The Grapevine income was \$158,700 higher than 1985 but expenses were \$252,900 higher. Included in the 1986 expenses are future severance benefits of \$60,100. This resulted in an operating loss of \$134,200, offset by interest income of \$58,000, and the cumulative amount of \$64,900 through an approved change in accounting methods. Net loss for the year was \$11,300, a virtual break-even.

The Grapevine budgeted revenues at \$1,615,000 and expenses at \$1,610,000, resulting in a budgeted operating net income of \$5,000. Net income after interest earned is budgeted at \$62,000.

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: In-depth reports were presented by the following board committees: Archives, Conference, Finance & Budgetary, and International. The reports encompassed the scope of the committees and highlights from history, as well as detailed accounts of activities and projects in progress, areas of concern, and future plans. Issues of specific interest to the board were also addressed. In August, staff and trustees gave an update on efforts to carry the A.A. message to the Native North American population.

In November, attention was focused on the Seventh Tradition and the challenge it represents. The February 1987 discussion topics included reports from the two delegates who attended the October 1986 Ninth World Service Meeting in Guatemala. In addition, two films prepared under the guidance of the trustees' P.I. and Correctional Facilities committees were reviewed.

In the spirit of cooperation, three members of the board of trustees for Cocaine Anonymous were invited to attend the February 1987 General Sharing Session.

Garrett Taylor, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES COORDINATOR

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, supervise the production of all service material, update the 14 A.A. Guidelines, and produce new Group Handbooks (English, Spanish, French, Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities).

New groups in the U.S. and Canada receive a Group Handbook, a G.S.R. Kit, and a complimentary supply of literature. They also receive *Box 4-5-9* bimonthly and the appropriate regional A.A. directory when issued. It is G.S.O.'s intention to provide services to all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada service structure that are as nearly identical as possible. We list more than 1,000 French-speaking and more than 500 Spanish-speaking groups; the Group Handbook, G.S.R. Kit, and *Box 4-5-9* are available in these languages.

G.S.O. keeps a storehouse of service material, available to A.A.s on request. Most service material is complimentary and is not listed on the literature order form. Service material does not have the Conference-approved seal because it doesn't go through the various committee procedures required. It is produced when G.S.O. correspondence indicates a need for readily available information on a specific subject. Service pieces are prepared from files containing A.A. group experience or from sharing specifically requested by a questionnaire. Service material is constantly revised according to Fellowship needs.

The group services coordinator also updates all order forms and literature kits and works with the other supporting departments in the preparation of the five A.A. directories. Periodically, the group services coordinator conducts a G.S.O. staff service meeting at which the service assignment of each staff member is discussed and suggestions for improvement and/or change are offered. The group services coordinator also acts as liaison with intergroups/central offices, communicating to the General Service Conference the needs and concerns of intergroups/central offices and is involved in organizing all plans for the Intergroups/Central Offices Seminar.

Curtis Monahan

INTERNATIONAL / WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: The International Committee is a focal point for information about A.A. around the world, especially in countries not represented at World Service Meetings. We also oversee an information booth for world travelers at the International Conventions. We make suggestions which will help carry the message to alcoholics overseas, particularly in countries without established service structures. We share our experience on our board structure, and we assist members who travel abroad by

helping them contact isolated A.A.s and groups. We work with G.S.O. staff on the overseas assignment and encourage regional and zonal meetings. We also serve as a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board of Trustees. In 1986 the committee finalized the Ninth World Service Meeting.

The committee decided that intergroups and central offices should be written to, informing them of A.A. literature available in different languages and asking them what languages they have had requests for. This information will help the committee determine what languages to consider next for three of our basic recovery pamphlets.

The committee heard a report on a country in which a second General Service Board and General Service Office have been formed. This new entity is printing translations of U.S./Canada literature without permission from A.A.W.S., Inc. The committee replied that we cannot become involved in that controversy and hope all involved will strive for unity. Our literature cannot be printed without permission from A.A.W.S., Inc. This committee is now planning a comprehensive review of the *International A.A. Directory*.

Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions was translated into Polish and *Alcoholics Anonymous* was translated into Korean. The pamphlets "This is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?," and "44 Questions" were translated into Korean and Vietnamese. "Is A.A. for You?," "A Newcomer Asks," and "44 Questions" were translated into Russian and Chinese.

Helen Harmon, chairperson

Staff report:

Overseas—The staff member on this assignment corresponds with 33 G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Colombia, Costa Rica, Ecuador, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Trinidad/Tobago, Uruguay, Venezuela, and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.s. If an overseas G.S.O. then needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada. For countries with their own G.S.O.s, we list English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroups/central offices, and Loners. Travelers are encouraged to contact those offices for up-to-date meeting information.

Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.s in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. When correspondence comes to us in a foreign language, it is translated, and a response is sent in the same language. We have translators (A.A.s) for over 30 different languages.

To protect A.A.'s copyrights, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards and centers permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature in the language of the country.

Computer age is here

When identifying themselves at the mike, delegates from single-digit areas often used two digits: i.e., area 06, area 03, etc.

A request to print should come from the board, and before any printing begins, G.S.O. first explores the way material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to A.A.W.S.

Interim Zonal Meetings—The overseas staff member attended the Fourth European Service Meeting in March 1987 and will attend the Fourth Ibero-American Service meeting in August 1987. Zonal meetings are held every other year; alternating with World Service Meetings. Their primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Also, they help countries without service structures by sponsoring them into service and contribute to the growth of A.A. worldwide.

World Service Meeting—The World Service Meeting meets biennially at locations alternating between the United States and overseas. In October 1986, 35 delegates representing 27 countries where A.A. has a national service structure or G.S.O., gathered in Guatemala City for the Ninth World Service Meeting. The theme, "Service Through Love and Humility," aptly expressed the spirit of the W.S.M. members who shared their experience, strength, hope, and dedication to our Three Legacies.

The Tenth World Service Meeting will be held October 23-27, 1988, in New York City. The theme will be "A.A. and Its Responsibilities."

Helen Turnquest

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION / A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—We approved Seattle, Washington as the site of the 1990 International A.A. Convention.

The committee heard a report of the International Convention Ad Hoc Committee's site inspection trip to Seattle. Our Big Meeting will be held at the Kingdome, which seats up to 60,000. Giant TV screens can be used to show the stage during the general sessions. The Seattle Center will be the center of meetings and workshops, with more rooms than were available to us at the Montreal Convention Centre, not including space for registration, coffee/hospitality, and offices.

The Washington State Convention Center will serve as the hub for Al-Anon activities and some of our entertainment activities on Thursday evening. We have tentatively scheduled a range of entertainment at four different locations to spread out the crowd: the Coliseum and Arena at the Seattle Center; the Convention Center; the Westin Ballroom; and perhaps an outdoor event (weather permitting).

We recommended that the 1987 General Service Conference recommend that the 1988 Conference select three cities for the 1995 International Convention, without further indication of preference. The final selection of the site will be made by the General Service Board in July 1988, following an inspection trip by the Conference Site Selection Committee.

Regional Forums—Since 1975, a total of 46 Forums have been held. Four regions hosted Forums in 1986. Our committee discussed each Forum and found they continue to be well received by service workers and improve communication within our Fellowship. We discussed the recommendation that Regional Forum reports be substantially condensed; the extent of which should be determined by the Regional Forum coordinator and his or her assistant.

A subcommittee was formed to determine when to set Regional Forum dates and sites. It recommended that the regional trustee and general service delegates should choose the location two years in advance. Site selection will be decided by the regional delegates at the regional luncheons during Conference week.

Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed on Regional Forums. Here is a schedule of future Forums:

1987		
May 15-17	Puerto Rico	San Juan
June 5-7	Northeast	Stamford, Conn.
Sept. 11-13	West Central	Fargo, N. Dak.
Oct. 2-4	East Central	Peoria, Ill.
Dec. 4-6	Southwest	Little Rock, Ar.
1988		
(tentative)	Western Canada	Alberta, Ca.
Dec. 2-4	Southeast	Hollywood, Fla.
1989		
August	West Central	(tentative)

Dan Byrne, chairperson

Staff report:

Regional Forums—All regions have hosted Regional Forums. Forums are held at the invitation of the region; plans are made with the regional trustee, the region's delegates, and G.S.O. staff. Board personnel who have attended include trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors. The board pays hotel, mail, and travel expenses for all its personnel; expenses for the region's service people are the responsibility of either the individuals or area committee.

The Regional Forum coordinator plans Forums with the regional trustee and delegates, services director, and G.S.O. general manager; makes arrangements with the host-city contact (the local liaison), hotel, and host-city; arranges travel and hotels for board personnel; handles mailings to the region's delegates (asking for agenda suggestions), G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, past/present delegates, past/present trustees, and central offices; and arranges for display boards of sample literature and service material.

Reports on Forums are sent to all Forum participants, trustees, and current delegates. Any A.A. member who wishes to attend a Regional Forum may request a registration/reservation form.

Curtis Monahan

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee:

Projects Completed—Following Conference approval, the following items became available: "A.A. for the Woman" (revised); "Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated"; and *Alcoholics Anonymous* (soft-cover edition).

Projects in Progress—Updating the stories in: "A.A. and The Armed Services"; "Young People and A.A." *History of A.A., 1955-1985* is still in the writing stage.

Projects Forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee—"Too Young?" (revised to include updated stories and new graphics); samples of four service pieces regarding A.A.'s primary purpose for use at A.A. meetings.

Other—Because of cultural differences, and great need among Native North Americans we suggest a pamphlet specifically for the Native North American be developed. In response to ongoing requests, developing lower-level reading material should be considered. A request to publish the first 181 pages of the Big Book was referred to the Conference Literature Committee. We also informed the committee that the Big Book survey (taken in 1986) indicated that a number of areas would like to see only the stories omitted but everything else retained. It is recommended that the suggestion at the end of the section on group inventory in the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be changed to read: "(Please share with G.S.O. what benefits of your group's inventory might be of help to other groups.)."

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator works closely with editors on updating and revising all recovery pamphlets, and with writers, artists, and editors on preparing new recovery pamphlets, books, displays, leaflets, service material, and audio-visuals. Production of this material is under the auspices of G.S.O.'s Publications Division. In addition, the literature coordinator serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, our bimonthly newsletter. The circulation of *Box 4-5-9* is as follows:

	Issue	Mailing List
English	Feb./Mar.	68,081 ¹
French	Apr./May	3,442 ²
Spanish	Feb./Mar.	12,289 ³

In an effort to increase the circulation of *Box 4-5-9* (our only newsletter to the Fellowship), we have selected the following experimental projects for 1987:

- Include a *Box 4-5-9* order form (single or bulk subscriptions) with each issue (this began with the Holiday issue, 1986).
- Send a questionnaire with the February/March 1987 issue asking each G.S.R. to complete it to help us make our newsletter more interesting and helpful to the Fellowship.
- Include a *Box 4-5-9* subscription form and a copy of our most recent *Box 4-5-9* newsletter with literature orders sent from G.S.O. for the period of six months (January through June).
- In January 1987, letters of invitation to renew *Box 4-5-9* subscriptions were sent to approximately 1,000 G.S.R.s rotating out of office.
- A tabletop placard with a holder was developed, to be displayed on groups' literature tables; this will be sent with bulk subscriptions of *Box 4-5-9*.
- Provide a *Box 4-5-9* placard, newsletters, and subscription forms at Regional Forums in 1987; have *Box 4-5-9* as a topic in one of the presentations during each Regional Forum.
- At the staff member's discretion, include a *Box 4-5-9* order form with letters sent from G.S.O.
- Send ten copies of *Box 4-5-9* with materials sent to each Conference and Convention when G.S.O. receives notices for *Box 4-5-9* calendar listings.

1 This figure includes 1,910 copies sent to English-speaking G.S.O.s at no charge, and 14,120 paid subscriptions.
 2 This figure includes 785 copies sent to French-speaking G.S.O.s at no charge, and 120 paid subscriptions.
 3 This figure includes 9,225 copies sent to Spanish-speaking G.S.O.s at no charge, and 1,670 paid subscriptions.

Correspondence from A.A. groups and individuals requesting specific information about literature comes to the literature desk. A letter is sent semiannually to all central offices, intergroups, literature chairpersons, and literature distribution centers to inform them of new developments in A.A. literature and other service material.

Sarah Price

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: Loners are A.A.s who live in isolated areas where there are no A.A. groups or contacts; they stay sober by reading A.A. literature and sharing experience, strength, and hope with other A.A. members around the world through letters and tapes. There are over 500 Loners in 90 countries. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability; 125 Homers participate in the Loners-Internationalists Group. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists; there are about 600 Internationalists and Port Contacts, with 56 Internationalist groups meeting aboard ships or in ports. A number of A.A.s now serve as Loner Sponsors.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer, or Internationalist. They also receive lists of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists and the bimonthly bulletins *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, a discussion meeting in print which shares excerpts from letters received at G.S.O.

About 3,050 A.A.s participate in the Loners/Internationalists meeting-by-mail—it might be called the largest A.A. group in the world. We now have Loners in Fiji, Bolivia, Greece, Africa, Australia, and even tiny, remote islands. Many Loners live in the remote areas of the United States and Canada.

Cheryl Ann Burke

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: We discussed our responsibilities in filling vacancies within our own ranks and among key service directors and staff. We requested that a list of job descriptions in each category and rotation dates be sent to all committee members.

We noted our responsibility to seek out possible candidates for all vacancies within the committee's scope in order that we may have an on-going file to draw upon. The importance of making known to the entire Fellowship the availability of these positions was noted.



We reviewed and approved mailing the letters, procedures, and résumé forms for the election of candidates for regional trustees from the Southwest and Northeast United States, and for trustee-at-large/Canada.

The committee reviewed the procedures for hiring a general manager and suggested that the term of general manager be a minimum of five years and a maximum of seven years. We recommended that under the heading "Major Activities" for the job description of G.S.O. staff members, the amount of weekend travel for A.A. functions be included and emphasized.

We recommended that the Grapevine Board select qualified candidates to interview from all applications received for the position of Grapevine director.

We recommended that the Conference Committee on Trustees review whether to continue the current practice of selecting directors for the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards exclusively from the New York City area.

The committee revised the Composition of the trustees' Nominating Committee to read as follows: "The committee is composed of trustees appointed by the chairperson of the General Service Board to include at least one Class A trustee and at least one trustee each serving as director on the A.A.W.S. Board and the Grapevine Corporate Board. In addition, a G.S.O. staff member serves as a nonvoting secretary to the committee. The manager of the General Service Office and the chairperson of the General Service Board are ex-officio members of the committee."

The committee recommended that a minimum of two regional trustees serve on the Grapevine Board at all times with a minimum term of two years, with the chairperson rotating every year between regional and general service trustees. The committee also recommended that one of the incoming regional trustees be elected as chairperson of the Grapevine Board.

The committee reviewed and accepted as presented the Composition, Scope and Procedures for the trustees' Nominating Committee.

The committee recommended that Ruth Jagodzinski serve on the A.A.W.S. Board, replacing Jack Ford; that John R. Whitehouse and Thomas G. Hills serve on the Grapevine Board, replacing Helen Harmon and Dan Byrne; and nominated Laurance Allen to serve as director on the Grapevine Board, replacing Stanley Silverman.

We reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1987 General Service Conference for their disapproval, if any:

Class A

William E. Flynn, M.D.	Gordon M. Patrick
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.	Amos E. Reed
John King	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Robert P. Morse	

Class B

Dan Byrne	Don I. Pritts
William H. Croke	Shepherd Raimi
John R. Ford	Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
Thomas G. Hills	James Shannon
Ruth Jagodzinski	John R. Whitehouse
Joe Phelan	Two regional trustees

(To be selected 4/29/87)

Two regional trustees—Northeast, U.S., Southwest, U.S.
One trustee-at-large/Canada

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Gordon M. Patrick
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	William E. Flynn, M.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
<i>Secretary</i>	John R. Ford
<i>Treasurer</i>	Robert P. Morse
<i>Assistant treasurer</i>	Edward H. Gordon
<i>Assistant secretary</i>	Lois Fisher ¹

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1987 General Service Conference:

John Bragg	Joseph E. Rhoads
William H. Croke	Harold Greene
Lois Fisher ¹	Ruth Jagodzinski
Joe Phelan	Jean Smith
Shepherd Raimi	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1987 General Service Conference:

Norman Adams	James Shannon
Laurance Allen	Ames Sweet
Thomas G. Hills	Desmond Towey
John King	Ann Warner ²
Ralph Rosenberg Jr.	John R. Whitehouse

Wayne Parks, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: During 1986, we accomplished the following:

- Released the annual anonymity memo to the major media, public information committees and contacts who might share it with smaller, local newspapers and broadcast outlets.
- Made available the new public service announcements approved by the 1986 General Service Conference.
- Revised the Public Information Workbook, to reflect the suggestions made by the 1986 Conference Public Information Committee.
- Launched the Seventh Triennial Membership Survey, the results of which will be forthcoming.
- Made available the revised radio public service announcements to include the ending tag "or check your local newspapers."
- Prepared and disseminated the press release announcing the Ninth World Service Meeting in Guatemala City, Guatemala, in October 1986.
- Reviewed current press feature stories, and explored the need for more. These will be forthcoming.
- Produced a 28-minute film targeting young alcoholics, as recommended by the 1986 General Service Conference. This film will be presented to the 1987 Conference for approval.

William H. Croke, chairperson

1 To be replaced upon rotation, effective September 1987

2 To be replaced upon selection of permanent management

Staff report: The staff member and staff assistant respond to about 10,000 written and telephoned inquiries annually from both the general public and the Fellowship. During 1986 we provided literature for about 325 health and community fairs and read and processed 15,000 newspaper, magazine, and TV feature stories. Each month we wrote approximately ten letters of gratitude to publications for good articles about A.A. and followed up on a monthly average of 15 to 20 anonymity breaks.

The staff member also handles media interviews, providing accurate information about A.A. A partial list of interviews includes *Vogue*, *Your Health*, *Glamour*, *Readers' Digest*, *McCall's*, *Seventeen*, and *Harper's Bazaar*.

New P.I. chairpersons received the P.I. Workbook, and all P.I. committee members and contacts receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as new public service materials. (Additional Workbooks are available at \$7.) Two discount packages are available to P.I. committees at \$20 and \$70, respectively. (Local committees may also order half-quantities of each package.)

The radio and TV P.S.A.s and the film "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View," were widely aired. We have received requests for help in planning programs including references to A.A. We have on-going contact with NBC, ABC, and CBS, as well as PBS and cable.

Eileen Gatzka

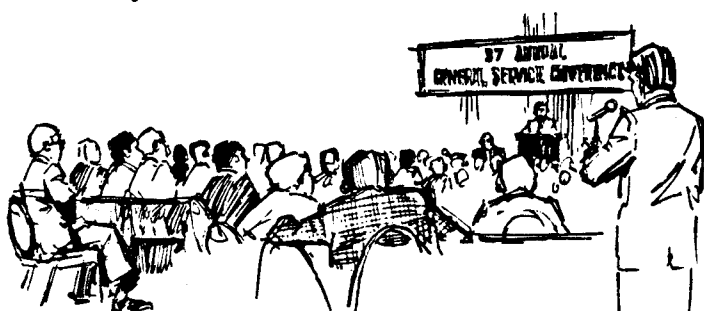
SPANISH SERVICES COORDINATOR

Staff report: This assignment was created to serve Spanish-speaking A.A. groups. The Spanish services coordinator, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of materials from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups.

Routine correspondence in Spanish received at G.S.O. is no longer translated into English before a response is prepared. It is now handled more efficiently without losing the "flavor" of A.A. terminology. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. The Spanish services coordinator is the editor of Spanish *Box 4-5-9*, and is currently translating *Pass It On*.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, the Spanish services coordinator attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, and Regional Forums, and assists at G.S.O.'s Annual Open House, the World Service Meeting, and the International A.A. Convention. The Spanish services coordinator greets Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Vicente Mejia



STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: In addition to assuming a functional responsibility such as Public Information, Regional Forums, or Literature, most of the 11 staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, or with A.A.s in overseas countries without a national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. The work is apportioned as follows:

Conference	Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird <i>Box 4-5-9</i> ; <i>Final Conference Report</i>
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; <i>About A.A.</i> ; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant on C.P.C. page); coordinator, Native North American Initiative
Correctional Facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page)
Group Services Coordinator, Regional Forums, International Convention	Supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention / A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; coordinator, all activities concerning the 1990 International Convention; liaison with intergroups/central offices
Literature Coordinator	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, and audiovisual materials; updating of recovery pamphlets and books; editor, <i>Box 4-5-9</i>
Loners, Internationalists, Homers	<i>Loners-Internationalists Meeting</i> ; secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees
Overseas, World Service Meeting	Secretary, trustees' International Committee; secretary, World Service Meeting; <i>World Service Meeting Report</i>
Public Information	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant for P.I. page)
Spanish Services	Consultant on any committee providing services to the Hispanic community; editor, Spanish <i>Box 4-5-9</i>
Treatment Facilities	Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; <i>Box 4-5-9</i> (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page)

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings; distributing advance material; preparing and distributing the minutes of the board meeting; editing the *Quarterly Report*, the newsletter account of the board's activities.

The staff coordinator is secretary of the General Sharing Session, a voting member of the General Service Conference and secretary of the Committee on Conference Policy/Admissions. The staff coordinator is a director and vice-president of A.A. World Services, Inc. and is responsible to coordinate the Self-Support Project.

During 1986, the G.S.O. staff handled almost 25,000 pieces of mail—an 11% increase over 1985.

An exciting aspect of staff service is attending A.A. conventions, assembly meetings, and get-togethers. This allows us to meet A.A.s all over the U.S. and Canada. We inform them about G.S.O. services, and learn of local activities that can be shared with other groups.

During the past year, approximately 1,700 visitors from all over the world visited G.S.O., including more than 800 A.A.s who attended the Annual Open House.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips in order to ensure that the office is covered at all times. The staff coordinator also serves as a liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments as a member of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee.

Lois Fisher

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: We reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities. We suggested that the composition section was too restricted and accepted a revision which describes the composition of the committee in flexible terms. We also accepted the term "appointed committee member" in lieu of the term "nontrustee/nondirector."

The 1986 General Service Conference on Treatment Facilities recommended that we study ways to develop contact sponsorship programs. We solicited shared experience throughout the Fellowship and compiled a report to be submitted to the 1987 General Service Conference for their review and further recommendations.

In response to an ongoing concern for A.A.s employed in the alcoholism field, we decided to solicit articles by these members on how their work affects their A.A. program. An article on this topic will appear in a forthcoming issue of the A.A. Grapevine.

We approved adding the following items to the enclosures in the Treatment Facilities Workbook: An A.A. Grapevine service piece entitled "Carrying the A.A. Message"; a copy of the article which appeared in the April 1984 issue of the *Treatment Facilities Bulletin* entitled "How We Carry the Message"; the A.A. Grapevine article entitled "What the A.A. Message Taught a Non-A.A. Counselor."

The committee revised the following phrase in the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Centers": "Since A.A.'s co-founders got sober by carrying the A.A. message into treatment centers . . ." to read: "Since A.A.'s co-founders helped maintain their sobriety by carrying the A.A. message into hospitals . . ." This revision will be brought to the 1987 General Service Conference for approval.

This committee decided to send an annual letter to treatment facilities chairpersons containing updated information on issues of particular relevance in carrying the A.A. message into treatment facilities, i.e., contact sponsorship programs and the mandated attendance of treatment facilities patients at A.A. meetings. We will also encourage chairpersons to recommend the Treatment Facilities Workbook to their successors.

We also discussed sending an annual mailing to treatment facilities as a means of sharing basic information on treatment facilities committees and contact sponsorship programs and the mandated attendance of treatment facilities patients at A.A. meetings. This discussion was in response to the committee's

evaluation of copies of *About A.A.* for the past three years. We would contact the treatment facilities chairpersons for the names of treatment facilities that they feel should be included in the mailing. We will further discuss both mailings.

The committee has been extensively involved in exploring the issue of the mandated attendance of treatment facilities patients at A.A. meetings. We will continue to seek shared experience from the A.A. Fellowship on this issue as a guide in responding to A.A. groups who face a problem.

William Flynn, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The highlights of 1986 are: preparation of a report on contact sponsorship programs to be reviewed by the 1987 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities; a report on the subject of the mandated attendance of treatment facility patients at A.A. meetings; solicitation of material for a Grapevine article from an A.A. member employed in the alcoholism field; participation in the Eastern Massachusetts Area Treatment Facility Symposium; and initiation of a sponsorship program for new treatment facility chairpersons. The staff member on this assignment sent 2,609 letters to solicit shared experience on developing contact sponsorship programs; 150 responses were received and distilled in a report to be reviewed by the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

Material for a report summarizing the best sharing over the past five years on mandated attendance of treatment facility patients at A.A. meetings was obtained from the following sources: Regional Forum reports, Conference presentations, board sharing sessions, workshop presentations, *Box 4-5-9*, the Treatment Facilities Bulletin, and *About A.A.* The trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities will determine the use of the material.

In response to frequent requests from new treatment facilities chairpersons, sponsorship service for new chairpersons and committee members was begun. An announcement appears regularly in *Box 4-5-9* asking chairpersons willing to serve as sponsors and those seeking sponsors to contact G.S.O. The staff member develops material, on an ongoing basis, for the Treatment Facilities section of *Box 4-5-9*.

The staff person has received many requests for the Treatment Facilities Workbook which has been an exceptionally well-received tool.

Confusion about the distinction between a "regular A.A. group" and a "treatment facility meeting" has continued in 1986. Form letters were sent to the Fellowship, and to professionals and A.A.s employed in the alcoholism field clearly defining the distinction between these types of A.A. meetings.

The correspondence has shown that the main issues of concern for the Fellowship continue to be the following: attendance of nonalcoholic addicts at regular A.A. groups and treatment facility meetings; influx of patients from treatment facilities to regular A.A. groups; and sponsorship of newly released patients.

Maureen Costello

Coming up the steps to the podium, to give the Area Highlights from Eastern Massachusetts, Mary Lindgren tripped and nearly fell. "Watch out," said trustee Garrett Taylor, who was introducing the Northeast Regional Highlights, "We don't want to have to get another delegate." Garrett was referring to the fact that both the delegate and the alternate delegate from Eastern Mass. were unable to attend.

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: After a year of many changes, the work of the A.A. Grapevine staff continues, and the watchword is "let's go forward." A committee of A.A. Grapevine staff and available board members has been established to review means of widening interest in the magazine among the Fellowship. Meetings have been scheduled for the sole purpose of planning ways to increase the magazine's use and circulation.

In the fall of 1986 the staff produced the Grapevine's first four-color flyer. Significant results were realized in just one month. Since then a second four-color appeal has been produced with the emphasis on the magazine itself. We have been in touch with the Intergroup Association of A.A. of Greater New York, and this flyer may be included in a forthcoming mailing.

Late in 1986, a Michigan treatment facility placed an order for almost 2,000 subscriptions to be sent directly to its alumni. This is a significant event both to the Fellowship and to the still-suffering alcoholic.

The new *GvR Newsletter* has become a regular publication and has received enthusiastic response in several areas. The staff has widened the search for artists and continues to appeal to the Fellowship to contribute to the magazine, while reminding members, both in print and in person, "We don't write the magazine, you do!" In addition, a selection of Bill W.'s writings for the Grapevine, gathered together under the working title *In All Our Affairs*, is nearing completion. It was hoped that a draft of this work would be ready for presentation to this Conference, but it was agreed that it would be wise to take more time.

In February 1987 the Grapevine staff sent a friendly letter to 40,000 people whose subscriptions had expired during the past year and a half. During that same period, almost 40,000 *new* readers subscribed to the Grapevine. Today the magazine has almost 40,000 different readers than it had a year and a half ago. This statistic is worthy of investigation (sure to result in valuable information both to the magazine and the Fellowship). Grapevine circulation in 1986 was budgeted at 125,000 per month and came in at an average of 126,400 per month. Circulation for December 1986, however, was below average, at 123,000. The monthly average so far in 1987 is about 123,000. If 1987 is like other years, that figure can be expected to rise. Small as those figures might seem to some, there is reason to be proud of the way readership of the A.A. Grapevine has grown during the last decade when many major publications have reduced circulation as a result of increasing illiteracy rates.

The editors of the A.A. Grapevine have at times turned to tapes, not just for those who can't read, but for those who prefer to listen. The Grapevine editorial staff has been busy of late, not just with special requested tapes in French and Spanish, but with recent audio efforts on the subject of spirituality: a set of two cassettes entitled "Spirituality—Finding It" and "Spirituality—Maintaining It." Two earlier tapes, entitled "Attitudes" and "Character Defects," were enthusiastically received. It is clear that tapes must be thought of as direct extensions of the magazine itself—as auditory rather than visual methods of carrying the message, a medium necessary to reach a segment of the Fellowship that is growing larger every day.

As to finance: Net overall operations loss for the year 1986 (including interest earned on the monies invested with the Reserve Fund per present accounting practices) was \$11,300. In the opinion of the experts, this is tantamount to break-even, an indication of rather good financial health for a nonprofit operation. It is also recognition, perhaps, that the purpose of the A.A.

Grapevine has never been to make money, but to make the A.A. message available to anyone who wants it.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., chairperson

Staff report: The resignation of the chief executive in November has meant spreading the administrative workload more widely; editor Ann Warner and controller Don Meurer, appointed as an interim management team, are "bridging the gap," fully supported by Grapevine personnel.

The magazine is moving ahead, with the objective of being even more responsive to the Fellowship as a whole. A new "Your Move" section now publishes the opinions of a large number of readers on issues of significance to the Fellowship, and a revived "Around A.A." section contains news and information about A.A. There have been more frequent groupings of several articles on the same topic. The Three Legacies are present in full force: emphasis on stories that help readers identify and "keep the memory green," a series of Traditions cartoons in each 1986 issue and a Traditions checklist each month of 1987, and an increase in articles on service.

In order to dispel the misconception that "New York people write the Grapevine," a cartoon flyer, "Who Writes the Grapevine? You Do!" is distributed at A.A. events and through the GvR network. This has already resulted in an increase in articles contributed.

In 1986 several new special items were introduced, notably the second volume of *Best of the Grapevine*. Trial Spanish- and French-language cassette tapes were made available. Earlier, a set of two tapes; "Attitudes" and "Character Defects," were produced and have been enthusiastically received. The Grapevine Workbook came off press in August and thus far is proving an effective service tool.

A selection of Bill W.'s Grapevine writings is being held over until 1988 to give the writer of the historical introductions enough time to do the best possible job.

A desktop publishing committee, chaired by managing editor Ames Sweet, investigated the possibilities of desktop publishing and determined that present technology is not adequate for the quality needs of the magazine. The possibilities of using DTP programs on the office's I.B.M. personal computers are now being looked into, with the thought of phasing into desktop publishing in this way.

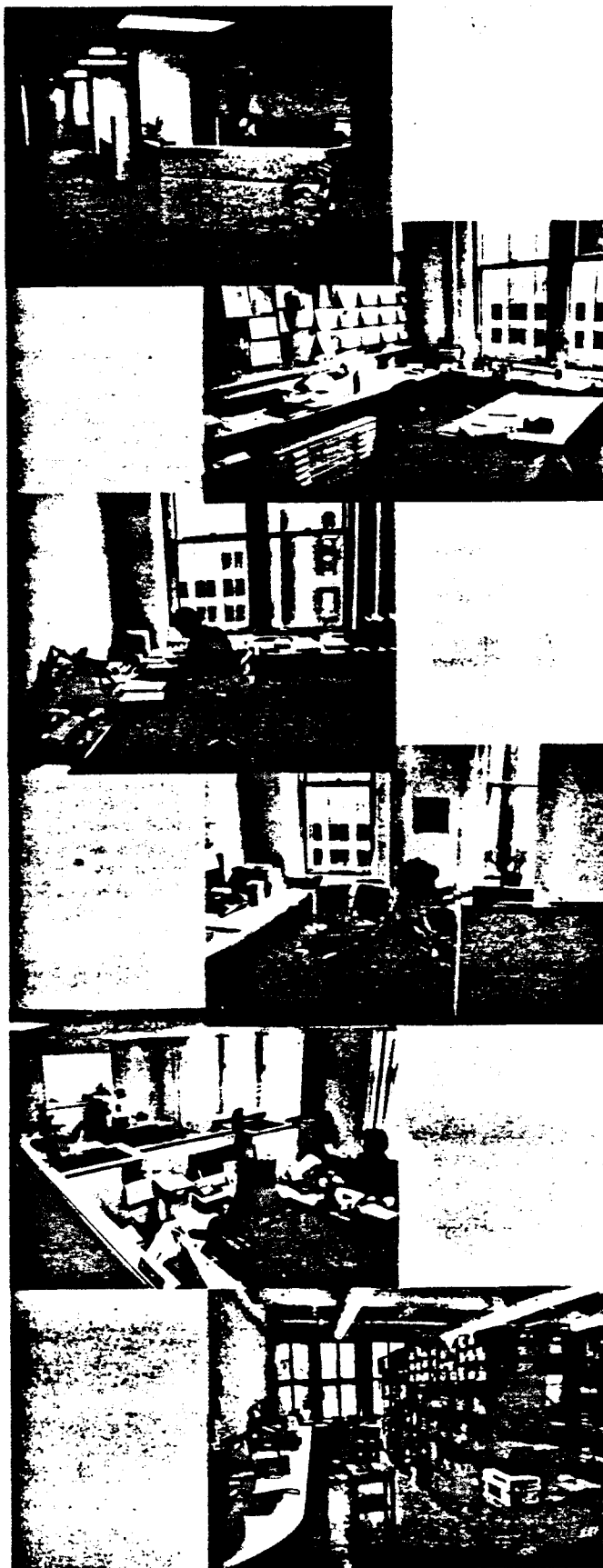
Art director John Nayduch, in addition to continuing his search for illustrators, designed two four-color flyers. The initial effort had excellent results; the second features the magazine itself. We await with interest the effect of that flyer, to be mailed in the spring of 1987. The new *GvR Newsletter* is now being produced quarterly to bring background material to GvRs and share news of effective GvR activities; the job of GvR coordinator has been upgraded and expanded. Our Circulation Department manager, Grace Hedderman, resigned in November 1986. Upon leaving, she recommended a downgrading of the job to a supervisory level position. Because refined computer programs may change procedures, and in light of budgetary considerations, the job has not been filled. That department is being evaluated to determine the most effective staffing configuration. While it has been a busy year, with the ups and downs that none of us are exempt from, it has been a year of reflection, productivity, and growth.

Ann Warner, editor

Donald W. Meurer, controller

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION—GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1986	APRIL 1987	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,119	1,077	- 42
Alaska	526	506	- 20
Arizona	1,476	1,420	- 56
Arkansas	838	806	- 32
California	12,949	12,462	- 487
Colorado	1,590	1,530	- 60
Connecticut	2,000	1,925	- 75
Delaware	415	399	- 16
District of Columbia	367	353	- 14
Florida	5,744	5,528	- 216
Georgia	2,479	2,386	- 93
Hawaii	368	354	- 14
Idaho	547	526	- 21
Illinois	5,586	5,376	- 210
Indiana	1,887	1,816	- 71
Iowa	1,679	1,616	- 63
Kansas	1,588	1,528	- 60
Kentucky	1,088	1,047	- 41
Louisiana	1,471	1,416	- 55
Maine	766	737	- 29
Maryland	2,264	2,179	- 85
Massachusetts	4,733	4,555	- 178
Michigan	3,650	3,513	- 137
Minnesota	4,214	4,055	- 159
Mississippi	866	833	- 33
Missouri	2,244	2,160	- 84
Montana	867	834	- 33
Nebraska	1,642	1,580	- 62
Nevada	633	609	- 24
New Hampshire	793	763	- 30
New Jersey	3,682	3,543	- 139
New Mexico	729	702	- 27
New York	8,310	7,997	- 313
North Carolina	3,206	3,085	- 121
North Dakota	687	661	- 26
Ohio	3,637	3,500	- 137
Oklahoma	1,757	1,691	- 66
Oregon	1,100	1,059	- 41
Pennsylvania	3,811	3,668	- 143
Rhode Island	762	733	- 29
South Carolina	1,653	1,591	- 62
South Dakota	653	628	- 25
Tennessee	1,455	1,400	- 55
Texas	5,495	5,288	- 207
Utah	347	334	- 13
Vermont	529	509	- 20
Virginia	2,975	2,863	- 112
Washington	2,826	2,720	- 106
West Virginia	548	527	- 21
Wisconsin	3,014	2,901	- 113
Wyoming	404	389	- 15
Puerto Rico	132	127	- 5
U.S. Possessions	—	—	—
Total	114,098	109,805	- 4,293
CANADA			
Alberta	1,348	1,297	- 51
British Columbia/Yukon	1,267	1,219	- 48
Manitoba	744	716	- 28
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	419	403	- 16
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	745	717	- 28
Ontario	4,568	4,425	- 143
Quebec	388	373	- 15
Saskatchewan	1,000	962	- 38
	10,507	10,112	- 395
FOREIGN	1,397	1,344	- 53
Grand Total	126,002	121,261	- 4,741



Literature Distributed - 1986

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	735,000
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft-cover)	81,200
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	411,800
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	67,800
A.A. Comes of Age	19,700
As Bill Sees It	79,900
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	21,800
"Pass It On"	36,100
50 Years With Gratitude (discontinued)	2,800
Total	1,456,100

Booklets

Living Sober	199,100
Came to Believe	78,000
Total	277,200

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	36,500
A.A. and the Armed Services	25,500
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	65,600
A.A. for the Woman	242,100
The A.A. Group	137,100
A.A. in Your Community	136,100
A.A. in Prisons	44,900
A.A. in Treatment Centers	86,400
The A.A. Member	127,900
The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs	228,700
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	28,300
A.A. Tradition—How It Developed	78,300
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	25,900
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	247,800
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	53,800
The Co-founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	54,800
Do You Think You're Different?	264,300
44 Questions	463,300
G.S.R.	71,600
How A.A. Members Cooperate	41,700
How It Works	139,400
If You Are a Professional	165,500
Inside A.A.	96,400
Is A.A. For You?	573,000
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	203,000
It Happened to Alice	91,600
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	73,300
The Jack Alexander Article	78,500
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	32,500
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	167,500
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	171,400
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	65,000
A Newcomer Asks	391,200
Problems Other Than Alcohol	189,900
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	348,300
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	37,100
This Is A.A.	536,900
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	51,600
Time to Start Living	136,000
Time to Start Living (large print)	15,300
Too Young?	207,100
Twelve Traditions Illustrated	85,500
Twelve Traditions of A.A.	3,400
Understanding Anonymity	126,700
What Happened to Joe	103,400
Young People and A.A.	281,400
Total	6,831,500

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards—two-fold	906,000
Wallet cards—I Am Responsible	119,000
Wallet cards—Anonymity	71,000
Parchment—scrolls	7,900
Placards	1,000
C.P.C. Workbook	1,000
Correctional Facilities Workbook	900
P.I. Workbook	1,200
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,500
A.A. Guidelines	147,000
Group Handbook	5,800
Wire Racks	2,700
Cassettes	4,400
Alcoholics Anonymous book (cassette album)	5,600
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions book (cassette album)	2,100
A.A. Comes of Age (new) (cassette album)	900
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	1,100
Twelve Steps (shade display)	1,800
Twelve Traditions (shade display)	1,500
Fact Files	3,700
Total	1,286,100

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	11,500
Como Lo Ve Bill	2,400
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad	900
Total	14,800

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio	3,500
El Manual de Servicios de A.A.	1,300
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	7,200
Llegamos a Creer (new)	300
Total	12,300

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	5,000
44 Preguntas	18,300
Esto es A.A.	27,300
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	39,200
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	4,400
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	4,300
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	2,400
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	2,200
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	1,500
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	1,000
Como Trabaja el Programa	14,000
El Marido Alcohólico (discontinued)	1,200
Lo que le Sucedió a Jose y su Problema con la Bebida	6,900
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	1,500
El Grupo de A.A.	4,500
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre Apadrinamiento	4,000
El Miembro de A.A. — Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	5,700
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	2,300
A.A. en Centros de Tratamientos (new)	1,400
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	7,100
Las Tradiciones de A.A.—Cómo se Desarrollaron	1,800
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	5,100
A.A. en Prisiones	3,000
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	5,000
Es Mejor que estar Sentado en una Celda	3,100
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	2,200
Dentro de A.A.	1,800
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	1,900
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	1,300
R.S.G.	2,700
Total	182,100

Guidelines 10,200

Wallet Cards

Tarjeta Tamaño Billetera 7,600

FRENCH

Books

Gros Livre Alcooliques anonymes (First edition)	160
Gros Livre Alcooliques anonymes	8,570
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient adulte	1,040
Réflexions de Bill	3,270
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	2,920
Total	15,960

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire	2,050
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	2,250
Album Souvenir	1,420
Total	5,720

Pamphlets

Les Douze Etapes	7,340
Voici les A.A.	11,230
Les A.A.: 44 Questions et réponses	6,490
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	25,710
Les A.A. pour la femme	2,240
Coopération des membres des A.A.	610
Les A.A. et le monde du travail	1,400
Le membre des A.A. face aux méd. et à la drogue	3,000
Les A.A.—Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	500
Collaborons avec nos amis	980
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	3,270
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	850
Les A.A. et la profession médicale (discontinued)	890
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	1,190
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	1,680
Les Douze Traditions des A.A.	1,470
Alice l'a trouvée	1,230
Jos levait le coude	1,410
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	1,760
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	2,280
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	880
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	1,910
Notre méthode	17,280
Les A.A. dans les prisons	820
Ça vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	1,420
Petit guide pratique des Alcooliques anonymes	6,510
Un ecclésiastique s'interroge sur les A.A.	1,200
Biographies des cofondateurs	600
Lettre à un détenu	1,660
Le groupe des A.A.	2,700
Le manuel de services/Douze Concepts	1,610
Douze Etapes/Douze Traditions (Carte)	4,420
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	560
Le sens de l'anonymat	1,950
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales	1,280
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,910
Si vous exercez des activités professionnel	530
Le R.S.G.	1,760
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	540
Trop jeune?	2,160
Les A.A.—leur structure	1,680
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	530
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,700
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,830
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	1,550
Carte anonymat (Français/anglais)	1,140
Le membre des A.A.	2,920

Les jeunes et les A.A.	2,860
Votre B.S.G.	1,350
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,380
Un nouveau venu veut savoir	10,190

Total 154,960

Guidelines

4,770

Miscellaneous

Réflexions sur les Douze Etapes	1,320
Les meilleurs articles de Bill	3,830
Prière Sérénité (Carte)	48,280
Prière Sérénité (5 × 7)	2,730
Prière Sérénité (12 × 16)	500
Prière Sérénité (23 × 34)	210
Slogans (série de 5)	300
Littérature . . . une aide essentielle	670
Suggestions pour réunions de débutants	440
La Vigne A.A.	830
Listes de réunions—Inter groupe de Mtl.	3,810
Médailles rhodium français	1,330
Jetons aluminium "appelle avant"	6,380
Étiquettes Allô!	1,400
Enseigne Meeting A.A.	20
Jetons 3 mois aluminium	2,090
Jetons 6 mois aluminium	1,680
Jetons 9 mois aluminium	1,450
Jetons 12 mois aluminium	1,120
Pochette re: kit nouveau membre	1,440

Total 79,830

Kits nouveaux groupes	80
Nécessaires pour établ. pénitentiaires	50
Nécessaires Information publique	30
Cahier Information publique	20
Aperçu sur A.A.	19,260
La transmission du message dans les prisons	1,970
Message aux adolescents	11,510
Et maintenant, que vais-je faire?	7,580
Renseignements sur les A.A.	4,850
Diverses façons de soutenir financièrement A.A.	1,400
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (citations)	2,980

Total 49,730



Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alabama/N.W. Florida: Our 19 districts with 280 groups meet quarterly at our assemblies. The Finance, P.I., C.P.C., Institutions, Convention, Grapevine, and Archives committees are working well. Our D.C.M. workshop is chaired by our alternate delegate and has stimulated more informed sharing. We are utilizing the vast knowledge and experience of our past delegates to chair the Ask-It-Basket session. We have just held our first convention with a registration fee, which was a success. Our concern is how to stimulate interest, participation, and support from groups that we never see or hear from at our assemblies.—*Katherine Guy*

Arkansas: Our two-day quarterly assemblies are attended by G.S.R.s from 186 groups and D.C.M.s from 12 districts. We will host the Southwest Regional Forum in Little Rock in December 1987. Our alternate delegate is responsible for A.A. service structure workshops, presented to all districts and put on by past delegates and/or assembly officers. Our main problems are: supporting the A.A. support system; the influx of people from treatment facilities and courts; and dealing with people who have problems other than alcohol.—*Ann Bruning*

British Columbia/Yukon: District service sharing sessions are prevalent, and A.A.s are becoming interested in service. A priority of our area committee is to carry the service message, particularly to outlying districts. Since ours is one of the largest areas on the continent, members of our area committee must travel a lot. A proper accounting system has been established along with preparation of financial statements and an annual budget. Also, Finance Committee has been formed. We hold an annual assembly and quarterly meetings in the outlying districts.—*Chester Norton*

California (Northern Coastal): Group support for central offices and G.S.O. continues to grow. Our service entities are working in greater harmony, and we listen more attentively to the experiences of our ten central offices (one Spanish). We are a very traditional area, knowledgeable and interested in A.A. principles and policies. Groups trust the Conference structure and process, and feel that leadership should come from them through the Conference. They have concerns about the direction "New York seems to be leading us." As Warranty Two in Concept XII says, we think we should not try to motivate by fear or pressure.—*Michael Goldsmith*

California (Southern): Our area has 1,204 groups and 47 districts. Communication is a big topic at this time. Most districts meet monthly; some hold combined meetings. Workshops are held every year. Our P.I. and C.P.C. committees are particularly active. P.I. has put together two projects: placing A.A.'s literature in libraries, doctors' offices, schools, etc; and packages of literature designed to be given to family doctors by A.A.s. We try to stay in close touch with other service entities, i.e., our central offices. We are doing a lot, but we know we have barely scratched the surface of our service possibilities.—*Al Hendricks*

Colorado: Our area has had a large increase in attendance at district meetings. Our committee chairpersons have more strongly organized committees. About two-thirds of our districts are now represented. The correctional facilities chairperson created a very workable structure. The treatment facilities committee assembled a state directory of facilities within each district. Our Grapevine chairperson created our annual "Grape-A-Thon," an all-day program. We continue to impress upon our members the financial needs of our districts.—*Bruce Sutherland*

Connecticut: Within a small geographic area, we have nearly 1,200 groups divided into nine districts, with three subdistricts each. A marvelous capacity and willingness to work set the tone for 1987: Corrections and treatment cover 120 weekly meetings; Grapevine is very active; Archives is looking into permanent storage and display space; C.P.C. is working with Yale/New Haven Hospital; P.I. is active with an in-house, students-only meeting at a high school (a first); and plans for our Area Convention and Roundup are underway. We will host the Northeast Regional Forum on June 5-7, 1987, in Stamford.—*Louise Dumais-Adams*

District of Columbia: Our area has 350 groups and 32 districts. One district contains a very active Spanish community. Our assembly and committee meetings are filled with workers who believe that self-support is of paramount concern. We developed, implemented, and distributed to our G.S.R.s a packet containing fundamental data to educate all groups about financial responsibility. We hope this plan will result in 99% group participation. Our first Washington Area Assembly Convention will be held in May 1987. Attendance at service functions has increased; we hope this will spark new interest.—*David Smoot*

Florida (North): Our area is growing. We have 359 groups and 23 districts. Our first 1987 quarterly meeting was held in January and helped to launch our drive to meet the Seventh Tradition Challenge. All D.C.M.s were given copies of the Southeast Regional Forum Report to help them hold Seventh Tradition Challenge meetings with G.S.R.s and approach noncontributing groups. The real power and dedication of our Fellowship was illustrated by the attendance of our new chairperson at our January meeting; he had recently received a heart transplant.—*Dick Pickens*

Florida (South): We have now set aside a part of our quarterly assembly for a sharing session between general service, inter-group, and central office. The area also split our Corrections committee into Correction and Treatment Facilities committees. We had a large representation at the Southeast Regional Forum in Montgomery, including many past delegates, G.S.R.s, and D.C.M.s. Expenses of the delegate and alternate delegate were paid in full; we will also pay the expenses of the delegate and alternate delegate to the special Puerto Rico Forum in May 1987. The Virgin Islands are now a part of our area. We welcome them with great anticipation because of the added experience they bring to us.—*Hal Carty*

Hawaii: We have two new districts (11 total) and two more in the planning states. One district held a G.S.R. school, which proved very useful. Our major hurdle is to overcome apathy for support for our trusted servants. We have 11 districts on four different islands, separated by a vast body of water. When our annual assembly meets, we have much discussion about the travel budget for G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and committee officers. Because of the expense of flying inter-island, attendance by outer-island servants is poor. Therefore we have a disproportionately weighted assembly that reflects the group conscience of the island on which it is held.—*Greg Muth*

Illinois (Chicago): Our area now has 16 districts and about 75,000 members, with 3,200 meetings weekly. We now have one Spanish-speaking district. In 1986 our service structure was extensively revised. Our alternate delegate now shares attendance at standing committee meetings and district functions. In August 1987 we will host the Illinois State Convention; in September we will celebrate 48 years of A.A. with our Annual All Chicago Open Meeting. We are showing favorable response in accepting our

responsibility to our Seventh Tradition. Individual and group contributions are improving. Although we are not self-supporting, the trend is encouraging.—*Beth Bowen*

Illinois (Southern): Our area has 316 groups, 308 of which are active. We hold quarterly assemblies (the largest one in the spring). Our area participated in the 1986 Illinois State Conference in Harvey; we will be involved in the 1987 conference in Chicago and will host the 1988 conference. We will also host the East Central Regional Forum in Peoria in October 1987. In November 1986 we hosted the 26th Annual Tri-State Convention in Mt. Vernon (the first time for our state). Over 800 gathered to share and care, with many rural A.A.s joining in for the first time.—*James Cravens*

Indiana (Northern): The 1965 Conference recommended that a request for an additional delegate from Indiana be granted, effective in 1966. A new delegate was elected, but no area committee or assembly was formed. Attempts to establish a separate delegate area failed. Early in 1986 concerned service people held meetings in four locations. In October 1986 the G.S.R.s voted to establish an area committee and assembly for Area 22. We are now working on an area structure and determining meeting times and places. We are also working closely with Area 23 to facilitate amicable and fair division of monies. We hope to be a working and self-supporting delegate area by January 1988.—*Benjamin Williams*

Iowa: We have 563 groups and 19 districts. Our assembly meets twice a year. Our state conferences include workshops led by our committee chairpersons. Our service structure is good because we follow *The A.A. Service Manual*, with good sponsorship of past area committees. We have split districts to improve communication and build a solid service structure. Cluster meetings have supported growth and understanding, helping newer districts to become more informed, involved, and motivated. We are educating and encouraging our groups to financially increase support of the central offices, state structure, and G.S.O.—*Dale Abbas*

Louisiana: We now have 391 groups and about 6,252 members. Our assembly meets quarterly in Alexandria; workshops are held on Saturday, and our business meeting is held on Sunday. Recently five past delegates held a workshop on *The A.A. Service Manual*. Our State Convention was a huge success; attendance increased from 800 in 1984 to 1,700 in 1986. Surplus convention monies are donated to our area assembly. At the end of the third quarter of each year, 10% of our funds are contributed to G.S.O.—*Richard Trahan*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our area is geographically small, but we have over 1,400 groups and meetings. The area committee and our 26 districts meet monthly; we have three assemblies a year. The Treatment Facilities committee held its first seminar in February 1987. Our young people will host the 30th Annual Conference of Young People in A.A. in September 1987. GvRs are increasing at the district level; and we have a Spanish-speaking liaison to our area committee. Continuing problems: getting people to "stay active"; meeting places that want groups to carry insurance riders; and courts "sentencing" people to A.A.—*Jack Allison Jr.*

Michigan (Central): Our assembly meets monthly and moves from city to city. Since our assembly roams up and down the state, it services outlying groups and districts with literature. Our

Literature Committee is like a central office on wheels. Our area has 14 districts serviced by 40 D.C.M.s; 239 groups are registered with our assembly, and 372 with G.S.O. Last year we established an Archives Committee. Written financial guidelines for the Literature Committee and intra-area were established, and we completed our first audit and inventory of literature. This year we plan to study the feasibility of assigning each new G.S.R. to a standing committee when they register.—*Judy Whitehouse*

Michigan (Southeast): Our State Conference, held in Dearborn, was a success. Our Committee for the Hearing-impaired (newly formed and still in its infancy) has a dedicated staff. Communication with treatment facilities for the hearing-impaired is being initiated and a T.D.D. system is now active. The Eighth Michigan Conference of Young People in A.A. was held in November 1986, attended by over 1,000. The program was based on all Three Legacies. Our efforts in registering new groups has resulted in a group gain of 15% over 1985 and an increase in contributions to G.S.O. of 12%.—*Joseph Clement*

Minnesota (Southern): We have experienced a decade of growth and change. Our three annual assemblies are independent of other A.A. events. Our area committee meets quarterly. We have ten standing committees and an annual three-day service conference. We have discontinued automatic rotation of our delegate to area chairperson and rotation of delegate eligibility between metro and rural. All positions are filled by area-wide elections. The number of districts has increased from 12 to 18. For the next two years, our focus will be on the self-support project and increased activity of the standing committees.—*Jack Cawkwell*

Missouri (Eastern): Our area has 459 groups; all 20 districts have newcomers' meetings. We hold quarterly one-day assemblies. All districts work with the Treatment Facilities Committee. The number of treatment facilities has doubled in the past five years. Last year a district with over 60 groups was split into three new districts. Another large district is trying the local committee person procedure; each L.C.M. is responsible for about ten groups and reports to the D.C.M. Our young people will hold their first conference in May 1987. This year we formed a Finance Committee and a committee to help the handicapped.—*Rita Jourdan*

Missouri (Western): Our area has 197 groups, seven committees, and two intergroups. We hold two-day quarterly assemblies and co-host the State Convention with Eastern Missouri. Workshops are held in the districts, and over half the districts hold monthly meetings. Some groups support their G.S.R.s. The vacancy caused by the death of our archivist has been filled, and archives now has a traveling display. Our goals are: Tradition and Concept studies; active district committees and G.S.R.s; D.C.M. involvement; taping oldtimers; member and group donations; "bridging the gap" contacts; and assembly growth.—*Marilyn Parsons*

Nevada: Our area is strengthened and united with workshops hosted by various districts. The alternate area officers serve as active officers, which aids elected officers in performing their duties and prevents the dropout feeling that alternates often experience. We are focusing on Tradition Seven and the issue of full self-support. We are examining ways to improve our districting system to avoid moving geographical lines as we grow. We are encouraging study-group meetings on the Steps and Traditions. One of our strengths is growing interest in service sponsorship.—*Louise Robertson*

New Jersey (Northern): Our area is still working on the problem of Hazelton literature at our groups. We are also concerned about programs of our state and other organizations that require proof of attendance at A.A. meetings. Over the past few years, we have been working with our intergroup especially to improve the Treatment and Institutions Committees. We have a low attendance at functions about service business but good attendance at social service functions. In 1986 our first mini-Conference was held, with great success. Our area guidelines have been established, and we now have a committee that works with the state motor vehicle program.—*Tom Lichwa*

New York (Central): In February 1987 our Institutional Committee held a joint workshop with local correctional facilities. The large number of patients attending A.A. meetings from treatment facilities has caused concern and frustration, particularly for oldtimers who fear that meetings do not deal with alcoholism, and that the topics of hope, recovery, sobriety, and Higher Power are being replaced by counseling sessions, treatment talk, and discussions about emotions. Our C.P.C. Committee is now very active. We now practice the Traditions in a real way, deciding to live in the solution, not remain part of the problem.—*Bob Watt*

New York (Southeast): Our area is made up of 1,200 groups divided into about 80 districts, which hold monthly or bimonthly cluster meetings. We have five assemblies and ten committee meetings each year. Recently, we held area meetings outside Manhattan; we now rotate them. This change has attracted more G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s to service. We are also holding quarterly workshops to inform G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s as to their duties. Our three active Hispanic districts each have a bilingual D.C.M. Most P.I., C.P.C., and H&I work is handled by local intergroups and answering services. We are starting an area office.—*Michael Fleming*

North Carolina/Bermuda: In 1986 our assembly workshops were increased to 12. Each service person attended three workshops with three different topics: four on Recovery, four on Unity, and four on Service. In 1985 one big concern was lack of attendance at our assemblies. In 1986 attendance increased by 40% (our fall assembly had the largest attendance ever). Credit for this increase goes to our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s.—*Bill Sears*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Our area has about 240 groups divided into 16 districts. Our geographical structure makes travel both difficult and expensive. Therefore, we have one assembly a year, which rotates two years in Nova Scotia and one in Newfoundland. Attendance of G.S.R.s at assemblies has decreased because they must travel outside their provinces. Area officers meet with D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s in May at our Service Weekend in both Nova Scotia and Newfoundland. The exchange of minutes from district G.S.R. meetings has produced an exchange of ideas and a sense of sharing throughout our area. The response from the GvR program has been fantastic! We now have archivists in Nova Scotia and Newfoundland. Good communication exists among the area officers and D.C.M.s.—*Sylvia Abraham*

Ohio (Central and Southeastern): We have 420 groups, 60 of which registered in 1986. All is going smoothly, except for groups that move meeting locations from one district to another, new groups, and two districts that do not want change. Our C.P.C. Committee continues to be active and currently is in the process of establishing programs for 1,200 policemen in Columbus. Our P.I. and Grapevine Committees and the liaison to the central office are being revitalized. Committee members are focusing on education and encouragement for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s.—*Marge Koch*

Ohio (Northeast): The number of groups in our area has almost doubled over the last six years. We now have 38 districts and 970 groups. We are focusing on kindling new interest in service and relighting the fire under seasoned members. We are redistricting to improve communication between D.C.M.s and the growing number of groups. We are setting up a travel display and presentation on the structure of the Fellowship. A newsletter has been developed. We feel a deep need to communicate the existence of a service structure, its purpose, and how it impacts on the groups.—*Joyce Kormer*

Oklahoma: Our area has 320 groups. To bring about more unity and participation, the area committee sponsored and underwrote four workshops in districts with lack of communication and general A.A. activity; over 500 participated. Interest in service was stimulated by these workshops. Group meeting attendance has increased; more A.A.s are available for service; and financial support has increased. The first "bridging the gap" workshop for treatment facilities was held. This program carried the message to over 2,700 patients last year. Our Oklahoma Area Conference, held in Tulsa, was attended by over 2,000.—*Dean Rinehart*

Ontario (Eastern): Our area committee celebrates its 10th anniversary this year. We hold semi-annual two-day assemblies. Day one consists of service sharing, with emphasis on helping G.S.R.s to better understand A.A. Attendance has increased at every assembly since adopting this format. Four years ago, we added an Agenda Committee to plan the service sharing part of the assembly. Our area includes part of the northern part of New York State; two districts straddle the U.S./Canadian border, and one district is entirely in northern New York. For the large part, our D.C.M.s are taking on the task of educating the groups about supporting our support system.—*Dennis Doyle*

Ontario (Northwestern): The institutional chairperson had the cooperation of our past institutional chairperson and intergroup's institutional chairperson in forming a committee which meets monthly. A liaison has been elected for each institution in District #1, and we hope other districts will respond. The Grapevine chairperson has the cooperation of two districts in increasing interest in the Grapevine. The Grapevine display has been shown at workshops and at our conference. A.A. is still growing in our area — 11 groups were formed in 1986. We now have 74 groups plus three institutions groups.—*Diane Faulconer*

Ontario (Northeast): Our area has 177 groups with eight active districts. Rotating our assemblies has increased interest and attendance. Our focus is communication to improve declining financial support (we travel 300 to 400 miles between districts). Workshops increase the number of informed trusted servants who carry the message to isolated groups. Further involvement in both our official languages is becoming more necessary as our membership increases in the north. Several major treatment centers are also a present reality. Service sponsorship now receives more attention.—*Art McCord*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Our area has 31 districts, 904 groups, and 60 meetings. A.A. meetings are held in 59 institutions and 25 prisons. In 1987 we formed our Grapevine Committee, chaired by the alternate delegate. Alternate D.C.M.s serve as GV chairpersons. Each year, after the Conference, we hold four mini-assemblies to hear the delegate's report and share on chosen topics. Past delegates have been active in our Annual Convention and other events. Much enthusiasm and willingness exist throughout our service structure, having a positive effect on all groups.—*Bill Griffiths*

Pennsylvania (Western): Our area has taken a definite turn for the better. Area officers, G.S.R.s, and D.C.M.s are more aware of their duties and responsibilities to members. We have a greater interest in service, largely due to our Weekend of Sharing, which has made service more available and attractive. The most noticeable improvement is in P.I./C.P.C. Today more than half of our 32 districts have active, self-supporting P.I./C.P.C. Committees. There is an excitement and an eagerness to do twelfth-step work, and we hope that, in the near future, P.I./C.P.C. will encompass all our districts.—*Regis Flannery*

Quebec (Northeast): Our area has 19 districts. Most of our groups are French-speaking; we have a few English-speaking groups and three groups for a population of 7,000 to 8,000 Native Canadians. In 1986, out of 323 groups, only 14 were not in touch with us. Even though our area is huge and traveling costs are high, we try to keep in contact with all A.A. members and hold area meetings as often as necessary. The area committee meets monthly and meets with D.C.M.s every three months. Workshops are scheduled a few times a year on the tasks of the G.S.R. and D.C.M., the Twelfth Step, and the Twelve Traditions. Last fall we began a workshop on the Twelve Concepts.

—*Micheline DuBerger*

Quebec (Southeast): Our area has 18 districts, most of which have institutions and P.I. committees and GvRs. We meet four times a year plus one general assembly. We also meet three times a year with the other three area in our province. Our 220 groups are all French-speaking and hold 255 meetings a week. Before the Conference, we held three assemblies to share on the Conference theme and topics. After the Conference, we will hold two gratitude dinners where the delegate's report is given. We have had an active year and hope that, with membership support and unity, we will keep moving forward.—*Real McIntyre*

Texas (Northeast): Our area has 22 districts, 5 intergroups, and 378 groups (an increase of 20%). Our Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, P.I., and C.P.C. Committees have encouraged the formation of the same committees on the district level — about 30% of the districts now have active service committees. Monthly district meetings are held, and service committees meet prior to the district meeting. Our service structure weakness usually develops from members' complacency when members occupy the same service jobs too long. One of our largest groups has suffered due to a lack of communication in all meetings of the Second and Third Legacies. Informative action has been taken.—*Pete Peterson*

Texas (Southeast): Our area is divided into ten districts, some of which are divided into zones, giving us 14 districts (one is Spanish-speaking). The area Policy and Procedures has been in effect for three and a half years and has been a great asset. Our P.I. and Correctional Committees have been doing a great job. An Archives Committee, formed last year, is just getting started. A lot of our members attended the 1985 Regional Forum in Dallas. We have grown tremendously and are striving to continue a strong service structure to better serve the area and A.A. as a whole.—*George Sehon*

Utah: Our area is experiencing real growing pains, in part due to the large influx of treatment centers, some of which has been generated by the change in our state law. Hospitals no longer must prove a need in order to be approved. Our Hospitals Committee is keeping up with this challenge. We are preparing for the 1988 Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly, to be held in Salt Lake City in March. Our area has four assemblies a year and

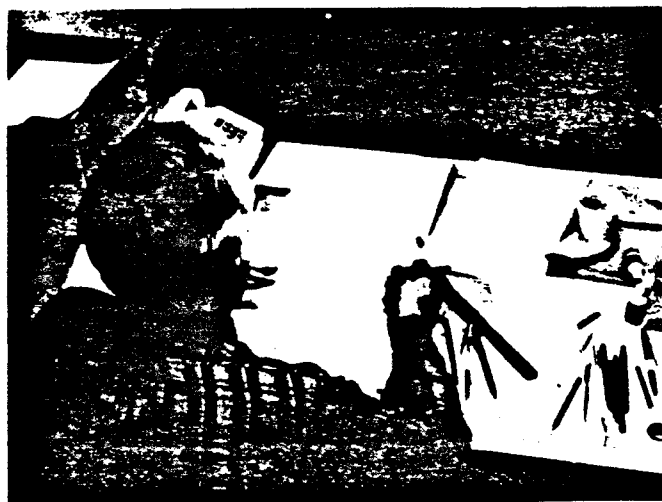
about 200 groups. One district has just been split, and we now have ten. We are striving toward unity in our service entities to help ensure our continued growth.—*Terry Anderson*

Virginia: Our area has about 800 groups and 28 districts. The D.C.M.s are assigned to our ten standing committees. Our assembly workshops have attracted more people, especially young people. Many districts are now self-supporting and several are working toward that goal. We hope that we will see more Grapevines in circulation; that more people will be exposed to A.A. through our P.I. and C.P.C. work; and that we will attract more alcoholics into service through good sponsorship. In August 1987, we will host the Southeastern Regional Conference and State Convention in Richmond.—*Jim Ball*

Washington: Our area has 28 districts spanning Washington, Northern Idaho, and Southeast British Columbia. We had 400 voting G.S.R.s at our last annual area assembly. To ensure adequate preparation for our G.S.R.s and committee members for this event, we've begun to hold smaller preassemblies in various locations. We are completing our area history, *Our Stories Disclose*, which will be ready in October 1987. We already have many volunteers to work on the 1990 International Convention, which we will proudly host in Seattle.—*Denis Foster*

West Virginia: We now have approximately 200 groups and 2,500 members. Some groups have as many as five meetings a week. Some of our larger, more populated districts have 24-hour answering services. In order to reach those still suffering in the less populated sections of our state, we have a statewide "800" number, which is listed in 50 telephone books. We believe this to be a "first" for any area.—*Bob Watkins*

Wisconsin (Southern): Our area is growing by leaps and bounds. We have about 1,000 groups and 31 districts. Redistricting is still going on, and by the end of the year we may have 35 districts. More members are becoming involved in service by accepting positions as G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s and serving on area committees. Many workshops were held this past year; service topics were the format used by most. Our spring and fall conferences are well attended (between 600 and 700).—*Larry Midworth*



Free-lance artist Jim McConnell laying out this Final Report

The General Service Office INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1986

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$7,485,685			\$7,485,685
Discount to A.A. Groups	(120,466)			(120,466)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>7,365,219</u>			<u>7,365,219</u>
Cost of printing	(2,418,140)			(2,418,140)
Royalties	(912,548)			(912,548)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>4,034,531</u>			<u>4,034,531</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$2,665,634		2,665,634
Interest income	<u>23,037</u>	<u>8,264</u>		<u>31,301</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>4,057,568</u>	<u>2,673,898</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>6,731,466</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	963,139	1,495,585		2,458,724
Pension expense	243,557			243,557
Rent	181,137	194,163		375,300
Box 4-5-9		118,206		118,206
A.A. Directories		77,290		77,290
Other service materials		206,519		206,519
Shipping and mailing	755,973			755,973
Other office expenses	42,033	362,491		404,524
Insurance and payroll taxes		389,142		389,142
Professional services	139,922		19,114	159,036
Board, committee and staff meetings	37,117	11,778	104,458	153,353
Writers' fees	61,443			61,443
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	7,381		111,183	118,564
General Service Conference		193,657		193,657
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	89,715			89,715
Regional Forums and other			84,223	84,223
Foreign literature assistance (net)	3,351			3,351
World Service Meeting			50,461	50,461
Film project			145,305	145,305
Grapevine management study			26,007	26,007
Leasehold improvements and construction			72,243	72,243
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>2,524,768</u>	<u>3,048,831</u>	<u>612,994</u>	<u>6,186,593</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>\$1,532,800</u>	<u>(374,933)</u>	<u>(612,994)</u>	<u>544,873</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$4,641,025
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				750,000
Transfer to General Fund				(100,000)
Investment Income				<u>870,072</u>
Balance, December 31				<u>\$6,161,097</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The General Service Office INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1985

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$7,251,232			\$7,251,232
Discount to A.A. Groups	(298,496)			(298,496)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>6,952,736</u>			<u>6,952,736</u>
Cost of printing	(2,391,618)			(2,391,618)
Royalties	(836,773)			(836,773)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>3,724,345</u>			<u>3,724,345</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$2,378,828		2,378,828
50th Anniversary Convention			\$315,940	315,940
Interest income	<u>24,370</u>	<u>7,906</u>		<u>32,276</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,748,715</u>	<u>2,386,734</u>	<u>315,940</u>	<u>6,451,389</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	950,087	1,408,633		2,358,720
Pension expense	223,339			223,339
Rent	159,697	171,181		330,878
Box 4-5-9		118,157		118,157
A.A. Directories		83,940		83,940
Other service materials		223,043		223,043
Shipping and mailing	755,114			755,114
Other office expenses	65,884	397,532	17,415	480,831
Insurance and payroll taxes		324,925		324,925
Professional services	90,297		10,920	101,217
Board, committee and staff meetings	24,122	10,600	97,455	132,177
Writers' fees	20,171			20,171
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	5,171		105,724	110,895
General Service Conference		166,116		166,116
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	90,775			90,775
Regional Forums and other			61,390	61,390
Foreign literature assistance (net)	28,303			28,303
Leasehold improvements			16,258	16,258
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>2,412,960</u>	<u>2,904,127</u>	<u>309,162</u>	<u>5,626,249</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>\$1,335,755</u>	<u>(517,393)</u>	<u>6,778</u>	<u>825,140</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$3,848,285
Transfers from A.A.W.S.				300,000
Investment income				<u>492,740</u>
Balance, December 31				<u>\$4,641,025</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1986

	1986	1985
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$1,426,695</u>	<u>\$1,352,961</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$219,176	\$184,182
Printing	213,087	184,627
Mailing — service	108,785	92,358
postage	149,893	118,950
Other production costs	98,503	74,053
Calendar costs	26,363	28,564
Occupancy costs	39,037	34,911
Telephone	1,792	1,771
Office supplies and expenses	12,630	4,242
Writers fees	7,500	—
Other editorial expenses	4,027	3,649
<u>Total</u>	880,793	727,307
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	297,180	279,274
Data processing costs	16,320	42,189
Stationery and supplies	11,665	11,368
Occupancy costs	39,037	34,765
Telephone	1,826	1,745
Office expense, including agency fees	23,281	14,049
Selling expense — Regular	50,330	31,100
GVR program	32,047	24,257
Postage	42,388	44,403
<u>Total</u>	514,074	483,150
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	5,496	5,496
Insurance	41,752	28,741
Professional fees	32,955	13,135
Payroll taxes	38,611	33,504
Meetings and conferences	17,496	13,003
Computer system development, etc.	18,486	59,151
Furniture and equipment	14,086	6,906
Contribution to Retirement Plan	22,308	19,835
Canadian exchange	1,139	2,766
Severance benefits	60,142	—
<u>Total</u>	252,471	182,537
<u>Total Costs and Expenses</u>	<u>\$1,647,338</u>	<u>\$1,392,994</u>
<u>Income (Loss) from Operations</u>	<u>(220,643)</u>	<u>(40,033)</u>
Interest earned	58,095	40,033
Cumulative effect of a change in accounting method	<u>64,862</u>	<u>—</u>
Net Income (Loss) for Year	<u>(97,686)</u>	<u>—</u>

() denotes red figures

The General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

December 31, 1986

	December 31, 1986		December 31, 1985	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
Assets				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 315,200	\$ 99,059	\$ 188,321	\$ 61,117
Short-term cash investments	585,833	113,975	1,130,928	115,994
Investment (Note C)	—	566,941	—	514,138
Accounts receivable	157,553	65,345	93,310	41,837
Due from Grapevine	11,538	—	23,028	—
Inventories	1,209,166	134,003	1,071,142	116,825
Prepaid expenses and deposits	120,299	79,977	77,158	106,400
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>2,399,589</u>	<u>1,059,300</u>	<u>2,583,887</u>	<u>956,311</u>
Deduct Liabilities				
Accounts and accruals payable	493,915	146,710	521,410	81,428
Deferred income	11,056	989,592	62,732	854,199
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>504,971</u>	<u>1,136,302</u>	<u>584,142</u>	<u>935,627</u>
Net Worth				
Balance, January 1	1,999,745	20,684	1,474,605	(86,316)
Net income (loss)	544,873	(97,686)	825,140	—
Prior period adjustment — unfulfilled subscription liability not required	—	—	—	107,000
Transfer to Reserve Fund (net)	(650,000)	—	(300,000)	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,894,618</u>	<u>(77,002)</u>	<u>1,999,745</u>	<u>20,684</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,837,605		\$1,942,732	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,894,618		1,999,745	
Reserve Fund	6,161,097		4,641,025	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>8,055,715</u>		<u>6,640,770</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	\$ 11,375		\$ 33,281	
Short term cash investments	1,283,759		133,909	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(51,000)		(32,810)	
U.S. Treasury obligations	5,381,315		4,877,633	
Accrued interest	102,589		143,150	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(566,941)		(514,138)	
<u>Balance, December 31</u>	<u>6,161,097</u>		<u>4,641,025</u>	

() denotes red figures

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS, DECEMBER 31, 1986

NOTE A — PURPOSES AND RESTRICTIONS OF DIFFERENT FUNDS

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was re-defined as one year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and, since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

NOTE B — After transfers of \$887,927 in 1986 and \$510,615 in 1985 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$566,941, represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, plus subsequent net investments of \$86,221 as shown below:

	Investment (Withdrawal)
1981	\$ (100,000)
1983	13,418
1984	60,000
1985	60,000
1986	52,803
	<u>86,221</u>

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountant.

The General Service Office 1987 BUDGET

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund		General Service Office Total
		Office	Other	
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$7,900,000			\$7,900,000
Discount to A.A. Groups	(237,000)			(237,000)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>7,663,000</u>			<u>7,663,000</u>
Cost of printing	(2,733,400)			(2,733,400)
Royalties	(955,900)			(955,900)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>3,973,700</u>			<u>3,973,700</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$3,028,000		3,028,000
Interest income	<u>17,000</u>	<u>8,000</u>		<u>25,000</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,990,700</u>	<u>3,036,000</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>7,026,700</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,179,200	1,608,000		2,787,200
Pension expense	254,800			254,800
Rent	281,400	206,700		488,100
Box 4-5-9		142,500		142,500
A.A. Directories		80,500		80,500
Other service materials		231,300		231,300
Shipping and mailing	784,200			784,200
Other office expenses	53,600	412,300	17,000	482,900
Insurance and payroll taxes		467,700		467,700
Professional services	70,000		17,000	87,000
Board, committee and staff meetings	47,900	13,800	125,000	186,700
Writers' fees	95,900			95,900
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	11,000		111,300	122,300
General Service Conference		219,700		219,700
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	111,000			111,000
Regional Forums and other			92,400	92,400
Foreign literature assistance (net)	10,000			10,000
Film development			98,300	98,300
Publication Division study	10,000			10,000
Construction & refurbishing			763,200	763,200
Self-Support Project			50,000	50,000
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>2,909,000</u>	<u>3,382,500</u>	<u>1,274,200</u>	<u>7,565,700</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>1,081,700</u>	<u>(346,500)</u>	<u>(1,274,200)</u>	<u>(539,000)</u>
Construction — Funded by Reserve Fund			763,200	763,200
<u>Adjusted Net Income (Expense)</u>	<u>1,081,700</u>	<u>(346,500)</u>	<u>(511,000)</u>	<u>224,200</u>

() denotes red figures

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

1987 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: Sales income has been budgeted at \$7,900,000, \$399,400 (5.3%) greater than 1986. This projection includes the first full year's impact of the portable Big Book, as well as the introduction of a 4% sales discount to all purchasers of \$25.00 or more, effective April 1, 1987. Total income after cost of printing, royalties and the 4% discount (and including interest earned) is estimated at \$3,990,700.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$2,909,000, representing an increase of \$384,200 over 1986. Part of this increase is due to the planned addition of three persons.

Net: Net publishing income, after operating expenses, is expected to be \$1,081,700.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: Contributions are budgeted at \$3,028,000, \$362,400 (13.6%) over 1986, based on anticipated support from the Fellowship to the Self-Support project.

Expenses: Total group expenses to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted to be \$3,382,500. This budget anticipates the addition of one person in this area. These expenses are \$346,500 greater than contribution income and will be offset by anticipated net income from publishing.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$1,274,200. This includes \$763,200 for construction and refurbishing to be paid for out of the General Service Board Reserve Fund. Exclusive of construction costs, these other expenses are budgeted \$29,800 (5.5%) less than 1985. These expenses will also be offset by anticipated net income from publishing.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1987 of "group services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$865,500. This is exclusive of construction and refurbishing which is paid for by the G.S.B. Reserve Fund. The makeup of this shortfall is shown on the right.

1987 Grapevine Budget

Total income: Income from magazine and other sales is budgeted at \$1,615,000.

Total expenses: Expenses are budgeted at \$1,610,000. These expenses do not include salaries for a publisher and circulation manager. These positions are vacant and are not planned to be filled in the foreseeable future. The operation is being directed by a management team consisting of the Grapevine controller and editor.

Net: The net operating income for 1987 is \$5,000. After interest earned from operating cash and on monies in the G.S.B. Reserve Fund for unfulfilled subscriptions, total net income is budgeted to be \$62,000.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

- a. G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and Final Conference Report]:

1985

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members		\$2,378,828
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$2,904,127	
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board	309,162	3,213,289
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions		<u>(834,461)</u>

1986

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members		\$2,665,634
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,048,831	
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board	\$ 612,994	
Less: Construction—Funded by the General Service Board Reserve Fund	(72,243)	540,751
		3,589,582
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions		<u>(923,948)</u>

1987 BUDGET

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members		\$3,028,000
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,382,500	
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board	\$1,274,200	
Less: Construction—Funded by the General Service Board Reserve Fund	(783,200)	511,000
		3,893,500
Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions		<u>(865,500)</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1987 BUDGET

	<u>1987</u>
INCOME — from subscriptions and other sales	<u>\$1,615,000</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING	
Salaries, including temporary help	\$171,050
Printing	217,000
Mailing — service	124,000
— postage	160,000
Other production costs	95,700
Calendar costs	22,000
Occupancy costs	62,000
Telephone	2,200
Office supplies and expenses	7,400
Other editorial expenses	4,800
Writers' fees	<u>11,500</u>
<u>Total</u>	877,650
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS	
Salaries, including temporary help	293,000
Data processing costs	20,000
Stationery and supplies	8,600
Occupancy costs	62,000
Telephone	2,200
Office expense, including agency fees	26,000
Selling expense — regular	44,500
— GvR program	24,600
Postage	<u>50,000</u>
<u>Total</u>	530,900
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE	
Consultant fees	5,500
Insurance	45,660
Professional fees	20,000
Payroll taxes	38,000
Meetings and conferences	16,000
Computer system development, etc.	20,000
Furniture and equipment	20,000
Contribution to Retirement Plan	33,000
Canadian exchange	<u>3,500</u>
<u>Total</u>	<u>201,660</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,610,210</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS	4,790
Interest earned	<u>56,000</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR	<u><u>60,790</u></u>

1986 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	331	178	53.7%	\$ 13,029.67	4,181	\$3.12	61.	Rhode Island	178	88	49.4	9,891.23	3,344	2.96
2.	Alaska	177	83	46.8	6,604.63	2,350	2.81	62.	South Carolina	220	160	72.7	15,083.12	3,500	4.31
3.	Arizona	545	249	45.6	27,355.96	9,041	3.03	63.	South Dakota	132	70	53.0	5,726.05	2,571	2.23
4.	Arkansas	194	112	57.7	7,504.80	2,768	2.71	64.	Tennessee	340	203	59.7	21,734.67	5,219	4.16
5.	California								Texas						
5.	Southern	1,315	614	46.6	74,956.37	42,461	1.77	65.	Northeast	335	159	47.4	28,200.27	10,388	2.71
6.	N. Coastal	1,575	1,045	66.3	136,713.92	37,926	3.60	66.	Northwest	197	92	46.7	10,321.18	4,538	2.27
7.	N. Interior	507	235	46.3	26,253.53	10,743	2.44	67.	Southeast	385	214	55.5	25,012.30	10,899	2.29
8.	San Diego/Imp.	512	262	51.1	28,172.42	13,337	2.11	68.	Southwest	372	201	54.0	26,444.34	7,001	3.78
9.	Mid-South	1,182	588	49.7	66,872.86	35,668	1.87	69.	Utah	180	95	52.7	8,374.18	2,975	2.81
10.	Colorado	538	261	48.5	33,621.91	11,577	2.90	70.	Vermont	166	90	54.2	9,902.22	2,747	3.60
11.	Connecticut	902	425	47.1	50,955.59	19,023	2.68	71.	Virginia	836	488	58.3	62,393.43	15,766	3.96
12.	Delaware	115	76	66.0	11,504.10	1,811	6.35	72.	Washington	920	472	51.3	50,507.19	17,075	2.96
13.	D.C.	311	204	65.5	41,369.83	9,864	4.19	73.	West Virginia	200	99	49.5	7,108.41	2,302	3.09
	Florida								Wisconsin						
14.	North	385	232	60.2	26,403.73	6,722	3.93	74.	N.Wis./Upper						
15.	South	1,017	581	57.1	76,921.56	16,607	4.63		Pen. Mich.	519	229	44.1	18,783.72	7,572	2.48
16.	Georgia	525	363	69.1	41,637.16	10,941	3.81	75.	South	635	311	48.9	25,712.18	11,507	2.23
17.	Hawaii	200	136	68.0	12,744.15	3,382	3.77	76.	Wyoming	111	61	54.9	3,307.88	1,723	1.92
18.	Idaho	159	87	54.7	5,881.03	2,047	2.87	77.	Puerto Rico	116	53	45.6	2,623.45	1,444	1.82
	Illinois							78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	489	215	43.9	20,282.13	6,195	3.27
19.	Chicago	854	359	42.0	44,709.69	19,408	2.30	79.	B.C./Yukon	576	255	44.0	22,189.94	8,663	2.56
20.	North	658	309	46.9	27,572.78	11,791	2.34	80.	Manitoba	152	64	42.1	5,379.43	3,502	1.54
21.	South	317	146	46.0	12,369.00	5,408	2.29	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	224	96	42.8	5,650.59	3,194	1.77
	Indiana							82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	248	112	45.1	7,154.96	2,856	2.51
22.	North	476	210	44.1	19,759.61	7,078	2.79		Ontario						
23.	South	266	171	64.2	19,078.88	4,989	3.82	83.	East	502	187	37.2	22,263.03	11,535	1.93
24.	Iowa	562	276	49.1	22,189.60	10,380	2.14	84.	Northeast	174	51	29.3	5,014.48	2,115	2.37
25.	Kansas	319	205	64.2	17,629.73	6,708	2.63	85.	Northwest	84	27	32.1	2,271.98	1,275	1.78
26.	Kentucky	393	232	59.0	35,053.44	6,189	5.66	86.	West	427	182	42.6	23,051.52	6,618	3.48
27.	Louisiana	419	228	54.4	19,156.01	6,942	2.76		Quebec						
28.	Maine	289	125	43.2	11,296.95	4,956	2.28	87.	Southwest	529	289	54.6	28,737.42	13,674	2.10
29.	Maryland	653	323	49.4	36,546.63	8,985	4.07	88.	Southeast	227	202	89.0	21,334.68	3,087	6.91
	Massachusetts							89.	Northeast	327	327	100.0	12,367.64	5,912	2.09
30.	East	888	480	54.0	73,760.83	25,583	2.88	90.	Northwest	297	297	100.0	36,735.48	5,577	6.59
31.	West	150	76	50.6	10,663.34	3,132	3.40	91.	Saskatchewan	324	164	50.6	8,698.05	3,839	2.27
	Michigan								Total U.S./						
32.	Central	368	190	51.6	25,390.34	7,485	3.39		Canada	40,529	20,114 ^①	49.6% ^①	\$2,328,938.81 ^②	803,192	\$2.90 ^①
33.	Southeast	445	216	48.5	34,028.07	9,576	3.55		Bahamas	4	0	0	0	93	0
34.	West	302	150	49.6	19,949.99	5,843	3.41		V.I. of U.S.	9	7	77.8	2,532.85	237	10.69
	Minnesota									40,542	21,121 ^①	52.1% ^①	\$2,331,471.66 ^②	803,522	\$2.90 ^①
35.	North	509	258	50.6	14,669.22	8,108	1.81		Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				\$ 114,306.04		
36.	South	863	418	48.4	37,214.54	25,121	1.48		Specials				199,995.69		
37.	Mississippi	211	123	58.2	7,138.03	2,407	2.97		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$2,645,773.39		
	Missouri								FOREIGN AND OTHER						
38.	East	426	236	55.3	23,850.86	5,806	4.11		Birds of a Feather				\$ 415.00		
39.	West	201	123	61.1	12,401.21	4,285	2.89		Correctional facility groups				100.00		
40.	Montana	280	109	38.9	7,755.13	3,654	2.12		Foreign				11,824.60		
41.	Nebraska	598	336	56.1	35,705.07	10,710	3.33		International Advisory Council of Young						
42.	Nevada	239	115	48.1	9,843.58	3,346	2.94		People in A.A.				7,300.00		
43.	New Hampshire	295	153	51.8	19,872.10	3,894	5.10		Internationalists				10.00		
	New Jersey								Loners				1,601.30		
44.	North	971	435	44.7	56,173.28	21,332	2.63		Treatment facility groups				818.00		
45.	South	241	138	57.2	21,342.11	3,566	5.98		World Hello				44.93		
46.	New Mexico	239	126	52.7	9,513.56	3,704	2.57		Grand Total				\$2,667,887.22		
	New York														
47.	Central	479	225	46.9	30,087.29	6,476	4.65								
48.	H.M.B.	438	218	49.7	16,571.48	5,181	3.20								
49.	Southeast	1,282	635	49.5	106,327.62	33,980	3.13								
50.	West	213	104	48.8	9,066.81	2,994	3.03								
51.	N. Carolina/Ber.	590	380	66.6	44,269.00	9,061	4.89								
52.	North Dakota	160	85	53.1	6,836.99	2,764	2.47								
	Ohio														
53.	Cent. & S.E.	419	181	43.1	18,263.85	4,893	3.73								
54.	Northeast	872	221	25.3	18,688.20	21,697	.86								
55.	N.W. Ohio/														
	S.E. Mich.	221	100	45.2	10,912.18	3,191	3.42								
56.	S.W. Ohio	322	165	51.2	16,292.41	6,340	2.57								
57.	Oklahoma	323	244	75.5	20,526.88	4,299	4.77								
58.	Oregon	518	272	52.5	23,829.00	7,184	3.32								
	Pennsylvania														
59.	East	819	438	53.4	54,198.33	18,009	3.01								
60.	West	529	296	55.9	27,674.82	7,675	3.61								

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1986-1985

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada 1986	40,542	21,121 ^①	52.1% ^①	\$2,331,471.66 ^②	803,522	\$2.90 ^①
U.S. & Canada 1985	38,285	19,989 ^①	52.2% ^①	2,100,421.31 ^②	750,511	2.80 ^①
Increase (Decrease)	2,257	1,132	(0.1%)	\$ 231,050.35	53,011	\$.10

1986 Total Contributions — by State / Province

U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	254	134	52.7%	\$ 9,255.91	3,578	\$2.58
Alaska	177	83	46.8	8,783.39	2,350	3.73
Arizona	537	246	45.8	30,080.67	9,059	3.32
Arkansas	193	112	58.0	8,760.63	2,754	3.18
California	5,138	2,764	53.7	381,269.62	141,808	2.68
Colorado	537	261	48.6	38,707.72	11,566	3.34
Connecticut	911	431	47.3	61,155.75	19,276	3.17
Delaware	114	75	65.7	12,034.85	1,780	6.76
District of Columbia	140	74	52.8	19,113.59	4,604	4.15
Florida	1,479	857	57.9	140,865.66	24,359	5.78
Georgia	525	363	69.1	43,294.46	10,941	3.95
Hawaii	200	136	68.0	13,653.02	3,382	4.03
Idaho	198	108	54.5	7,737.75	2,429	3.18
Illinois	1,828	814	44.5	104,163.91	36,706	2.83
Indiana	768	398	51.8	44,088.84	12,472	3.53
Iowa	563	276	49.0	25,559.00	10,387	2.46
Kansas	318	205	64.4	19,250.63	6,697	2.87
Kentucky	368	215	58.4	33,846.25	5,832	5.80
Louisiana	419	228	54.4	21,301.18	6,942	3.06
Maine	280	122	43.5	13,592.75	4,880	2.78
Maryland	819	450	54.9	66,702.57	14,103	4.72
Massachusetts	1,058	562	53.1	90,213.85	28,968	3.11
Michigan	1,281	627	48.9	92,788.44	25,107	3.69
Minnesota	1,370	674	49.1	62,501.97	33,304	1.87
Mississippi	211	123	58.2	7,176.03	2,407	2.98
Missouri	625	358	57.2	39,117.87	10,075	3.88
Montana	280	108	38.5	9,204.35	3,654	2.51
Nebraska	598	336	56.1	44,614.07	10,710	4.16
Nevada	202	99	49.0	12,384.75	2,842	4.35
New Hampshire	297	156	52.5	21,063.22	3,923	5.36
New Jersey	1,209	574	47.4	85,507.84	24,833	3.44
New Mexico	238	125	52.5	10,241.06	3,565	2.87
New York	2,427	1,164	48.7	189,316.64	48,661	3.89
North Carolina	570	380	66.6	45,748.52	8,903	5.13
North Dakota	160	85	53.1	8,220.24	2,764	2.97
Ohio	1,804	657	36.4	70,863.66	35,196	2.01
Oklahoma	324	244	75.3	23,360.28	4,312	5.41
Oregon	522	274	52.4	27,212.35	7,230	3.76
Pennsylvania	1,369	748	54.6	93,526.19	25,970	3.60
Rhode Island	174	84	48.2	11,397.73	3,215	3.54
South Carolina	221	161	72.8	16,442.37	3,505	4.69
South Dakota	132	70	53.0	7,675.10	2,571	2.98
Tennessee	340	203	59.7	23,412.97	5,219	4.48
Texas	1,289	665	51.5	104,806.06	32,534	3.22
Utah	180	95	52.7	10,216.65	2,975	3.43
Vermont	163	87	53.3	10,959.33	2,704	4.05
Virginia	843	493	58.4	69,789.51	15,932	4.38
Washington	866	440	50.8	53,339.69	16,505	3.23
West Virginia	196	97	49.4	8,351.38	2,255	3.70
Wisconsin	1,024	482	47.0	41,452.09	17,704	2.34
Wyoming	114	63	55.2	3,467.88	1,765	1.96
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	116	53	45.6	2,713.45	1,444	1.87
Bahama Islands	4	0	0	—	93	—
Virgin Islands of U.S.	9	7	77.7	2,532.85	237	10.68
Bermuda	20	0	0	—	158	—
TOTAL for U.S.	36,002	18,666	51.8%	\$2,402,836.54	727,145	\$3.30

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alberta	432	200	46.2%	\$ 34,494.25	5,559	\$6.21
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	170	69	40.5	5,351.48	2,118	2.53
Newfoundland	101	40	39.6	3,412.33	875	3.90
Nova Scotia	146	73	50.0	8,080.31	1,943	4.16
Prince Edward Island	66	31	46.9	2,870.64	1,199	2.39
Labrador	2	0	0.0	—	37	—
British Columbia	613	271	44.2	39,844.10	9,096	4.38
Manitoba	152	64	42.1	7,958.67	3,502	2.27
N.W. Territories	23	4	17.3	382.92	235	1.63
Ontario	1,141	422	36.9	80,274.24	21,017	3.82
Quebec	1,363	1,115	81.8	138,936.08	26,851	5.17
Saskatchewan	324	164	50.6	13,512.63	3,852	3.51
Yukon Territory	7	2	28.5	801.67	93	8.62
TOTAL for (Canadian dollars)	4,540	2,455①	54.1%①	335,919.32	76,377	4.40①
(converted to U.S. dollars)				242,936.85		3.18)
TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars)	40,542	21,121①	52.1%①	\$2,645,773.39	803,522	3.29①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Birds of a Feather				415.00		
Correctional facility groups				100.00		
Foreign				11,824.60		
International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				7,300.00		
Internationalists				10.00		
Loners				1601.30		
Treatment facility groups				818.00		
World Hello				44.93		
GRAND TOTAL				\$2,667,887.22		

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1985-1986 (IN U.S. DOLLARS)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1986	36,002	18,666	51.8%	\$2,402,836.54	727,145	\$3.30
U.S. 1985	33,840	17,536	51.8	2,146,031.50	676,234	3.17
Increase						
(Decrease)	2,162	1,130	0 %	\$ 256,805.04	50,911	\$.13
Canada 1986	4,540	2,455①	54.1%①	\$ 242,936.85	76,377	\$3.18①
Canada 1985	4,445	2,453①	55.2 ①	207,481.26	74,277	2.79①
Increase						
(Decrease)	95	2	(1.1%)	\$ 35,455.59	2,100	\$.39
U.S. and Canada 1986	40,542	21,121①	52.1%①	\$2,645,773.39	803,522	\$3.29①
U.S. and Canada 1985	38,285	19,989①	52.2 ①	2,353,512.76	750,511	3.14①
Increase						
(Decrease)	2,257	1,132	(0.1%)	\$ 292,260.63	53,011	\$.15



**REGIONAL MAP
OF UNITED STATES AND CANADA**

1987 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

³Jack Allison
²Tom Beebe
 Rita Jourdan
 Art McCord
 Leon Morehouse
¹Dave Roberts
 Bob Watkins
 Cole Zobel

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Finance

²Real Bourgeois
 Beth Bowen
 Michael Fleming
¹Louis Hall
 Kathy Jarchow
 Gene Ray
 Dave Smoot
 Bruce Sutherland

Secretary: Ed Gordon

Policy/Admissions

²Cliff Carlson
 Jack Cawkwell
 Denis Doyle
 Rege Flannery
 Buddy Holder
 Marge Koch
¹Will Noble
 Jerome Waller

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Treatment Facilities

Dale Abbas
 Edell Estenson
 Joyce Korner
 Walter Kronkvist
 Tom Lichwa
²Pete Robinson
 Bill Sears
¹Walter Thompson

Secretary: Maureen Costello

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Hal Carty
 Louise Dumais-Adams
 Gwen Fields
 Michael Goldsmith
 Bill Hay
²Wes Jones
 George Schon
¹Jan Whitney

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Grapevine

Terry Anderson
¹Art Cross
 Diane Faulconer
 Harry Fischler
 Katherine Guy
²Richard Haas
 Chester Norton
 Dean Rinehart
 John Sears

Secretary: Ames Sweet

Public Information

Jim Ball
²Ed Cavin
 Bob Dodge
 Micheline Duberger
 Larry Midworth
 Sam Parsons
¹Tom Simpson
 Bonnie Taylor

Secretary: Eileen Gatz

Trustees

Lawrence Adams
 Bacon Cravens
²Paul Davidson
 Denis Foster
¹Lynn Macomber
 Pete Peterson
 William Schmidt
 Billy Speight
 Bubs Trahan

Secretary: Cheryl Ann Burke

Correctional Facilities

Sylvia Abraham
 Francis Bratager
 Joseph Clement
 Geno Cotto
¹Jack Dolan
 Bill Griffiths
 Al Hendrick
²Jack Reighard

Secretary: Lyla Bonney

Literature

²Mary Baker
¹Ole Borgen
 Real McIntyre
 Bill Miller
 Bob Morse
 Elroy Mundhenke
 Dick Pickens
 Louise Robertson
 Benjamin Williams

Secretary: Sarah Price

Report and Charter

Ann Bruning
¹Peter Buckler
²Hank Groat
 Jack Jones
 Greg Muth
 Marc Pineau
 Bob Watt
 Judy Whitehouse

Secretary: Curtis Monahan

NEW CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Conference Agenda	Rita Jourdan, E. Missouri	Art McCord, N.E. Ontario
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Michael Goldsmith, N. Coastal, Calif.	Hal Carty, S. Florida
Correctional Facilities	Allen Hendricks, S. California	Joseph Clement, S.E. Michigan
Finance	Michael Fleming, S.E.N.Y.	Bruce Sutherland, Colorado
Grapevine	Dean Rinehart, Oklahoma	Chester Norton, B.C./Yukon
Literature	Louise Robertson, Nevada	Dick Pickens, N. Florida
Conference Policy/Admissions	Denis Doyle, E. Ontario	Regis Flannery, W. Pennsylvania
Public Information	Larry Midworth, S. Wisconsin	Marilyn (Sam) Parsons, W. Missouri
Conference Report and Charter	Greg Muth, Hawaii	Ann Bruning, Arkansas
Treatment Facilities	Tom Lichwa, N. New Jersey	Dale Abbas, Iowa
Committee on Trustees	Denis Foster, Washington	Pete Peterson, N.E. Texas

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

³ Delegate and alternate unable to attend Conference;

Mary Lindgren, area chairperson, was seated, and served on the Agenda Committee.

1987 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Joe Phelan, *chairperson*
 Norman Adams
 Thomas Hill
 Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
 Joseph Rhoads
 Stanley Silverman
 John Smith, M.D.
 Garrett Taylor
 George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
 Milton Maxwell, Ph.D., *ex officio*
 Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

John Ford, *chairperson*
 Norman Adams
 Helen Harmon
 Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
 Ruth Jagodzinski
 Shepherd Raimi
 Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
 Garrett Taylor
 John Whitehouse
 Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John Whitehouse, *chairperson*
 Paul Dooling
 William Flynn, M.D.
 Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
 John King
 Don Pritts
 Amos Reed
 James Shannon
 Stanley Silverman
 John Smith, M.D.
 Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Don Pritts, *chairperson*
 Dan Byrne
 William Kubinski
 Amos Reed
 James Shannon
 Jean Smith
 Hylan Sperbeck
 Desmond Towey
 Lyla Bonney, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
 Gary Glynn
 Harold Greene
 Wayne Parks
 Joe Phelan
 Shepherd Raimi
 Amos Reed
 Joseph Rhoads
 Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
 Stanley Silverman
 John Whitehouse
 Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
 Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
 Edward Gordon, *secretary*

International

Helen Harmon, *chairperson*
 William Flynn, M.D.
 Harold Greene
 John King
 Wayne Parks
 Don Pritts
 Amos Reed
 John Whitehouse
 Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Dan Byrne, *chairperson*
 William Croke
 John Ford
 Thomas Hills
 Wayne Parks
 Shepherd Raimi
 Jean Smith
 Garrett Taylor
 Curtis Monahan, *secretary*

Literature

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., *chairperson*
 Norman Adams
 William Croke
 Thomas Hills
 Ruth Jagodzinski
 John King
 Jean Smith
 John Smith, M.D.
 Desmond Towey
 Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
 Sarah Price, *secretary*

Nominating

Wayne Parks, *chairperson*
 Dan Byrne
 William Flynn, M.D.
 John Ford
 Helen Harmon
 Ruth Jagodzinski
 Joe Phelan
 James Shannon
 Cheryl Ann Burke, *secretary*

Public Information

William Croke, *chairperson*
 Sam Elfert
 Jill Hargrave
 Renata Karlin
 Howard Levine
 Edward McDougal
 Don Pritts
 Ralph Rosenberg Jr.
 Jane Schulberg
 Garrett Taylor
 Desmond Towey
 Eileen Gatz, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

William Flynn, M.D., *chairperson*
 James Ahern
 Hugh Freyer
 Harold Greene
 Thomas Hills
 Ruth Jagodzinski
 John King
 Joseph Rhoads
 Maureen Costello, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Garrett Taylor, *chairperson*
 Lois Fisher, *secretary*
 All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Gordon Patrick and John Bragg are ex officio members of all committees. Committee secretaries and consultants do not vote.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
 Gordon Patrick
First vice-chairperson
 William E. Flynn, M.D.
Second vice-chairperson
 Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Secretary
 Helen Harmon
Treasurer
 Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
 Lois Fisher
Assistant treasurer
 Edward H. Gordon
 The new slate of officers (post-Conference) is given on page 49.

1987 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Gordon M. Patrick (P.O. Box 774, Kingston, ON K7L 4X6, Canada) was elected to the board in 1975 and became its chairperson in 1982. Recently retired, he was a management consultant with a special interest in helping organizations develop programs for employees disabled by alcoholism. Formerly associated with the Addiction Research Foundation of Ontario and the Donwood Institute, he has a continuing interest in employee assistance programs and professional education. A longtime friend of A.A., he considers it "the most useful resource for recovery from alcoholism."

William E. Flynn, M.D. (125 Daleview Dr., McLean, VA 22101) joined the board in April 1980. A graduate of the Georgetown University School of Medicine, he is currently assistant professor of psychiatry at Georgetown and director of studies in alcohol and drug abuse. He also serves as a consultant to the National Center for Alcohol Education and the alcohol treatment unit at Arlington Hospital in Virginia. Bill chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Nominating, Cooperation With the Professional Community and International Committees.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities and has served as consultant and editorial adviser for many local and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, Joan was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. She chairs the Literature Committee and is a member of the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Conference Committees.

John King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He serves on the International, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment Facilities, and Literature Committees.

Robert P. Morse (96 Cove Rd., Oyster Bay, NY 11771) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee in April 1981. A graduate of the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 15 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert has his own investment counsel firm and is president of the Wall Street Fund. He is also treasurer and trustee of the Bermuda Biological Station of Research, Inc. He is chairperson of the Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies and has

received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Recently retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He serves on the International, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, B.C. V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. He is also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine and part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John serves on the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Literature Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Dan M. Byrne (2900 19th Avenue, Marion, Iowa 52302) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1984. He has a background of group and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. He is currently employed by the Quaker Oats Cereal Company in Cedar Rapids, Iowa. Dan chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committee and is a member of the Nominating and Correctional Facilities Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

William H. (Bill) Croke (165 Perry Ave., Norwalk, CT 06850) was elected general service trustee in April 1986. He has been active in group service since 1970 and has served as A.A.W.S. director since 1983. Bill's background is in advertising/marketing, and he is currently a partner in a small advertising agency in New York City. A member of the Public Information Committee since 1976, Bill also serves on the Literature and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

John R. (Jack) Ford (3092 West King Edward, Vancouver, B.C. V6L 1V5) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 1984. He has been active in group, intergroup, and area service; as a Panel 29 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. He is owner of an auto sales and service center. Jack chairs the Conference Committee and is a member of the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Helen A. Harmon (Box 850, Melita, MB R0M 1L0, Canada), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1983, has served her area as G.S.R., D.C.M., and as a Panel 28 Conference delegate. She remains active in group and area service, and serves on the board of directors of the Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba. She owns and operates a franchise for income-tax preparation and is a salesperson for investments. Helen chairs the International Committee and is a member of the Conference and Nominating Committees. She also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Tom Hills (48 McGregor Road, Scarborough, ON M1P 1C8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1986. Tom has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. A former director of Ontario's Employees Benefits Branch, in 1985 he was chairperson of the Canadian Public Service Pension Advisors. Currently he is senior advisor to Ontario's Management Board of Cabinet on Public Service Pensions. Tom serves on the Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, Treatment Facilities, and Literature Committees.

Ruth C. Jagodzinski (2934 S. Lindell, Las Vegas, NV 89102), elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1986, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. Ruth's background is in the home-health-care and nursing fields; she co-owns and administers a home-health-care program. She is a member of the governor's Advisory Board for Alcohol and Drug Abuse and president of the We Care Foundation board of directors (a small rehabilitation house for alcoholic women). Ruth serves on the Nominating, Conference, Treatment Facilities, and Literature Committees.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson (1105 Palmerston Ave., West Vancouver, BC V7S 2J5, Canada), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1987, has served his area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area treasurer, and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. Currently, Webb is a member of the finance committee for British Columbia/Yukon. A former stock broker and broker dealer, Webb is currently president of NTV Oil Services Industries, Inc. and director of U.C.A. Technologies, Inc. A golfer, Webb is also a member of the American Contract Bridge League.

Wayne Parks (1120 West Cypress, Rogers, AR 72756) was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. Wayne has a background in area service, and after a term as Conference delegate (Panel 29), he returned to other area activities. He has worked in the oil sales, freight, and furniture fields. Wayne serves on his state's Alcohol and Drug Abuse Authority and on its Alcohol and Drug Abuse Advisory Council. He is chairperson of the Nominating Committee and a member of the Finance and Budgetary, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and International Committees.

Joe Phelan (272 The South Chace, Atlanta, GA 30328), elected Southeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1985, has been active in group and area service. As a Panel 30 Conference delegate, he chaired the Conference Finance Committee. Joe served on the Georgia Task Force on Alcohol, Marijuana, and Other Drugs and was president of the Metro Atlanta Council on Alcoholism. Now retired, his background is in the finance, marketing, and investment banking fields. Joe chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Finance and Budgetary and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Don I. Pritts (1009 S. Lewiston Way, Aurora, CO 80017) was elected trustee-at-large, U.S., in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A part-time volunteer for adolescent treatment units, Don has been an employment counselor. Currently he is a sales director for the Conklin Company, establishing and training franchise holders. Don chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the International, Public Information, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees.

Shepherd Raimi (1040 Park Avenue, New York, N.Y. 10028), elected general service trustee in April 1985, is an active member of the Red Hook Group in Red Hook, N.Y. A native of Michigan, he is a lawyer in New York City. He has had a great deal of experience with the impaired lawyer and other aspects of law and alcoholism. Shep is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board. He is also a member of the Conference, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Finance Committees.

Ralph Rosenberg Jr. (410 West 24th St., New York, N.Y. 10011), elected general service trustee in April 1984, remains active in group and intergroup service. He has been a writer for radio and TV and is now employed in the advertising field. Ralph has served on the Grapevine Editorial Board and currently chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board. He also is a member of the Public Information, Conference, and Finance Committees.

James Shannon (3106 Kingsbridge Ave., Bronx, NY 10463), elected general service trustee in April 1985, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service. He was a Panel 27 Conference delegate for Southeast New York and has been involved with the Grapevine, Public Information, and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees as well as the S.E.N.Y. area convention. Jim worked as a supervisor at a management consulting firm and is now retired. He serves as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board and a member of the Correctional, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Nominating Committees.

John A. Sharkey (9 Valley Way, West Orange, NJ 07052). Elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, John is a past area chairperson, and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. He currently serves on the Essex County Alcoholism Advisory Board and was trustee of his intergroup committee. John, who owned and operated a tavern for seven years, is supply coordinator with New Jersey Bell Telephone Company, where he has been employed for over 30 years.

Garrett Taylor (50 55th St. S.E., Washington, DC 20019) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1983. He was chairperson of the Washington Intergroup and of the area committee. After serving as a Panel 27 delegate, he returned to area activities. A retired postal manager, Garrett remains active in civic affairs. Garrett chairs the General Sharing Session. He also serves on the Public Information, Archives, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums, and Conference Committees.

John R. (Jack) Whitehouse (2981 Lakeview Dr., Sanford, MI 48657) was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1985. He has been active in group and area service and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A practicing attorney, he now serves as a mediator for the Workers' Disability Compensation Bureau for the State of Michigan's Department of Labor. Jack chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee. He also serves on the Finance and Budgetary, International, and Conference Committees.

Jan Kelly Williamson (3208 Lampliter, El Paso, TX 79925), elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, has been active in her area's intergroup and in the Southwest Regional Delegate Assembly; she was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. A retired executive secretary, Jan serves on the boards of several local and state associations that deal with alcohol and drug abuse. Jan is primarily involved with local A.A. and her four grandchildren.

¹ Retiring at the close of the 1987 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, becoming a Conference member immediately after election by the General Service Board, April 29, 1987.

A.A. World Services Directors

Shepherd Raimi, *chairperson*
John Bragg
William Croke
Lois Fisher
Jack Ford

Harold Greene
Joe Phelan
Joseph Rhoads
Jean Smith

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Ralph Rosenberg Jr., *chairperson*
Norman Adams
Dan Byrne
Helen Harmon
Jim Shannon

Stanley Silverman
John Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Ann Warner

General Service Office Staff

John Bragg, *general manager*
Lyla Bonney
Cheryl Ann Burke
Maureen Costello
Lois Fisher
Eileen Gatzia
Betty Liddle

Curtis Monahan
Sarah Price
Helen Turnquest
Susan Ulseth
Tom Jasper, *services director*
Frank Mauser, *archivist*
Vicente Mejia, *Spanish services*

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet Ann Warner

Others Assisting at the Conference (nonvoting)

G.S.O./Grapevine Personnel

Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
Ed Brady, *steno/clerical department*
Charles Columbia, *controllor*
Helena De Crespo, *steno/clerical department*
John de Stefano, *editor*
Lynda Ernst, *steno/clerical department*
Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
Dale Fuqua, *Grapevine editorial secretary*
Elizabeth Garcia, *manager, steno/clerical department*
Edward Gordon, *director of finance/business administrator*
Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
Margie Janicek, *steno/clerical department*
John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller*
Steve Linek, *mail department*
Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
Jim McConnell, *designer, Conference Report*
Dorothy McGinity, *Conference Manual coordinator*
Don Meurer, *Grapevine controller*
Victoria Milgrim, *steno/clerical department*
John Nayduch, *Grapevine art director*
Carol Nielsen, *records department*
Tony Onato, *office manager/events coordinator*
Elsie Oxman, *steno/clerical department*
Eve Ponzo, *steno/clerical department*
Ivelisse Rivera, *steno/clerical department*
Frank Segui, *steno/clerical department*
Joan Smith, *steno/clerical department*
Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine executive secretary*
Shirley Sykes, *steno/clerical department*
Cynthia White, *steno/clerical department*
Madeline Whitlock, *secretary, A.A. World Services*
Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeriti

Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
John L. Norris, M.D.

All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees are encouraged to attend and participate at the joint meetings. They are also encouraged to attend, as observers, the Monday sessions of the Conference and one presentation session related to the committee on which they serve.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 37th Conference includes Panel 36 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 37 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	37	Katherine F. Guy, 104 Guy Hollow Ln., Opelika, AL 36801
Alaska	2	36	Francis D. Bratager, 1195 Bratager Rd., North Pole, AK 99705
Arizona	3	36	Edward P. Cavin, 1560 San Carla, Green Valley, AZ 85614
Arkansas	4	37	Ann Bruning, 10728 Hunters Pt., Fort Smith, AR 72903
California Southern	5	37	Allen Hendricks, 4205 Deacon Rd., Bakersfield, CA 93307
Northern Coastal	6	37	Michael Goldsmith, 148 Saturn St., #3, San Francisco, CA 94114
Northern Interior	7	36	Will Noble, Box 162607, Sacramento, CA 95816
San Diego/Imperial	8	36	Tom Beebe, 3752 Catamarca, San Diego, CA 92124
Mid-Southern	9	36	William Schmidt, 8123 Magnolia Ave., #60, Riverside, CA 92504
Colorado	10	37	Bruce Sutherland, Box 1277, Basalt, CO 81621
Connecticut	11	37	Louise A. Dumais-Adams, 49 Bette Circle, Vernon, CT 06066
Delaware	12	36	Wes Jones, 2010 Monroe Pl., Wilmington, DE 19802
District of Columbia	13	37	David B. Smoot, 8500 Oak Dr., Brandywine, MD 20613
Florida Northern	14	37	Richard B. Pickens, 8000 Bay Meadows Circle E., #37, Jacksonville, FL 32216
Southern/Bahamas	15	37	Hal Carty, 113 Arlington Ct., Port Charlotte, FL 33952
Georgia	16	36	Jerome Waller, 204 Fortune Loop, Swainsboro, GA 30401
Hawaii	17	37	Greg Muth, 45-325 Namoku St., Kaneohe, HI 96744

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	36	Gwen Fields, 1311 Willow St., Caldwell, ID 83605	Missouri	38	37	Rita Jourdan, 404 Michael, Wentzville, MO 63385
Illinois				Eastern			
Chicago	19	37	Beth Bowen, 6705 N. Greenview, Chicago, IL 60626	Western	39	37	Marilyn Parsons, 112 Brentwood, Liberty, MO 64068
Northern	20	36	Henry Groat, R.R. 4, Princeton, IL 61356	Montana	40	36	Walter Thompson, Box 6788, Great Falls, MT 59406
Southern	21	37	James Cravens, 75 Montgomery Circle, Carmi, IL 62821	Nebraska	41	36	Sharon L.K. Macomber, 206 E. Sixth St., Ogallala, NE 69153
Indiana				Nevada	42	37	Louise Robertson, 608 Saylor Way, Las Vegas, NV 89107
Northern	22	37	Benjamin H. Williams, 4126 E. Sixth Ave., Gary, IN 46403	New Hampshire	43	36	Peter G. Robinson, 25 McDougall St., Kittery, ME 03904
Southern	23	36	Arthur D. Cross, 11519 Rolling Springs Dr., Carmel, IN 46032	New Jersey			
Iowa	24	37	Dale Abbas, 1103 58th St., Des Moines, IA 50311	Northern	44	37	Tom Lichwa, 1410 E. Oak Tree Dr., North Brunswick, NJ 08902
Kansas	25	36	Mary Baker, 4323 Deerfield, Wichita, KS 67216	Southern	45	36	Harry J. Fischler, 212 Walt Whitman Blvd., Cherry Hill, NJ 08003
Kentucky	26	36	John Jones, 1127 Griffith Ave., Owensboro, KY 42301	New Mexico	46	36	Henry R. Dolan, 5501 Sumner N.E., Albuquerque, NM 87110
Louisiana	27	37	Richard Trahan, 3215 Landfair, Lake Charles, LA 70601	New York			
Maine	28	36	Bob Dodge, Box 83, Stonington, ME 04681	Central	47	37	Robert Watt, 41 Westminster Rd., Rochester, NY 14607
Maryland	29	36	Gene Ray, 579 Bell Manor Rd., Conowingo, MD 21918	Hudson/Mohawk /Berks/Hire	48	36	Bill Miller, Box 73, Warnerville, NY 12187
Massachusetts				Southeast	49	37	Michael R. Fleming, 40-33 W. Fourth St., Patchogue, NY 11772
Eastern	30	37	¹ John S. Allison, Jr., 110 Parker Rd., Needham, MA 02194	Western	50	36	William J. Hay, 68 Ebenezer Dr., West Seneca, NY 14224
Western	31	36	Paul O. Davidson, 20 Johns Dr., Hampden, MA 01085	North Carolina/ Bermuda	51	37	William Sears, 338 First Ave. S.W., Taylorsville, NC 28681
Michigan				North Dakota	52	36	Ole Borgen, 2510 11th Ave. S., Grand Forks, ND 58201
Central	32	37	Judith R. Whitehouse, 2981 Lakeview Dr., Sanford, MI 48657	Ohio			
Southeastern	33	37	Joseph Clement, 12247 E. Ten Mile Rd., Warren, MI 48089	Central & Southeastern	53	37	Marjorie Koch, 1706 B Lakeview Dr., Newark, OH 43055
Western	34	36	Janet Whitney, 9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838	Northeastern	54	37	Joyce Komer, 1204 Hall, Lakewood, OH 44107
Minnesota				N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	55	36	Jack Reighard, 1208 Cady, Maumee, OH 43537
Northern	35	36	Louis Hall, 1537 30th Ave. S., Fargo, ND 58103-8928	S.W. Ohio	56	36	Bob Morse, 19A Bellbrook Ct., Fairfield, OH 45014
Southern	36	37	Jack Cawkwell, 1988 Longfellow Ave., St. Paul, MN 55119	Oklahoma	57	37	Dean Rinehart, 613 Matthews, El Reno, OK 73036
Mississippi	37	36	Buddy Holder, 805 Daniel St., New Albany, MS 38652	Oregon	58	36	Kathy A. Jarchow, Box 851, Gold Beach, OR 97444

¹ Unable to attend the Conference. Alternate delegate also unable to attend; area chairperson, Mary Lindgren, was seated.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	59	37	William Griffiths, 501-C Edmunds Ave., Drexel Hill, PA 19026
<i>Western</i>	60	37	Regis Flannery, 212 Ormsby Ave., Pittsburgh, PA 15210
Rhode Island	61	36	Cliff Carlson, 73 Tucker Ave., Cranston, RI 02905
South Carolina	62	36	Cole Zobel, 1505 S. Kilbourne Rd., Columbia, SC 29205
South Dakota	63	36	Elroy Mundhenke, Box 873, Spearfish, SD 57783
Tennessee	64	36	Billy Speight, Rte. 3, Box 153, Charlotte, TN 37036
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	37	Edmund Peterson, 4557 N. O'Conner Rd. #1281, Irving, TX 75062
<i>Northwest</i>	66	36	Bonnie Taylor, 3700 Merrill, Odessa, TX 79764
<i>Southeast</i>	67	37	George Schon, Rte. 4, Box T-63, Beaumont, TX 77705
<i>Southwest</i>	68	36	Edell Estenson, 95 River Ranch Rd., Bandera, TX 78003
Utah	69	37	Terry Anderson, 3065 W. 8600 South, West Jordan, UT 84088
Vermont	70	36	Richard Haas, Box 276, Townshend, VT 05353
Virginia	71	37	James L. Ball, Madison #1, Presidential Apts., Marion, VA 24354-4433
Washington	72	37	Denis Foster, 1823 10th Ave. W., Seattle, WA 98119
West Virginia	73	37	Robert S. Watkins, 713-A Main St., Charleston, WV 25302
Wisconsin			
<i>N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.</i>	74	36	David J. Roberts, Box 453 M-35, Negaunee, MI 49866
<i>Southern</i>	75	37	Larry Midworth, Rte. 1, Box 24, Merrimac, WI 53561
Wyoming	76	36	John J. Sears, Box 698, Cody, WY 82414
Puerto Rico	77	36	Eugenio Cotto Jr., G.P.O. Box 211, San Juan, PR 00936

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta / Northwest Territories	78	36	Walter Kronkvist, 402-1941 Mayor Magrath Dr., Lethbridge, AB T1K 2R8
British Columbia / Yukon	79	37	Chester Norton, Box 724, Vedder Crossing, BC V0X 1Z0
Manitoba	80	36	Leon Morehouse, 3410 Van Horne St., Brandon, MB R7B 3H4
New Brunswick / Prince Edward Island	81	36	Lawrence Adams, Black River Bridge, R.R. #2, Northumber- land County, NB E0C 1B0
Nova Scotia / Newfoundland / Labrador	82	37	Sylvia Abraham, 2817 Connolly St., Halifax, NS B3M 3N3
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	37	Denis Doyle, RD #1, Bombay, NY 12914
<i>Northeastern</i>	84	37	Art McCord, 24 MacDonald Ct., Elliott Lake, ON P4A 2V2
<i>Northwestern</i>	85	37	Diane Faulconer, 403 Ray Blvd., Thunder Bay, ON P7B 4E7
<i>Western</i>	86	36	Tom Simpson, R.R. #3, Thornton, ON L2L 2N0
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	36	Marc Pineau, 185-14e Ave., Iberville, PQ J2X 1B5
<i>Southeast</i>	88	37	Real McIntyre, 326 Sanatorium, Mont-Joli, PQ G5H 1V7
<i>Northeast</i>	89	37	Micheline Duberger, 903 Senneterre, Ste.-Foy, PQ G1X 3Y2
<i>Northwest</i>	90	36	Real Bourgeois, 560 Blvd. du Coteau, Ste. Therese, PQ J7E 2J9
Saskatchewan	91	36	Peter Buckler, 3366 Eagle Crescent, Prince Albert, SK S6V 7N9

"Canadian delegate from America?"

"You have a wonderful country; I could live there," someone said to Denis Doyle, Panel 37 delegate from Eastern Ontario. "So could I," replied Denis, "I actually live in Bombay, New York." He went on to explain the little-known fact that there are 50 A.A. groups in New York State that are part of the Eastern Ontario Area.

